THE STRIPLINE METHOD · HTML EBOOK

The 12-Month Body

In twelve months you'll change how you look by stripping fat first, locking one plan, and building under accountability — The STRIPLINE Method.

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CONTENTS

Front matter

○ How to use The 12-Month Body

Problem

01 The Wrong Order

Solution

02 The STRIPLINE Method

Benefits

03 What Changes When You Run It

Why Me

04 Why Listen to Me

Promise & Playbook

05 The Twelve-Month Follow-Along Playbook

06 Calories, Macros & Tracking (Nutrition System)

07 STRIPLINE Programmes: PPL & PPLU

Start & Next Step

08 Start This Week, FAQ & Next Step

Advanced Tools Education

A Advanced Tools Literacy — PEDs, TRT, Peptides & GLP-1s

Year Logbook

A Year Logbook & Tracker

FRONT MATTER

How to use The 12-Month Body

Title: The 12-Month Body
Subtitle: The STRIPLINE Method
Promise: A complete follow-along system to transform your physique in twelve months — strip fat first, lock one plan, lift, link to accountability.

JOURNEY ORDER

1. Stage 1 — The Wrong Order
2. Stage 2 — The STRIPLINE Method
3. Stage 3 — What Changes When You Run It
4. Stage 4 — Why Listen to Me
5. **Stage 5A** — Twelve-Month Follow-Along Playbook (Week 0 → Month 12)
6. **Stage 5B** — Calories, Macros & Tracking (+ Food Bro + food apps)
7. **Stage 5C** — PPL & PPLU programmes (+ training apps)
8. Stage 6 — Start This Week, FAQ & Next Step
9. Appendix — Advanced Tools Literacy
10. **Appendix — Year Logbook & Tracker** (print and fill for 12 months)

TOOLS

- Food Bro: https://yehbro.com/food-bro/
- Food app default: Cronometer (alts: MyFitnessPal, MacroFactor)
- Training app default: Hevy (alts: Strong, paper logbook)
- Companion workbook: `workbook/stripline-companion-workbook.md`
- Soft CTA: `[PLACEHOLDER: paid offer / coach funnel — pending agreement]`

PROBLEM

The Wrong Order

Most people don't fail bodybuilding because they're lazy. They fail because they run the year **backwards**.

They chase muscle before the midsection is honest. They collect programmes like trading cards. They negotiate with themselves every Tuesday night and call it "listening to their body." Then twelve months later the photos look familiar, the wardrobe still lies, and they swear genetics are the villain.

Here's the uncomfortable version: the order of operations matters more than your favourite exercise. Get the order wrong and even "hard work" becomes expensive entertainment.

WHAT "THE WRONG ORDER" LOOKS LIKE

You've seen it. You might be living it.

Someone with a soft middle decides the answer is a dirty bulk "so I have something to cut later." Someone skinny-fat lives at accidental maintenance while hopping from ab challenges to advanced techniques. Someone overweight crashes calories for three weeks, rebound-eats for two, then buys a new programme PDF because the last one "didn't work." Someone already tired of starting over adds a supplement stack, a fasting window, and a random advanced tool before they can hit protein four days in a row.

Different costumes. Same mistake: **building on a soft base, without a locked plan, without anyone keeping them honest.**

The mirror doesn't care how long you've been "into fitness." It cares what you repeatedly do — and in what sequence.

Scene: the bulk that bought you a bigger soft photo

It's January. You're frustrated. A mate says you need to "eat big to get big." You take that as permission. Training feels heroic because the weights move when you're full. The scale climbs. Clothes get tighter in the wrong places first. By winter you're stronger — and the midsection owns every candid photo. You tell yourself you'll cut "when the time is right." The time never arrives cleanly, because cutting from a soft surplus is harder than the podcast made it sound, and by then you're tired of being hungry *and* tired of being soft.

That's not a character flaw. That's the wrong order wearing a surplus hoodie.

Scene: the skinny-fat maintenance fog

You're not huge. You're not lean. Arms look okay in a hoodie; shirt off tells a different story. You bounce between "I should bulk" and "I should cut," so you do neither with intent. You eat by vibe. You train hard sometimes. You change your split when a reel makes you doubt yourself. Six months later the scale hasn't moved much and neither has the silhouette. You call it a plateau. It's often just accidental maintenance plus novelty.

Scene: the crash-and-rebound loop

You go hard. Coffee for breakfast. Tiny dinners. Steps through the roof. Week two you look "flatter." Week three you're ravenous and social life nukes the deficit. Week five you've "failed the diet," so you buy a new plan to feel in control again. The midsection barely changed. What changed is your trust in yourself.

Scene: tools before boring basics

You're curious — fair enough. Curiosity without a system becomes a shopping list: powder, pills, gadgets, maybe something more aggressive you saw online. Meanwhile protein is a coin flip and your programme has no logbook. Complexity feels like commitment. It's often cosplay for the hard parts: food average, progressive sets, sleep, and someone who asks whether you did what you said.

MISTAKE ONE: MUSCLE-FIRST WHEN FAT STILL OWNS THE PHOTO

Muscle is the fun story. Fat loss is the adult conversation.

When body fat is high enough to blur every hard edge, "getting bigger" often just makes you a larger version of the same silhouette. You can get stronger. You can even add some tissue. But if the primary visual problem is the midsection, shoulders won't fix the photo by magic. Spot reduction won't either. Endless core work won't.

Fat loss isn't moral purity. It's stored energy with a public relations problem — and it moves when average intake sits below average expenditure for long enough that you can still train. That's not vibes. That's the boring physics underneath every dramatic transformation collage.

The wrong order pretends you can skip the boring physics because you're "building a foundation of muscle first." Sometimes a true hardgainer with very low body fat genuinely needs food and progressive lifting more than a cut — we'll mark that as a **documented**

exception later, not the default religion. For most people reading this book, especially if you carry meaningful fat or look soft through the middle, **stripping fat first is the move that makes the next eleven months readable.**

If you've ever lost a pile of scale weight and still hated the mirror, you already know: smaller isn't the same as better. Skinny-fat is what happens when the number drops and the structure never arrives. The wrong order also creates that — crash, vanish, undereat protein, skip hard training, then wonder why you look deflated.

Skinny-fat vs bulk mistakes (say it plainly)

Skinny-fat mistake: assuming low scale weight means you're ready to dirty bulk. You're not. Soft middle + thin limbs usually wants honest fat-down or recomp with hard lifting and high protein — not pizza surplus "for aesthetics later."

Bulk mistake: using "I'm building muscle" as cover for unstructured overeating while the waist climbs faster than your numbers. Surplus can be a tool later. On a soft photo it's often just delayed honesty.

Crash-cut mistake: chasing the scale so hard you gut training quality and protein, then bounce. You get a temporary number and a long-term identity story that "diets don't work."

The physique you want is composition: less of what blurs you, more of what shapes you. Wrong order treats those as separate hobbies instead of a sequence.

MISTAKE TWO: PROGRAMME-HOPPING DRESSED UP AS OPTIMISATION

Programme-hopping feels like progress because novelty spikes motivation. Your brain loves new PDFs the way it loves new diets.

Week one: perfect. Week three: "I need more volume." Week five: a reel says frequency is everything. Week seven: you're on a different split with different lifts and no logbook continuity. You didn't plateau. You never stayed still long enough to adapt.

Bodybuilding rewards **boring continuity** with progressive overload: same movement patterns, logged loads and reps, slightly harder over time. The person who runs one decent programme for twelve weeks will usually beat the person who "researches" twelve programmes for twelve weeks.

The wrong order treats the plan as optional flavour. The right order treats the plan as the job.

What hopping costs in real life

Every restart burns the skill you were building: groove on a squat pattern, familiarity with a progression rule, the quiet confidence of knowing Tuesday's session before you walk in. Busy people — long shifts, kids, software deadlines — don't have spare cognitive budget for redesigning the week every Sunday night. Hopping spends that budget on theatre.

You'll also lose the only honest diagnostic: did this template stop working, or did you stop running it? If you never finish a block, you never find out.

MISTAKE THREE: NO ACCOUNTABILITY (NEGOTIATING WITH YOURSELF)

You are a biased committee. On Monday you're disciplined. On Thursday you're tired, hungry, and suddenly very interested in "flexible dieting" that somehow never includes the protein target.

Accountability isn't punishment. It's an external brain that doesn't care about your mood. A coach, a training partner, a ruthless mate who asks "did you hit the steps?" — someone who makes the plan real outside your head.

Without that link, most people rewrite the plan mid-week and call it strategy. Missed sessions become "recovery." Skipped protein becomes "intuitive eating." Soft photos become "water weight" forever.

If that stings, good. It means you recognise the pattern.

What absence of accountability actually feels like

It feels like freedom for about a fortnight. Then it feels like fog. You vaguely "know" what you should do. You don't send the check-in. Nobody asks. The missed session doesn't get logged as a miss — it evaporates. Three months later you can't explain where the time went, only that you're "still trying."

Trying without a witness is where years hide.

Lone-wolf pride is fine until your photos disagree. Independence that quietly deletes targets isn't virtue; it's privacy for inconsistency. The fix isn't shame. It's a human loop: report, review, adjust one lever, continue.

MISTAKE FOUR: TOOLS BEFORE SYSTEMS

Supplements, gadgets, and advanced pharmacology can matter in the right context. They are terrible first moves.

If you can't log training and hit protein for a boring block, adding complexity multiplies mess. The feed flattened enhanced timelines next to natural beginners and sold impatience as education. Curiosity is fine. Chaos is optional.

We'll cover advanced-tools *literacy* later as an appendix — what things are, what they aren't, why unsupervised chaos fails — without turning this book into a protocol shop. For Stage 1, remember: **tools amplify the system you already have.** If the system is wrong-order chaos, amplification doesn't save you.

Scene: the stack that didn't move the waist

You buy the tubs. You feel serious. Training is still inconsistent. Dinner is still guesswork. Three months later your kitchen looks committed and your midsection looks familiar. The lesson isn't "supplements are fake." The lesson is order: systems first, tools later, literacy before impulse. Wrong order loves shopping because shopping feels like progress without demanding Tuesday's protein.

THE QUIET FIFTH MISTAKE: MEASURING THE WRONG THING

Wrong order often pairs with wrong scoreboard. Scale-only thinking celebrates crash cuts. Mirror-only thinking without standards celebrates flattering light. Programme-count thinking celebrates PDFs owned instead of blocks finished.

Useful scoreboard for a year that matters: same-condition photos, waist, strength logs, adherence. Everything else is optional colour. If your scoreboard rewards novelty and punishment, you'll keep buying novelty and punishment.

WHY TWELVE MONTHS STILL MATTERS

Short challenges create short people. Twelve months is long enough for fat loss phases, skill in the gym, real strength, and photos that don't lie — if the sequence is right.

It's also long enough to waste if you spend it hopping.

This book assumes you have a real life: work, maybe kids, imperfect sleep, social meals, stress that doesn't care about your hypertrophy goals. The wrong order usually comes from trying to out-clever that life with novelty. The right order installs a sequence that survives ordinary weeks.

Twelve months isn't magic because of the number. It's useful because it forces you past the honeymoon. Motivation dies; systems don't have to. A year of wrong order teaches you the bitter story. A year of right order teaches you what your body does when you stop interrupting it.

Think of the year as four seasons of behaviour, not twelve separate New Year's resolutions. Wrong order restarts every season. Right order compounds.

THE COST OF WAITING ANOTHER YEAR

Another year of wrong order doesn't just delay the physique. It teaches your identity the wrong lesson: "nothing works." That story is usually false. What failed was sequence, adherence, and honesty — not your bones.

Cost of waiting:

- More photos you'll hide.
- More programmes you'll abandon.
- More money on things that don't move the midsection.
- More comparison to people who simply stayed on one plan longer than you stayed curious.
- Another birthday with the same soft middle story and a harder restart because trust in yourself took another hit.
- More "I'll start when life calms down" — life rarely calendars itself around your cut.
- Another winter of hoodies as strategy.
- Another summer of "next summer" promises.
- Another round of explaining to yourself why this wasn't the right time — while the midsection quietly becomes the default you stop noticing until a photo ambushes you.

Waiting feels responsible when you frame it as research. Sometimes research is stalling with better vocabulary. You already know enough to take baseline photos, lock calories and protein, write a twelve-week template, and name a human who will ask. The rest of this book makes that sequence sharper. It does not replace the decision to begin.

There's also a social cost people skip: you start believing you're "the unfit mate," the one who jokes first so nobody else has to. Humour is fine. Using it as a permanent escape hatch from sequence is not. Twelve months of right order won't fix your entire life, but it will retire a lot of that defensive comedy because the photos stop agreeing with the joke.

You don't need athlete genetics. You need the right order, a plan you'll still run in week eight, and a human who notices when you quietly quit.

One more honest inventory

Before Stage 2 names the method, sit with four questions — not as shame, as diagnostics:

1. Is fat still owning the photo while you chase "getting bigger"?
2. Have you finished a twelve-week programme without rewriting it into a different religion?
3. Does anyone outside your head know your targets and ask about them?
4. Are you adding tools faster than you're logging basics?

If you answered yes / no / no / yes, congratulations: you have met the wrong order. Most of us have. The point of this stage isn't to roast you. It's to stop you spending another expensive year rehearsing the same play with new costumes.

Wrong order is common because it's culturally rewarded: bulk culture, novelty culture, lone-wolf culture, tool culture. Right order feels slower in week one and faster across the year. This book bets on the year.

If you recognise yourself in more than one scene, that's normal. Wrong order rarely arrives as a single cartoon mistake. It's usually a stack: soft bulk *and* hopping *and* no check-in *and* a tub you bought instead of a logbook. Untangle the stack by fixing sequence first. Everything else gets easier when the year isn't running backwards.

One last scene, because it belongs here: the competent person who runs systems at work and improvises their body. Long shifts. Kids. A calendar that never asks permission. They don't lack grit — they lack a locked order that survives Thursday. Wrong order thrives in busy lives precisely because novelty and negotiation feel like control when time is scarce. Right order is the opposite kind of control: fewer decisions, clearer sequence, a human who asks.

WHAT YOU'RE GOING TO LEARN INSTEAD

The STRIPLINE Method — strip fat first, lock the line of the plan, lift on a cleaner base, link yourself to accountability — is the spine of *The 12-Month Body*.

Next stage names the method properly: what STRIP, LINE, LIFT, and LINK mean in practice, who gets a lean-hardgainer exception, and how the year is supposed to feel when you stop running it backwards.

If you're impatient already, that's fine. Impatience is useful when it pushes you into sequence — not into another PDF.

SOLUTION

The STRIPLINE Method

In twelve months you'll change how you look by stripping fat first, locking one plan, and building under accountability — without bulk-before-you're-lean chaos or another abandoned programme PDF.

That sentence is the whole product. Everything else is implementation — weeks, reviews, and the refusal to hop when boredom asks politely.

The STRIPLINE Method has four moves: **STRIP** → **LINE** → **LIFT** → **LINK**. They aren't motivational posters. They're the order of operations for *The 12-Month Body* — four moves, one spine, no competing brand.

Old gym roadmaps still talk about Foundation, Build, Refine, Peak. Those can still describe *months inside* the year. They are not distinctive enough as a method, and they often smuggle in "pick your calorie religion" before they've told you to get the midsection honest. STRIPLINE fixes the spine: fat-loss-first by default, one locked plan, muscle emphasis when the base deserves it, accountability so you don't negotiate the plan into dust.

STRIP — FAT DOWN BEFORE YOU OBSESS OVER GETTING BIGGER

STRIP means your first job is getting body fat moving in the right direction until the photo stops lying.

Not "get stage lean in six weeks." Not punishment cardio until you hate training. A sustainable deficit (or a recomp that still prioritises midsection progress) while you lift hard and eat enough protein that you don't evaporate.

What STRIP looks like in practice

- Calories set for fat loss (or honest recomp) — weekly average matters more than one perfect day.
- Protein high enough to protect muscle (~1.6–2.2 g per kg as a practical band; use goal weight if body weight is very high).
- Progressive resistance training kept non-negotiable — you're not "just dieting."
- Steps / daily movement as a quiet fat-loss helper.
- Photos + waist + strength as the scoreboard; scale as supporting actor.

STRIP is where most people should spend early months even if their ego wants a bulk. Soft middles don't become athletic by eating in a surplus and hoping shoulders outrun the belly.

A week in the life of STRIP (ordinary adult edition)

Monday: train upper or full body as written. Hit protein. Steps on the watch. Sleep defended even if the day ran long.

Tuesday: maybe legs or a second session. Hunger shows up mid-afternoon — you don't invent a new diet; you eat the plan's meal or a default high-protein option you already decided exists.

Wednesday: rest or active recovery. Steps still count. No "I earned a free-for-all because I trained hard Monday."

Thursday: train. Log loads. Notice one lift moved a rep — that's the quiet win STRIP protects.

Friday: social meal in the diary. You don't cancel the week; you bank calories earlier or accept a weekly average that still trends down.

Weekend: kids, overtime, life. Bad-week minimum ready: protein floor, two short sessions if needed, step floor, no programme rewrite.

That's STRIP. Not aesthetic suffering. Direction with a life attached.

STRIP examples by starting point

Higher body fat: obvious. Modest deficit, high protein, lift like muscle matters, steps up. Expect clothes and waist to talk before the mirror becomes flattering under bad lighting.

Skinny-fat: often a lighter deficit or recomp — still midsection-first. Don't dirty bulk because you feel "small." Small and soft is not the same problem as lean and underfed.

Restarter: you've lifted before. STRIP still wins if the photo is soft. Experience doesn't exempt you from physics; it just means LINE can reuse skills faster once you stop hopping.

The lean-hardgainer exception (documented — not the default)

If you are already lean, light-framed, and genuinely struggle to eat enough — photos show little fat to strip — your STRIP phase may be short or mostly "stop cutting yourself into nothing." You still LINE (lock a plan). Your LIFT may arrive sooner with a small surplus. Write the exception down. Don't use "I'm a hardgainer" as cosplay while carrying a soft midsection.

How to document the exception properly

1. Same-condition photos: front, side, back. Good light optional; consistency mandatory.
2. Waist measure. If the midsection is clearly soft, you do not get the exception.
3. One-sentence rationale: “Already lean; underfed history; priority is progressive surplus under a locked plan.”
4. Review date in 4–6 weeks. If waist climbs faster than strength and limb fullness, you lied to yourself — return to STRIP without drama.

True hardgainers often undereat relative to training, fear “getting fat,” and live in a cut mentality that keeps them small forever. The exception is permission to feed the work — not permission to eat chaos. LINE still locks calories upward with intent. LINK still asks whether you hit them.

If you’re unsure, default to STRIP/recomp until the photo votes. Ego prefers the bulk story. Honesty prefers evidence.

LINE — LOCK ONE PLAN AND STOP HOPPING

LINE means you draw the line: this is the programme, these are the food targets, these are the sleep/step floors, these are the review dates. Then you run it.

A programme is not a religion. It’s a way to organise hard sets across the week so muscles get trained often enough, recovered enough, and progressed enough around your actual calendar. One boring template beaten for twelve weeks beats three clever templates abandoned at week three.

What gets locked

1. **Training template** — days, lifts, progression rule (e.g. double progression: add reps in a range, then add load).
2. **Nutrition targets** — calories + protein at minimum; carbs/fats fill the rest in a way you can digest, train on, and repeat.
3. **Recovery floors** — sleep minimum you’ll defend; deload rule.
4. **Movement floor** — steps especially in STRIP.
5. **Review ritual** — every 2–4 weeks: photos, waist, strength, adherence. Change **one** lever if stalled.

LINE is also where you stop collecting rules. Meal timing, fancy supplements, advanced intensity techniques — seasoning. Calories, protein, progressive overload, sleep — the meal.

If a diet style tanks your adherence every time you try it, stop collecting rematches with the same fad. Adherence is the cost centre that decides whether any approach works.

A week in the life of LINE

Sunday night (ten minutes): glance at the written week. No redesign. If travel exists, swap days — don't invent a new philosophy.

Training days: same lifts in the same order unless pain forces a substitution you already listed as an alternate. Logbook open before the first warm-up set.

Food: defaults ready — breakfast protein, work lunch that hits the number, dinner that doesn't require chef theatre. Tracking if you need it; averages if daily weighing makes you mental.

Review Friday or every second Sunday: adherence score honest. Missed two sessions? That's data. Not a personality verdict. One lever only if stalled: calories, steps, or a progression tweak — not all three plus a new split.

LINE examples

Shift worker: lock a 3-day full-body rotating on available days, not "Mon/Wed/Fri" fantasy. Protein targets stay; timing flexes.

Parent evenings: shorter sessions with the big lifts first. Optional accessories only if time remains. LINE protects the core, not the Instagram accessory list.

Office + gym after work: commute and hunger are the enemies. Pre-packed protein and a fixed start time beat "I'll go if I feel like it."

LIFT — BUILD MUSCLE ON A CLEANER BASE

LIFT is progressive overload with intent: more load, more reps, better control, or more quality hard sets over time — not random sweating.

You train during STRIP too. LIFT as a *phase emphasis* means: once the midsection trajectory is honest (or your documented exception applies), you bias more of the year toward muscle gain — food up toward maintenance or a small surplus, volume progression where recovery allows, weak-point work without novelty addiction.

What LIFT is not

- Ego maxing every session because you feel motivated.

- Copying advanced volume from someone who recovers like a professional athlete with a nap schedule.
- Abandoning protein and sleep because “I’m bulking now.”

Muscle grows when you give it a reason, the raw materials, and enough recovery to finish the job. Training is the request. Recovery is the construction. Food decides whether the request is easy, hard, or ignored.

A week in the life of LIFT emphasis

Calories sit near maintenance or a small surplus you chose on purpose. Hunger is less dramatic; the job is hitting protein and not turning every weekend into an untracked surplus avalanche.

Sessions push progression: add a rep, add a kilo, improve the pause, clean up the last set. Weak points get one or two honest movements — not a new programme identity.

Sleep and deloads matter more because volume may creep. LINK asks whether you’re actually recovering or just eating more and calling it a bulk.

LIFT examples

After a successful STRIP: waist down, strength mostly held, photos cleaner — raise food, keep the same template, chase overload for 8–12 weeks.

Hardgainer exception: small surplus from week one of the locked plan; patience measured in months of logged progression, not fortnightly scale panic.

Still soft at month six: you don’t “LIFT harder” by force. You keep stripping or recomping. LIFT emphasis is earned by criteria, not calendar boredom.

LINK — ACCOUNTABILITY SO THE PLAN SURVIVES YOU

LINK is the human loop. Someone checks. You report. The plan stays outside your mood.

That can be an experienced coach, a training partner, a mate with permission to be annoying, or — when the agreement exists — a formal coaching funnel. Until then, the soft door in this book is:

[PLACEHOLDER: paid offer / coach funnel — pending agreement]

No coach name here on purpose. The principle stands either way: structure + implementation + follow-through beats motivation theatre.

What LINK looks like weekly

- You send: sessions done, protein hit?, steps, one sentence on hunger/energy.
- They ask: did you follow the written plan — not the rewritten Thursday version?
- You review photos on schedule, not when the lighting is flattering.

LINK also covers Year 2 decisions later: stay in a growth block, another STRIP polish, advanced-tools literacy with supervision — not 1 a.m. impulse after a reel.

A week in the life of LINK

Check-in is boring on purpose. “3/3 sessions. Protein 6/7. Steps average 8k. Sleep rough Wednesday.” Your person replies with one question that hurts a little: “What happens Thursday when you’re tired?” You answer with the MED plan, not a speech.

Monthly photo drop isn’t a performance. Same bathroom, same light if you can, same poses. Comparison to month one beats comparison to strangers.

Without LINK, LINE slowly becomes a suggestion. With LINK, missed weeks get recovered instead of mythologised.

HOW STRIPLINE MAPS ONTO TWELVE MONTHS

Think in phases, not vibes.

Months	STRIPLINE bias	What “good” looks like
1–3	**STRIP + LINE**	Fat moving or midsection improving; plan locked; lifts logged; habits installed
4–6	**STRIP continues or transition**	Still honest about fat; strength mostly protected; adherence high
7–9	**LIFT emphasis when criteria met**	If midsection allows, push muscle; if not, keep stripping without drama
10–12	**LIFT + LINK**	Photos vs month 1; strength PRs; Year 2 sketch; accountability still on

Inside those months you can still use words like foundation (skill), build (stress), refine (aim), peak (show the work). They are subtitles under STRIPLINE — not a competing brand.

Month mapping examples (stories, not prescriptions)

Example A — soft start: Months 1–6 mostly STRIP + LINE. Waist drops. Strength holds. Months 7–10 LIFT emphasis. Months 11–12 polish, photos, Year 2 plan with LINK still weekly.

Example B — skinny-fat: Months 1–4 recomp/STRIP bias with aggressive protein and lifting. Middle tightens, limbs thicken slightly. Months 5–12 gradual LIFT if criteria met — or continued recomp if the photo still softens under surplus.

Example C — lean hardgainer exception: Month 1 short STRIP-as-"stop undereating," LINE hard. Months 2–12 LIFT with patient surplus, same template, LINK watching waist so surplus doesn't become denial.

Example D — restarter with history: Month 1 audit: delete novelty, lock one template, decide STRIP vs LIFT from photos. Then follow the table without reinventing your identity every block.

Your calendar will differ. The spine shouldn't.

STARTING-POINT MODIFIERS (NOT ALTERNATE RELIGIONS)

People start different. The method doesn't.

- **Higher body fat:** STRIP is obviously primary. Sustainable deficit, high protein, lift like muscle matters.
- **Skinny-fat:** STRIP/recomp until the middle tightens and limbs thicken — don't dirty bulk "for aesthetics later."
- **Already lean hardgainer:** documented exception; LINE hard; LIFT sooner with patient surplus.
- **Restarter with gym history:** LINE means audit and simplify before novelty; then apply STRIP or LIFT based on photos, not ego.

Secondary curiosity about advanced tools never hijacks months 1–3. Fundamentals first. Literacy later.

PUTTING THE FOUR LETTERS ON ONE PAGE

If you forget everything else from this stage, keep this:

Move	Job	Failure mode
STRIP	Make the midsection honest	Dirty bulk or crash cut
LINE	Lock plan + floors + reviews	Programme-hopping
LIFT	Progressive muscle emphasis when earned	Ego volume / surplus denial
LINK	Human loop that survives mood	Lone-wolf rewrite culture

STRIP without LINE is a temporary diet. LINE without LINK slowly dissolves. LIFT before STRIP is the wrong-order classic. LINK without a written line is just someone listening to your vibes. The method is the combination in order.

How the year should *feel* (not just look)

Months 1–3 often feel annoying: hunger management, learning the template, fewer dopamine hits from novelty. That's installation, not failure.

Months 4–6 feel quieter if you're doing it right — less drama, more logged work. People quit here because quiet doesn't feel like content. Stay.

Months 7–9 either open into LIFT emphasis (food up, chase tissue) or continue honest STRIP without calling yourself broken. Criteria decide, not ego.

Months 10–12 should feel like evidence: photos vs month one, strength story, a Year 2 sketch that isn't panic. LINK is still on. The year ends with a system, not a cliff.

WHAT YOU STOP DOING WHEN STRIPLINE IS REAL

- Bulking into a soft photo because a podcast said so.
- Changing programmes when motivation is bored.
- Using the scale as a courtroom.
- Quitting protein when appetite is weird.
- Running unsupervised chaos because someone online "looks insane."
- Treating accountability as optional personality.
- Collecting diet identities instead of weekly averages.
- Confusing research nights with training nights.
- Waiting for perfect sleep before you earn average sleep.
- Using "hardgainer" as a costume for a soft middle.

COMMON OBJECTIONS (ANSWERED BRIEFLY)

“Won’t I lose muscle if I strip first?”
Not if protein is high, lifting stays progressive, and the deficit is adult-sized. Panic cuts lose tissue. STRIP isn’t a panic cut.

“I only have three days.”
LINE can be three days. Frequency fantasies don’t beat finished weeks.

“I travel constantly.”
Defaults travel better than perfect kitchens. Protein targets and a shortened session list beat “I’ll restart when I’m home.”

“Accountability feels soft.”
It’s structural. Planes have checklists. Builds have inspections. Your physique can have a check-in without becoming a personality cult.

“What if I stall?”
Review ritual. One lever. Photos and waist before panic. Stalls are information when LINE is intact; they’re identity crises when you’ve hopped too much to know what you were testing.

“Can I do STRIPLINE in a commercial gym with limited kit?”
Yes. LINE picks patterns you can load: squat/hinge/push/pull/carry variants that exist on your floor. Fancy machines are optional. Progressive hard sets are not.

Micro-example: locking LINE in one sitting

Open a note. Write:

- Days: e.g. Mon / Wed / Fri
- Session skeleton: squat pattern, hinge, horizontal push, horizontal pull, vertical push or pull, one arm isolation, one carry or core
- Progression: 3×6–10; add weight when all sets hit 10 clean
- Calories / protein: from Food Bro PDF or equivalent — numbers on the page
- Steps floor / sleep floor
- LINK human + check-in day
- Review every 14 or 28 days

That’s enough to start. Stage 5 elaborates. LINE’s job here is to end the fog, not to win a programming contest.

Micro-example: STRIP review that doesn't spiral

Week 4 photos look similar. Waist down 1–2 cm. Strength mostly flat. Adherence 80%. You do **not** rewrite the programme, add a miracle supplement, and slash calories by a thousand. You nudge steps or tighten weekend averages — one lever — and run another block. That's STRIPLINE maturity: boring corrections beat dramatic reinvention.

Micro-example: when LIFT waits

Month 6. Strength is up. Midsection still soft in side photos. Boredom says bulk. Criteria say keep stripping or recomp. You keep LINE, keep LINK, delay LIFT emphasis. Ego hates it. The year loves it. Wrong order starts the surplus here; STRIPLINE doesn't.

HARDGAINER EXCEPTION — WORKED DETAIL

Let's labour this because misuse is common.

You might be a candidate if: visible fat is low in honest photos; waist is already tight; training history shows food fear or chronic under-eating; strength rises when calories rise; "cutting" mostly makes you smaller and colder without revealing much muscle.

You are probably not a candidate if: side photos show a soft middle; belts tell on you; you rebound between "I'm skinny" feelings and hoodie softness; you want a bulk mainly because surplus is more fun than adherence.

What the exception changes: STRIP becomes brief — stop the accidental cut, install LINE, move toward a small surplus sooner.

What the exception does not change: you still lock a programme; you still log progressive overload; you still review waist so surplus doesn't become denial; you still LINK so "I ate big" isn't an unverified vibe.

Patient surplus literacy: small and steady beats dirty chaos. If waist races ahead of strength and limb fullness, you didn't discover hardgainer destiny — you discovered unstructured overeating. Pull back toward maintenance, keep lifting, reassess. The exception is a lane, not a personality.

Month sketch for a documented exception: Month 1 — photos, LINE lock, food up from undereating toward a planned surplus, LINK weekly. Months 2–6 — same template, chase overload, waist watched every review. Months 7–12 — continue LIFT or insert a short STRIP polish if softness crept in. No programme-hopping as celebration.

STRIP / LINE / LIFT / LINK — FAILURE MODES WORTH NAMING

STRIP failure: crash for two weeks, binge for two, call it a metabolism problem.
LINE failure: perfect spreadsheet, zero weeks finished.
LIFT failure: surplus without progressive stimulus — "dreamer bulk."
LINK failure: check-ins that are essays about feelings and silent about sessions and protein.

Name the failure early and you can correct without burning the year.

ANOTHER WEEK-IN-THE-LIFE: MIXED REALITY (STRIP + LINE UNDER PRESSURE)

Your roster looks fine on paper. Then a late job lands, a kid gets sick, and sleep fragments. Wrong order uses that week to scrap the identity. STRIPLINE uses MED: protein floor still hit with boring defaults; one or two shortened sessions that keep squat/hinge/push/pull patterns alive; steps as walking-with-life instead of a punished treadmill penance; LINK message that says "bad week, MED on, full LINE resumes Monday." That's not softness. That's how twelve-month bodies are built by people who don't live in a content house.

MONTH MAPPING — NUMBERS AS ILLUSTRATION, NOT DESTINY

Suppose you start with a soft midsection and average adherence historically around 50%. Months 1–3 aim for adherence 80%+ and a clear waist/photo trend while strength mostly holds. Months 4–6 continue STRIP until side photos stop arguing — maybe you're ready to transition, maybe you need more strip time; criteria decide. Months 7–9, if earned, push LIFT: food up, same template, chase overload, weak-point work limited to one or two movements. Months 10–12 compare to month one, sketch Year 2, keep LINK. If at month 8 you're still soft, you didn't "fail LIFT" — you simply haven't met LIFT criteria yet. Stay honest. Stay on LINE. The calendar is a guide; the photo and the waist are the vote.

CURIOSITY CLOSER

You now have a named system. Next we talk about what actually changes when you run it — the benefits that make fat-loss-first feel less like delayed gratification and more like the fastest honest path to a physique you'll keep.

Then you'll get the why-me story (real, limited, no fairy tale), then the twelve-month playbook with food, training, and the Food Bro calculator link so numbers stop being guesswork.

For now, write one line in your notes:

> I'm running STRIPLINE: strip → line → lift → link.

Say it with the exception clause if you earned it: "…with a documented lean-hardgainer exception and waist reviews." Say it with honesty if you didn't. If you can't say that without flinching, Stage 1 is still talking. Stay with it until the flinch becomes a decision.

BENEFITS

What Changes When You Run It

STRIPLINE isn't a personality transplant. It's a sequence that makes ordinary weeks add up — the unsexy kind of change you notice in trousers, logbooks, and quieter Sundays.

Here's what changes when you stop running the year backwards — not as fantasy before/after marketing or fabricated testimonials, but as practical outcomes you can feel in the logbook and see in photos.

THE MIDSECTION STOPS OWNING EVERY PHOTO

When fat loss comes first, clothes fit differently before you're "done." Shoulders and arms start reading as shape instead of padding. You stop needing perfect lighting to feel okay about a photo.

That's not vanity for its own sake. Midsection progress is feedback that energy balance and adherence are real. It also makes later muscle-focused phases cleaner: you're not trying to reveal muscle that never had a chance to show.

People who bulk first often spend Year 2 undoing Year 1. Fat-loss-first compresses that expensive loop.

Before/after of process (not a testimonial)

Before (wrong order): You avoid side photos. Belts creep. "I'll cut after this bulk" becomes a loop with no exit criteria. Every social photo needs a strategic angle.

After (STRIP running): Same lighting, same bathroom, four weeks apart — waist tape moves, shirt hangs differently, you stop negotiating with the camera quite so hard. You're not stage-lean. You're simply no longer lying to yourself about direction.

The benefit isn't a magazine cover. It's evidence you can trust on a Tuesday.

STRENGTH BECOMES A STORY YOU CAN TRUST

In a panic cut, strength falls off a cliff and you call it metabolism. In STRIPLINE, lifting stays non-negotiable while fat comes down, so the logbook usually shows a quieter truth: some lifts

stall, many hold, skill rises, and you're still a lifter — not a cardio tourist.

When you eventually bias harder into LIFT, progressive overload has a runway. You're not learning the barbell and learning hunger management and learning a new programme identity in the same week.

Before/after of process

Before: Every diet means "I'll get back to real training later." Later never inherits the strength you had. You rebuild the same beginner groove annually.

After: The notebook still has numbers during STRIP. A stall is a stall — annoying, not an identity collapse. When food comes up in LIFT emphasis, you're adding load to a skill you kept warm, not rediscovering the gym from zero.

DECISION FATIGUE DROPS

LINE kills a surprising amount of misery: you already know what you're doing this week. Grocery lists shrink to defaults. Gym sessions stop being philosophical debates.

Busy adults — construction hours, software sprints, kids in the car — don't fail because they lack information. They fail because every evening asks them to redesign the plan. A locked line means the evening only asks: execute or run the bad-week minimum.

Before/after of process

Before: Sunday night is a research rabbit hole. Monday's session depends on which reel won. Food is renegotiated at every meal. By Thursday you're exhausted from deciding, not from training.

After: Sunday night is a ten-minute glance. Training is written. Protein defaults exist. Travel week uses the MED list you already drafted. Cognitive load moves from "what's my identity this week?" to "did I do the thing?"

That mental quiet is a benefit people underestimate until they feel it.

YOU WASTE FEWER MONTHS

Programme-hopping feels productive. It's usually a tax.

Twelve focused weeks of one template with logged progression will teach you more about your body than a year of half-finished experiments. STRIPLINE's review ritual (one lever at a

time) means stalls become diagnostics, not identity crises.

Fewer wasted months also means less of the poisonous story: “I’ve tried everything.” You tried everything except continuity.

Before/after of process

Before: Six programmes in six months. No continuous log. You can’t say whether volume was high or adherence was low. Frustration feels like expertise because you’ve “sampled” a lot.

After: One template for twelve weeks. Week eight looks related to week one. When you change calories or steps at a review, you know what you changed. Learning compounds. Time stops vanishing into half-starts.

ACCOUNTABILITY CHANGES BEHAVIOUR BEFORE MOTIVATION DOES

LINK isn’t magic cheerleading. It’s the knowledge that someone will ask.

People lift harder when the notebook is open. People eat more honestly when the check-in exists. Motivation still wobbles — that’s human — but the plan doesn’t have to wobble with it.

If you’ve only ever trained as a lone wolf who “doesn’t need anyone,” notice whether your photos agree. Independence is fine. Isolation that quietly deletes protein targets is not a virtue.

Before/after of process

Before: Missed sessions evaporate. Soft weeks get rewritten as “listening to my body.” Nobody receives the unflattering photo set. You become an unreliable narrator of your own plan.

After: A short weekly message exists. Misses get named. Photos land on schedule. You still have bad weeks — you stop mythologising them. Behaviour improves before your feelings catch up, which is the whole point of a system.

IDENTITY SHIFTS FROM “I’M TRYING” TO “I TRAIN”

Discipline isn’t endless punishment with a gym bag. It’s reps of behaviour until the behaviour is who you are on ordinary Tuesdays.

STRIPLINE builds that identity in the right order: you become someone who gets leaner with intention, follows a written plan, lifts progressively, and reports to a human. The physique

follows the identity more reliably than the other way around.

You also learn the healthy limit: optimisation should expand your life (energy, confidence, time with people you care about), not consume it. Responsibility without obsession.

Before/after of process

Before: "I'm getting back into it" is your personality for years. Friends stop asking. You stop trusting your own start dates.

After: You don't need a speech. You train on the days you said. Protein is mostly handled. The identity is boring in the best way — like brushing your teeth, except with a logbook and a waist tape.

COMPARISON GETS QUIETER

When your scoreboard is *you vs you* — photos under the same conditions, waist, strength — other people's pharmacy and genetics become less hypnotic. Body image still has weather. Literacy helps: the feed is a highlight reel with filters and timelines you don't share.

STRIPLINE doesn't cure insecurity. It gives you a process so insecurity doesn't get to redesign your calories every weekend.

Before/after of process

Before: A scroll can nuke your plan. You add volume you can't recover, cut food you can't adhere to, or chase a tool you don't understand — all before breakfast.

After: You still scroll sometimes. The review ritual and LINK absorb the impulse. Changes wait for the scheduled lever, not the scheduled insecurity spike.

WHAT YOUR WARDROBE AND WEEK START DOING

Practical, unglamorous benefits stack:

- Trousers and work shirts fit with less negotiation.
- Grocery spend stabilises around defaults instead of "diet food" fads.
- Gym time gets shorter and denser because the session is written.
- Sleep gets defended because recovery is part of LINE, not an afterthought.
- Social meals become planned events inside a weekly average, not moral collapses.

None of that requires a perfect life. It requires sequence repeated until the sequence is normal.

CONSTRAINED WEEKS STOP BEING AN EXCUSE — AND START BEING THE ARENA

A quiet Stage 3 benefit: you stop waiting for a monastery calendar. The plan that only works on empty evenings wasn't a plan; it was a fantasy. When sessions are locked, protein has defaults, and LINK still gets a three-line check-in after a brutal day, fatherhood and long hours stop being a veto. They become the environment the system was built to survive.

That doesn't make the weeks easy. It makes them countable. You can look at a month of site overtime or kids' illness and still see sessions, grams, and photos — instead of a blank that you rewrite as "I'll get serious next season."

Before/after of process

Before: "Once work settles / once the kids sleep / once this project ends" — the physique waits for a calendar that never arrives.

After: The calendar is ugly and the LINE still runs. MED weeks are logged, not mythologised. Progress is slower than Instagram, faster than never.

ENERGY, MOOD, AND ORDINARY COMPETENCE

Strip the hype and you still get practical human benefits when the sequence runs.

Fat-loss-first with protein and lifting often means you move through workdays with less physical self-contempt — not because every hour is blissful, but because you're no longer carrying quite as much of the thing that made stairs and shirts feel like commentary. Sleep floors in LINE don't cure life stress; they stop you treating recovery as optional flavour. Progressive strength under LIFT changes how groceries, kids, and job tasks feel in your hands. LINK reduces the lonely fog of "am I making this up?"

Before/after of process

Before: Training is a guilt loop. Food is a mood. You finish workdays depleted and call the evening a write-off before protein has a chance.

After: Not perfect energy — directed energy. You know the session exists. You know the default meal exists. You might still be tired. You're less often lost.

RELATIONSHIPS WITH FOOD AND THE GYM GET LESS THEATRICAL

Wrong order turns every meal into a referendum and every session into a personality performance. STRIPLINE makes more of it procedural: hit the average, run the template, send the check-in. Hunger still exists in STRIP. So does pleasure. They're just no longer allowed to redesign the year every Friday night without review.

Before/after of process

Before: Monday purity, Thursday bargain, Saturday amnesia, Sunday shame-research.

After: Weekly average. Planned social meal. Logged training. Review date on the calendar. The theatre budget shrinks.

CONFIDENCE THAT ISN'T FAKE BRAVADO

Real confidence here is quieter: you can show a side photo to your LINK without a speech; you can decline a random programme because yours isn't finished; you can say "I'm in STRIP" without needing strangers to validate the phase. That's process confidence. Physique confidence grows behind it.

TIME USE GETS CLEANER

Wrong order spends evenings researching. STRIPLINE spends evenings executing or recovering. That swap is a benefit with compound interest: hours formerly burned on PDF archaeology become sessions, meal defaults, or sleep. You don't become a monk. You become harder to distract with novelty dressed as homework.

Before/after of process

Before: Two hours of "research," zero logged sets, protein still undecided.
After: Forty-five minute session as written, protein default eaten, ten-minute LINK note. Same evening length. Different year.

THE PHOTO FOLDER BECOMES A TOOL, NOT A THREAT

When reviews are scheduled, photos stop being random ambushes. They become data you chose to collect. That doesn't make every photo pleasant. It makes them useful. Side-by-side month 1 vs month 4 under the same conditions beats a thousand feelings about "whether it's working."

STRENGTH, HUNGER, AND HONESTY CAN COEXIST

A quiet benefit of STRIPLINE is emotional permission structures: you can be hungry in STRIP and still lift; you can stall a lift and not torch the diet; you can send an ugly check-in without quitting. Wrong order treats discomfort as a signal to reinvent everything. Right order treats discomfort as weather inside a locked plan. That single shift saves months.

WHAT DOESN'T MAGICALLY CHANGE

Be honest about the limits.

- You won't out-train a permanent weekend black hole without adjusting the plan.
- You won't love every hungry evening in STRIP.
- You won't add championship muscle in a month of LIFT.
- Accountability won't work if you lie to the person on the other end.
- Genetics still exist. Timelines still vary. Bad weeks still happen.
- Advanced tools still won't rescue a chaotic base — literacy comes later for a reason.
- Body image weather still rolls through. Process reduces how often weather gets to rewrite calories.

The benefit isn't ease. It's direction.

BRIDGE

Next is why you should listen to someone who isn't claiming guru status — just a bloke who ran a real twelve-month turnaround with a coach, systems, and the same principles you're about to install. Then the playbook: numbers, training, months, and the Food Bro calculator so you're not guessing forever.

If Stage 2 was the map, Stage 3 is the reason the map is worth folding into your pocket. Stage 5 is where you walk it. The change isn't a mood. It's a sequence you can feel in the logbook long before strangers notice the photo.

WHY ME

Why Listen to Me

I'm not writing this as a famous bodybuilder with a secret formula. I'm writing it as someone whose life — and physique — turned around in twelve months when the order finally got honest.

Here's the real story. I'm not inventing extras.

2026: FAT LOSS THAT WASN'T THE PHYSIQUE YET

In **2026** I lost **over 25 kg**. On paper that sounds like the win. In the mirror it was more complicated. I went from essentially carrying a lot of fat to looking **skinny-fat** — lighter, softer in the wrong places, not the athletic shape I actually wanted.

Then I **put weight back on**.

That part matters. A lot of transformation content skips the ugly middle: the rebound, the confusion, the moment you realise the scale lied about the goal. Lower weight isn't automatically a better body. I learned that the hard way.

What skinny-fat after a big loss actually teaches

You can do something "right" on the scale and still miss the point. Clothes get looser. Relatives congratulate you. Inside the mirror, the midsection and the lack of muscle structure still argue. If you've been there, you know the weird grief of succeeding at subtraction and failing at composition.

I don't need to dress that up with invented drama. The fact pattern is enough: big fat loss → skinny-fat look → regain. That's the wrong-order / incomplete-order lesson lived, not lectured.

THE COACH AND THE SYSTEM

I got an **experienced coach**. I learned **the system** — not a vibe, not a random stack of tips, a way of running training and food with someone keeping me accountable.

After that, I lost **over another 15 kg** while **putting on muscle at the same time**. Different game. Composition, not just subtraction.

Now I feel **bigger and stronger at around 75 kg** than I did at around **103 kg**. More toned. More like the project was about building something, not only deleting something.

That's the whole proof I'm offering you: same human, different order, different outcome — fat-loss-first when it needed to be, a locked plan, progressive training, and accountability that didn't let me quietly rewrite the rules every Thursday.

~75 versus ~103 — the feel that matters

The numbers are landmarks, not a prescription for your body. What matters is the contradiction people don't expect until they live it: you can weigh less and feel more solid, move better, and look more like the goal — when muscle and fat finally move in the right directions together under a system.

~103 kg with a lot of fat is one kind of "big." ~75 kg with more muscle and less fat is a different kind of capable. Same person. Different composition. That's why this book refuses to worship the scale as the whole courtroom.

WHY SYSTEMS CLICKED FOR ME — UNDER REAL LIFE, NOT UNLIMITED GYM TIME

I'm a **father of two young girls**. During this turnaround I was also working **~70-hour weeks in construction** — on top of a brain that also lives in **software**, data, plans, and systems. This did **not** happen because I had a content-creator schedule, a private chef, and three free hours of "optimal training" every day.

It happened because the plan had to survive fatherhood and brutal hours: locked sessions that fit the calendar, protein defaults that didn't need a perfect kitchen every night, and a coach keeping me accountable when Thursday-me wanted to negotiate.

If you're reading this after a twelve-hour day with kids who still need you, you're the audience. STRIPLINE assumes constraints. Unlimited recovery is not the prerequisite.

My background in **construction** and **software development** meant I already trusted **data, plans, and following systems**. When training finally got the same respect as a build schedule or a codebase — written plan, tracked inputs, review loops — results stopped being mystical.

If you're the type who can follow a procedure at work but treats the gym like improvisational theatre, you're not broken. You're just running the wrong process in the place that needs process most.

Construction brain meets training

On a site, you don't "feel your way" through a structural sequence and hope the inspection passes. You follow an order. You check what's done. You don't skip foundations because the finishings look more exciting on Instagram. Seventy-hour weeks don't leave room for programme-hopping cosplay — you run the one plan you locked.

Software brain meets food and lifting

In code, vibes without version control become chaos. Training without a log, nutrition without targets, and weeks without review are the same bug with sweat on them. Once I treated adherence like something you can see — sessions done, protein hit, photos on schedule — the fog lifted. Not because I'm special. Because systems are what I already trusted everywhere else — and because accountability meant someone noticed when the log went quiet after a monster week on the tools.

WHAT I WANT THIS BOOK TO CARRY

Life can turn around in **twelve months**. Not because twelve is magic — because it's long enough to run STRIPLINE for real: strip fat, lock the line, lift on a better base, link to accountability.

Anybody can do it with the same system if they stop chasing novelty and start executing the sequence. You don't need my biography to match yours. You need the method.

I'm not going to pretend I did it alone as a lone wolf myth. The coach mattered. Accountability mattered. If you read this book, run the plan, and still want hands-on help, I'll link you with my coach when that door is formally open:

[PLACEHOLDER: paid offer / coach funnel — pending agreement]

No name here yet on purpose. The invitation is the point: you don't have to white-knuckle forever if you need a human in the loop.

WHAT THIS STAGE IS NOT

- Not a list of fake client testimonials.
- Not medical advice or a pharmacology autobiography.
- Not "do exactly my numbers."
- Not a claim that your timeline will photocopy mine.
- Not a longer legend than the facts allow — if a detail isn't here, I didn't invent it for colour.

It's why the voice of this book sounds impatient with wrong-order nonsense — because I've lived the soft photos after "successful" weight loss, and I've lived the version where muscle and fat loss finally moved together under a system.

WHY "ANYBODY CAN" ISN'T EMPTY CHEERLEADING

I'm not saying anybody gets the same photos in the same weeks. I'm saying the *system* — fat-loss-first when the midsection owns the photo, one locked plan, progressive lifting, accountability — is available to ordinary adults with jobs and messy calendars. Construction days and software sprints didn't make me exempt from hunger or missed sessions. They made me hungry for a process that survives real weeks.

If you need a guru myth, this isn't your book. If you need a sequence and a reason to trust twelve months of boring continuity, you're in the right place.

WHAT THE TWELVE-MONTH TURNAROUND ACTUALLY ARGUES

Look at the arc again without decoration:

1. Big fat loss (25 kg+) that landed in skinny-fat territory.
2. Weight back on.
3. Experienced coach + system.
4. Another 15 kg+ down while muscle went up.
5. Feels bigger and stronger near 75 kg than near 103 kg.
6. Background already wired for plans and data — construction and software — finally applied to training.
7. Message: twelve months can turn a life around when the sequence and the accountability are real; anybody can run the same kind of system; help linking to a coach stays a soft door until agreements exist.

That's the argument. Not destiny. Not genetics worship. Not lone-wolf myth. A human who needed order, got it, and wants the method in your hands as *The 12-Month Body* — STRIPLINE — rather than another pile of tips.

I won't pad this stage with invented childhood stories, fake client quotes, or pharmacology autobiography. The approved facts are enough to explain why this book is impatient with soft bulks, abandoned PDFs, and accountability optional cosplay.

WHY THE COACH CHAPTER OF THE STORY STAYS NAMELESS (FOR NOW)

The coach mattered. The system mattered. Accountability mattered. Naming can wait until agreements exist; the principle doesn't. If you've ever tried to white-knuckle a physique rewrite alone and watched Thursday rewrite the plan, you already understand why LINK sits in the method instead of in a motivational footnote.

When the door is open, the soft invitation stays the same wording on purpose:

[PLACEHOLDER: paid offer / coach funnel — pending agreement]

SOFT NEXT STEP (NOT A HARD SELL)

Run the playbook in Stage 5. Start in Stage 6. If you still want hands-on help after you've tried the system:

[PLACEHOLDER: paid offer / coach funnel — pending agreement]

Until that placeholder becomes a real door, your LINK can be a mate with permission to be annoying. The principle doesn't wait for branding.

The short version if you skim: I lost a lot of fat, looked skinny-fat, regained, then did it properly with a coach and a system — more fat down, muscle up, and ~75 kg that feels stronger than ~103 ever did. Systems from construction and software finally met the gym. Twelve months mattered. Anybody can run this kind of sequence. Help linking to a coach stays soft and pending on purpose.

NEXT

Stage 5 is the promise and the playbook: how to measure, how to eat (including the Food Bro calculator), how to train, how to recover, and how to lay the twelve months across STRIP → LINE → LIFT → LINK.

You've got the problem, the method, the benefits, and the why. Now we build the year — with numbers, training, and the same respect for plans that construction and software already taught me to trust.

PROMISE & PLAYBOOK

The Twelve-Month Follow-Along Playbook

The promise: run The STRIPLINE Method for twelve months — strip fat first, lock one plan, lift progressively, link to accountability — and you give yourself a real shot at the best physique of your life from wherever you are starting. Not a six-week miracle. Not a bulk that ignores the midsection. A year of honest sequence with specific tools, templates, and decision rules.

This chapter is the follow-along operating system. You should be able to open it in Month 1 and still be using it in Month 12 without inventing a new religion every Sunday night.

If you still want a human in the loop later, that door sits here as a soft next step — **[PLACEHOLDER: paid offer / coach funnel — pending agreement]** — without replacing the plan in your hands.

HOW STAGE 5 SPLITS (READ THIS ONCE, THEN EXECUTE)

Stage 5 is too important to bury inside one overloaded pamphlet. It splits into three working chapters plus a later logbook appendix:

Part	Job	What you do with it
5A (this chapter)	The twelve-month journey	Scoreboard, Week 0/1 setup, month-by-month actions, reviews, plateaus, chaos SOPs
5B	Nutrition system	Calories, macros, tracking workflow, defaults for busy days
5C	Training system	Default **PPL** and **PPLU** programmes, effort rules, deloads, logging
Year Logbook (later appendix)	Write-in pages	Weekly/monthly checklists, waist/photo trackers, training and food logs for the full year

Rule of use: 5A tells you *what month you're in and what "good" looks like*. 5B sets the food numbers. 5C sets the sessions. The Year Logbook is where you write the receipts.

Metering tool for food targets (also covered in 5B): **https://yehbro.com/food-bro/**

Keep Stage 2's definitions in your head: **STRIP** → **LINE** → **LIFT** → **LINK**. This chapter installs them on a calendar.

HOW TO USE THIS CHAPTER ACROSS THE YEAR

1. **Week 0–1:** complete the setup checklists; do not skip photos.
2. **Every training week:** run floors + LINK template; log food and lifts.
3. **Every 4 weeks:** run the review script; apply the one-lever tree only if needed.
4. **At month boundaries:** read that month's section the weekend before it starts; write the "next action" in your calendar.
5. **At Months 3, 6, 9, 12:** use the block tables as a dashboard; complete photo comparisons.
6. **Whenever life explodes:** open chaos SOPs first — not a new PDF.

You should not need to re-read Stage 1–4 every month. You *should* reopen the month you are in, the review script, and Stages 5B/5C when numbers or sessions need detail.

If you want more accountability than a mate can give, keep the soft door visible without waiting for it to start: **[PLACEHOLDER: paid offer / coach funnel — pending agreement]**.

WEEK 0 / WEEK 1 SETUP CHECKLIST

Do not "start training harder" before you can measure whether anything changed. Week 0 is setup. Week 1 is first honest execution.

Week 0 — baseline and lock (exact steps)

Complete every box before you chase clever programming.

1. Photos (same conditions) - [ ] Front, side, back — relaxed posture - [ ] Same bathroom/light if possible; same time of day (morning after bathroom is best) - [ ] No pump-flex Olympics for the baseline set (optional pumped shots can be extra — keep one standard set forever) - [ ] Save dated files somewhere you will still find in twelve months

2. Waist - [ ] Tape at navel, relaxed, consistent tension - [ ] Record number + date in workbook / notes

3. Scale protocol (supporting actor, not judge) - [ ] Weigh most mornings after bathroom, before food/drink - [ ] Plan to average the week — single days are noise

4. Food Bro PDF - [ ] Enter stats at **https://yehbro.com/food-bro/** - [ ] Download free tailored PDF (cut / maintain / lean bulk as relevant) - [ ] Paste calories + protein into workbook and your food app goals

5. Apps (pick one each — stop shopping) - [ ] Food logging: Cronometer (primary default) *or* MyFitnessPal *or* MacroFactor — see Stage 5B - [ ] Training logging: Hevy (primary default) *or* Strong *or* a notebook that you will actually open — see Stage 5C - [ ] Steps: whatever watch/phone you already own; set a floor number

6. Pick the programme (Stage 5C) - [ ] **PPL** if you can honestly guard ~6 training days most weeks - [ ] **PPLU** if **4 hard days** is the real life version - [ ] **3-day full body** only if 4+ days is fantasy this season - [ ] Write the days on the calendar for the next 8–12 weeks — no redesign loop

7. LINE lock (write these once) - [ ] Calorie target + protein target (from Food Bro + 5B) - [ ] Step floor (STRIP default often 7–10k+; pick a number you can hit on workdays) - [ ] Sleep floor (defend a minimum — many adults need to fight for 7+) - [ ] Deload rule (e.g. every 6–8 weeks, or when sleep + joints scream) - [ ] Review date every 4 weeks (put it in the calendar now) - [ ] LINK person: coach / mate / partner who can ask “did you follow the written plan?” — or soft door **[PLACEHOLDER: paid offer / coach funnel — pending agreement]**

8. Starting-point call (one sentence) - [ ] Higher body fat → STRIP primary - [ ] Skinny-fat → STRIP/recomp; no dirty bulk escape - [ ] Already lean hardgainer → complete the exception checklist later in this chapter - [ ] Restarter → audit, simplify to one template, then STRIP/LIFT from photos

Week 0 exit rule: if photos, waist, Food Bro targets, programme choice, and floors are not written, you are still in Week 0. Gym heroics without a baseline are just expensive cardio cosplay.

Week 1 — first honest week (exact steps)

- [ ] Train every scheduled day on the locked template (MED version only if life explodes — see chaos SOPs)
- [ ] Log every work set before you leave the gym or close the app

- [ ] Hit protein daily; hit calories as a weekly average (perfect days optional; averages mandatory)
- [ ] Hit step floor ≥5 of 7 days
- [ ] Sleep floor defended at least on training nights
- [ ] One mid-week LINK check-in: sessions done / protein hit? / one sentence on energy
- [ ] Do **not** change the programme, the calorie target, or the app stack mid-week

Week 1 exit rule: attendance + logging + protein happened. Looking transformed by Sunday is not the exit rule.

SCOREBOARD DEFINITIONS

If the scale is your only judge, you will make stupid decisions. Scale weight includes fat, muscle, water, gut content, glycogen, salt, stress hormones, and "I trained legs yesterday."

Primary scoreboard (decide with these)

Metric	How to take it	Cadence	What it tells you
Photos	Same poses, light, time; front/side/back	Every 2–4 weeks	Shape, midsection honesty, limb fullness
Waist	Navel, relaxed, consistent tension	Weekly (same day) + every review	Fat trajectory on the midsection
Strength	Logbook on main lifts (load × reps × sets)	Every session	Muscle signal is alive or dying
Adherence	Sessions hit / protein days / step days / sleep nights	Weekly score out of simple totals	Whether you ran the plan

Secondary scoreboard (useful, not sacred)

- Trend weight (weekly averages)
- How clothes fit (belt notch, shirt sleeves, jeans waist)
- Energy / hunger / mood notes (one line)

- Joint feel (not hypochondria — early warning)

How to read the board

Photos	Waist	Strength	Verdict
Improving	Down or stable-down	Holding or rising	Winning — stay the course
Soft / worse	Up	Rising	Likely surplus too big or steps collapsed — one lever
"Smaller" but soft	Down fast	Collapsing	Shrink mode — eat up / recover; you are not transforming
Flat	Flat	Flat	Check adherence first; then plateau tree

Adherence score (simple weekly template):

- Training days planned: __ / hit: __
- Protein days (≥90% of target): __ / 7
- Step-floor days: __ / 7
- Sleep-floor nights: __ / 7

If adherence is junk, you do not have a mysterious plateau. You have a compliance problem. Fix the week before you rewrite the physics.

TOOLS STACK (DEFAULTS YOU CAN SWAP LATER)

Pick tools once in Week 0. Consistency beats brand loyalty contests.

Food tracking apps

Role	Default	Why
Primary	**Cronometer**	Accurate database; clean enough for beginners who weigh food

Role	Default	Why
Strong alternative	**MyFitnessPal**	Huge barcode coverage (handy in AU shops) — verify entries
Paid coaching-style option	**MacroFactor**	Useful if you want algorithm-assisted adjustments and will pay

Rule: one app for ≥8 weeks. Verify barcodes. Log oils and cooking fats. Review **weekly averages**, not single-meal purity.

Pair with Food Bro: set targets at **https://yehbro.com/food-bro/** → enter the same calories/protein as app goals → log daily → bring weekly averages into the 4-week review.

Training log apps

Role	Default	Why
Primary	**Hevy**	Clean templates, rest timers, history you will actually check
Strong iOS-first alternative	**Strong**	Excellent session UX if you live on iPhone
Offline fallback	Notebook / Notes app	Valid if you open it every session

Rule: if it is not logged, it did not progress — you exercised. Stage 5C gives the PPL/PPLU sessions to load.

Steps / wearables

Use whatever you already own. The number that matters is the **floor you hit**, not the brand on your wrist. Recalibrate if a new watch reads differently — compare trends inside one device.

Workbook / Year Logbook

Use the companion workbook sheets now; the full Year Logbook appendix later is the print-friendly twelve-month home for checklists, waist/photo trackers, and weekly reviews. Until that appendix is in your hands, a notes doc with dated headings is enough — as long as Month 12 can find Month 1.

FLOORS, DEFAULTS, AND THE WEEKLY OPERATING RHYTHM

The year fails in the gaps between “knowing” and “running.” These are the defaults that keep STRIPLINE alive when motivation is average.

Non-negotiable floors (write numbers)

Floor	How to choose	Example starting defaults
Protein	From Food Bro / Stage 5B (~1.6–2.2 g/kg practical band)	e.g. 160–200 g depending on size/goal weight
Calories	Phase-appropriate average (STRIP deficit; LIFT small surplus when earned)	Paste Food Bro cut/maintain/lean-bulk figure
Steps	High enough to matter in STRIP; sustainable on workdays	Often 7–10k+; raise before savage calorie cuts
Sleep	Minimum you will defend most nights	Many adults: fight for 7+; training nights first
Training days	From Stage 5C choice	6 (PPL), 4 (PPLU), or 3 (full body)
LINK touchpoints	Weekly at minimum	Same weekday; three lines is enough

If a floor is fantasy relative to your roster, lower it to something hittable and raise it later. A fake 12k step target you miss daily is worse than an 8k floor you own.

Default week shape (ordinary adult)

Sunday (10–15 min): glance at written sessions and food defaults. No redesign. Note travel/overtime. Confirm LINK check-in day.

Training days: compounds first, log before you leave, protein planned around the session without perfection theatre.

Rest / step days: step floor still counts. Active recovery walks beat “rest means sofa and delivery chaos” for most people in STRIP.

Friday or Saturday: social meal rule already written — estimate, protein-first where possible, weekly average still trends correctly.

Review Friday every fourth week: full script. Other weeks: adherence score only.

Starting-point modifiers (bias inside one method)

Starting reality	Month 1–3 bias	Watch-outs
Higher body fat	Clear STRIP deficit; steps matter; lift like muscle matters	Crash diets; cardio that kills lifting
Skinny-fat	Mild deficit or recomp; high protein; no dirty bulk escape	Feeling "small" and bulking into softness
Lean hardgainer (documented)	Short stop-undereating → patient surplus	Denial soft bulk; skipping waist checks
Restarter with history	Audit, simplify one template, then STRIP/LIFT from photos	Novelty addiction; ego loading on a cut

These are modifiers, not four different books.

Worked example — reading a noisy month

Sam, Month 2: scale up 0.6 kg week-to-week after a salty restaurant weekend. Panic says "reverse diet" or "new programme." Scoreboard says: waist -1 cm across four weeks, side photo tighter, bench holding, adherence 6/7 protein days. **Decision:** stay course. The scale told a salt story. The waist and photos told the fat story.

Jordan, Month 5: scale down, lifts down hard, photos "smaller soft," sleep 5–6 hours. Panic says "cut harder." Scoreboard says shrink mode. **Decision:** raise calories ~150–200, defend sleep, MED volume one week, keep steps. Fat loss that deletes training is not the product.

Use examples like these in your own reviews. Story first from photos/waist/strength/adherence — then the scale as supporting cast.

MONTH-BY-MONTH FOLLOW-ALONG (MONTHS 1–12)

Each month below uses the same five blocks: phase bias, what to do, what to track, what "good" looks like, failure modes, next action. Run the month you are in. Do not live in Month 12

fantasy during Month 2.

Month 1 — Install the craft (STRIP + LINE)

STRIPLINE phase bias: STRIP + LINE. Fat-loss-first for anyone with meaningful fat or skinny-fat softness. Hardgainer exception only if documented.

What to do this month - Run Week 0 / Week 1 checklists completely. - Lock PPL or PPLU (or 3-day) and stop shopping programmes. - Practise Food Bro targets with real logging — oils, sauces, "bites," alcohol included. - Learn hard-enough sets without form collapse (Stage 5C effort rules). - Build default meals you can repeat on workdays (Stage 5B). - Install LINK: weekly check-in habit, even if it is short and boring.

What to track - Photos (Week 0 + end of Month 1) - Waist weekly - Weekly weight average - Session log every training day - Adherence score weekly - Hunger/energy one-liner 2–3×/week

What "good" looks like - You can explain your calorie + protein targets without vague vibes. - ≥80% of planned sessions happened. - Protein hit most days. - Midsection trajectory started *or* exception written with a review date. - Logbook exists and is ugly in a useful way.

Common failure modes - Skipping photos "until I look better." - Changing the split three times because a mate runs something cooler. - Tracking food Monday–Thursday, disappearing Friday–Sunday. - Judging the whole year by a noisy scale on day nine. - Going so hard on cardio that lifting and sleep die.

Exact weekly checklist (Month 1) - Mon–Sun: hit scheduled sessions or MED substitute - Daily: protein target; log food same day - Daily: steps toward floor - 1× LINK: sessions / protein / energy - End of week: adherence score + weekly weight average

Next action into Month 2 Keep the same template. Do a short review: waist trend, strength on 3 main lifts, adherence average. Adjust **one** lever only if needed (usually steps or a small calorie tweak). No new programme.

Month 2 — Make the boring reliable (STRIP + LINE)

STRIPLINE phase bias: STRIP + LINE. Habit reliability over novelty.

What to do this month - Automate groceries and default breakfasts/lunches. - Film one work set per major lift this month (form check). - Protect sleep floor like it is a training

appointment. - Practise social-meal rules written in advance (estimate, budget, return next meal). - If travel/shift chaos hits, use chaos SOPs — do not invent a temporary religion.

What to track - Same primary scoreboard - Note which meals are “autopilot” vs improvisation - Step average vs floor - Any missed LINK check-ins (fix them; do not mythologise)

What “good” looks like - Weekends no longer erase weekdays every time. - You know your working weights on main lifts. - Hunger is managed with plan tools (protein, volume foods, sleep), not with “new diet” shopping. - Waist trending favourably *or* recomp signs (tighter photos, held strength) if skinny-fat.

Common failure modes - “Clean eating” without logging because tracking felt tedious for five days. - Adding random HIIT because fat loss feels slow at week six. - Ego loading while dieting; joints complain; you call it “bad genetics.” - Secret surplus via coffee-shop extras and “I deserved it” dinners.

Decision rules unique to Month 2 - If weekends erase weekdays: pre-log a default Saturday intake and a planned social meal budget — do not “wing it and regret.” - If lifts feel ugly: film sets before adding load; reduce range only if pain demands a listed alternate from Stage 5C. - If hunger is loud but waist is moving: keep protein high, favour volume foods (Stage 5B), sleep harder — do not panic-eat a new diet identity.

Next action into Month 3 Run a proper 4-week review script (later in this chapter). Decide: stay STRIP, lighten deficit slightly if strength is dying, or hold course. Still no programme hop.

Month 3 — Prove the system under real life (STRIP + LINE)

STRIPLINE phase bias: STRIP + LINE. Exit foundation with receipts, not feelings.

What to do this month - Stress-test the plan against overtime, kids’ sport, social season — using MED weeks when needed. - Nail double progression: top of rep range with good form → add load. - Confirm deload timing if joints/sleep are fraying. - Compare Month 1 photos to Month 3 before declaring anything cursed. - Write a one-paragraph “what actually works for my schedule” note.

What to track - Full Month 3 photo set vs Month 1 - Waist vs Month 1 - Strength on the same 3–5 lifts - Adherence average across Months 1–3 - How many MED weeks you needed (data, not shame)

What "good" looks like - Clear midsection improvement **or** documented hardgainer exception still valid on review. - Strength mostly held or improved on key lifts. - You trust the process enough to stop collecting PDFs. - LINK still happening without drama.

Common failure modes - Boredom bulk: "I've been good; time to eat big," while photos still soft. - Quitting because a stranger on social media looks better after "8 weeks" (unknown drugs, lighting, years of training). - Perfect weekdays + obliterated weekends = mysterious plateau cosplay. - Delaying review because you "already know" — memory lies.

Month 3 exit interview (write answers) 1. What broke most often — training, food logging, steps, sleep, or weekends? 2. What default fixed it when I used it? 3. Midsection vs Month 1: better / same / worse? 4. Am I bored of a working plan and tempted to hop? (If yes, that is a warning light.) 5. Phase decision for Months 4–6 in one sentence:

Next action into Month 4 Block decision: continue STRIP, shift to recomp/hold, or begin early LIFT only if STRIP→LIFT checklist passes. Write the decision in one sentence.

Month 4 — Productive stress without chaos (STRIP continues or transition)

STRIPLINE phase bias: STRIP continues for most. Transition only if criteria earned.

What to do this month - Keep the same programme skeleton (Stage 5C). Add at most one accessory or one set where a weak point is honest — not a new identity. - If still stripping: keep deficit sustainable; raise steps before nuking calories into misery. - If transitioning: nudge calories toward maintenance first for 1–2 weeks, then small surplus if photos stay honest. - Rehearse recovery: sleep, deload rule, stress management on purpose.

What to track - Photos every 2–4 weeks - Waist response to any calorie change within 2–3 weeks - Session quality (RIR honesty) - Adherence under slightly higher life load (common in this block)

What "good" looks like - You can train hard without treating every session like a funeral. - Fat trajectory still honest if STRIP continues. - If calories rose, waist did not sprint away while lifts stayed lazy. - Plan still written; mood is not the programmer.

Common failure modes - "Transition" that is actually untracked eating. - Adding volume because you feel flat, while sleep is wrecked. - Comparing to Month 12 goals and panicking into extremes. - Dropping LINK because "I've got this now."

Transition protocol (only if earned) 1. Move from deficit → estimated maintenance for 7–14 days. 2. Keep protein and training identical. 3. Watch waist + photos. 4. If midsection stays honest, add ~100–200 kcal for a small surplus (Stage 5B). 5. If waist jumps and photos soften, return to STRIP. No debate club.

Next action into Month 5 Confirm phase in writing again. If waist climbed faster than strength/limbs after a surplus nudge, return to STRIP without a speech.

Month 5 — Hold the line when motivation thins (STRIP / early LIFT)

STRIPLINE phase bias: STRIP for soft midsections; early LIFT only if earned.

What to do this month - Expect motivation to dip. Systems carry you: defaults, calendar, LINK. - Audit logging quality (verify barcodes, weigh oils, stop “eyeballing the peanut butter”). - Push progressive overload where recovery allows; take the deload if earned. - Practise restaurant estimation without abandoning the weekly average.

What to track - Adherence especially (this is the month people quietly quit logging) - Waist + photos - Sleep vs training performance correlation - Alcohol / social frequency vs weekly calorie average

What “good” looks like - You train on days you do not “feel like a bodybuilder.” - Food logging is boring and mostly accurate. - Physique is clearly different from Month 1 in side-by-side photos. - You are not shopping for a new method because a plateau week happened.

Common failure modes - Ghosting the food app while still “kind of dieting.” - Revenge workouts after a bad weekend. - Supplement stacking as a substitute for steps and protein. - Using “maintenance break” as a euphemism for chaos.

Motivation-dip protocol - Shrink decisions: same breakfast, same gym start time, same LINK weekday. - Use MED sessions rather than zeros when life spikes. - Re-read Month 1 photos before you declare the plan dead. - Do not open a new programme PDF as entertainment.

Next action into Month 6 Run 4-week review. Decide whether Months 6–7 stay STRIP or officially enter LIFT emphasis. Use the checklist, not boredom.

Month 6 — Mid-year audit (STRIP finish or LIFT gate)

STRIPLINE phase bias: Mid-year fork — continue STRIP with integrity **or** enter LIFT if criteria met.

What to do this month - Full mid-year photo set (same conditions as Month 1). - Complete STRIP→LIFT criteria checklist (below). - If staying in STRIP: refresh defaults, tighten weekend leaks, keep lifting progressive. - If entering LIFT: raise food with intent (Stage 5B surplus defaults), keep the same template, watch waist weekly. - Update Year Logbook pages so Months 7–12 are not improvisation.

What to track - Month 1 vs Month 6 photos (mandatory) - Waist delta - Strength delta on main lifts - Adherence average Months 4–6 - Written phase decision for Months 7–9

What "good" looks like - Honest call: keep stripping **or** build — based on midsection evidence. - Strength story is mostly protected across the first half. - You know your failure patterns and have countermeasures written. - LINK still on the calendar.

Common failure modes - Dirty bulk celebration because "half the year is done." - Cutting harder out of impatience when adherence was the real issue. - Changing to an advanced split to "mark the new phase." - Skipping the mid-year photo comparison.

Mid-year scoreboard table (fill in)

Metric	Month 1	Month 6	Notes
Waist			
Weekly avg weight			
Key lift A			
Key lift B			
Key lift C			
Photo verdict	baseline	better/same/worse	

Fork sentence (copy): "For Months 7–9 I will run _____ because photos/waist/adherence show _____."

Next action into Month 7 Execute the written fork. If LIFT: surplus is small and tracked. If STRIP: no self-pity — integrity compounds.

Month 7 — LIFT emphasis when earned (or STRIP integrity)

STRIPLINE phase bias: LIFT emphasis **if** Month 6 checklist passed; otherwise STRIP continues (no drama).

What to do this month (LIFT path) - Calories at small surplus or strong maintenance with high protein. - Chase overload: reps, load, control — logged. - Keep steps from collapsing to zero; NEAT often rises in surplus, but do not invent a sofa bulk. - Add weak-point work sparingly (1–2 movements), not a new programme brand.

What to do this month (STRIP path) - Same as earlier STRIP months: deficit honesty, protein, progressive training, steps. - Ignore calendar envy from people who earned LIFT earlier. Your photos are the referee.

What to track - Waist weekly (LIFT path: early warning) - Strength progression rate - Weight trend vs photo look - Recovery (sleep, resting feel, joint notes)

What "good" looks like - LIFT: limbs filling, strength rising, waist not sprinting. - STRIP: continued midsection progress without strength freefall. - Either path: adherence still adult.

Common failure modes - LIFT becoming weekend buffet + weekday denial. - STRIP lifters "rewarding" themselves into a soft surplus accidentally. - Volume explosion because surplus energy feels motivating. - Dropping cardio/steps to zero and calling it recovery.

LIFT weekly guardrails - Surplus size stays small enough that weekly waist change is slow, not dramatic. - Protein remains non-negotiable (surplus carbs do not replace it). - Progression logged every session — "I ate more" is not overload. - If clothes tighten at the waist faster than sleeves: trim food or raise steps before you invent a cut panic.

STRIP weekly guardrails (if still here) - Deficit still trainable. - Compare to *your* Month 1, not to people who earned LIFT earlier. - Raise steps or tighten logging before another aggressive calorie slash.

Next action into Month 8 Keep the path. Mini-review at week 4. One lever only if waist or strength misbehaves.

Month 8 — Build skill under load (LIFT / continued STRIP)

STRIPLINE phase bias: Same as Month 7 — stay consistent inside the chosen bias.

What to do this month - Double down on form under heavier loads; film a set again. - Schedule the deload if you skipped it in the last 6–8 hard weeks. - Practise high-protein surplus meals that are not pure junk (Stage 5B). - If still stripping, consider a brief diet break at maintenance if adherence is dying — planned, timed, not a free-for-all.

What to track - Quality of last reps (are they still the target muscle?) - Waist vs strength (LIFT) - Hunger vs sleep (STRIP) - Missed sessions causes (schedule vs motivation vs illness)

What "good" looks like - Progression continues without weekly injury scares. - Body looks more athletic than Month 1 even if scale story is mixed. - You can explain why you are still in STRIP or LIFT in one calm sentence.

Common failure modes - Ignoring nagging pain until it becomes a month off. - Programme hop disguised as "weak point specialisation camp." - Comparing enhanced timelines to your natural Month 8. - Letting LINK die because results feel "fine enough."

Deload reminder If you have run 6–8 hard weeks without an easier week, take one: reduce set count and/or load, keep frequency, sleep harder. Coming back stronger beats collecting a mystery shoulder injury as a personality.

Pain rule: sharp joint pain that alters mechanics → swap to the listed alternate (Stage 5C) and reduce load. Soreness from hard training is not the same thing. If unsure, MED and ask a qualified professional — do not ego through structural pain.

Next action into Month 9 Block review: are you still on the right side of the STRIP/LIFT gate? Adjust food or steps one notch if needed. Keep the skeleton.

Month 9 — Refine the aim (LIFT / STRIP polish)

STRIPLINE phase bias: LIFT refine if earned; otherwise STRIP polish without calling it failure.

What to do this month - Aim stimulus: prioritise lagging body parts with honest effort, not seventeen new machines. - Tighten food quality if surplus got sloppy; tighten adherence if STRIP stalled from leaks. - Rehearse photo conditions for the final quarter (same as Month 1). - Sketch a first draft of Months 10–12 intent: grow, polish, or hybrid.

What to track - Photos at start and end of month - Waist - Top sets on priority lifts - Adherence and social-meal hit rate

What "good" looks like - Clear visual difference vs Month 1 and vs Month 6. - You are bored of the plan in a healthy way — boredom means LINE is working. - Decision draft for final

quarter exists on paper.

Common failure modes - Panic cut before a holiday because a mirror day was unkind. - Specialty technique addiction (drop sets everywhere) with no log progression. - Abandoning protein while “lean gaining.” - Starting Month 12 fantasy peaking rituals too early.

Final-quarter planning worksheet - Bias for Months 10–12: - Reason (photos/waist): - Calorie target: - Step floor: - Programme (unchanged unless pain forces alternates): - Photo dates booked: - LINK weekly slot: - Year 2 early note:

Next action into Month 10 Lock final-quarter bias: LIFT finish, short STRIP polish, or maintain + recomp. Write it. Tell your LINK person.

Month 10 — Show the work starting now (LIFT + LINK)

STRIPLINE phase bias: LIFT + LINK for those who earned growth; short STRIP polish allowed if midsection still owns the silhouette.

What to do this month - Treat photos as a project: same conditions, scheduled dates. - Keep training progressive; do not coast because “the year is almost done.” - Run LINK weekly without fail — this is where people quietly drift. - If polishing: modest deficit, high protein, protect lifts, steps up. - If still growing: keep surplus patient; waist watched.

What to track - Fortnightly photos optional; monthly mandatory - Strength PRs (even small ones) - Adherence streak - Early Year 2 notes (what to keep / kill)

What “good” looks like - You look unmistakably different from Month 1 in side lighting that is not flattering. - Training identity is “I train and eat on plan,” not “I’m on a challenge.” - LINK still asks hard questions.

Common failure modes - Coasting. - Crash cutting for a photo that fools no one who sees you in person. - New programme “for the final push.” - Advanced-tools curiosity turning into unsupervised chaos (literacy belongs in the appendix — with a coach standard, not 1 a.m. impulse).

Photo project checklist (start now) - [ ] Same location/light plan as Month 1 - [ ] Morning schedule blocked - [ ] Front / side / back relaxed set - [ ] Optional flexed set kept separate - [ ] Files named `YYYY-MM-month12-front.jpg` style so you can find them

Coasting test: if you skipped two LINK check-ins and “forgot” logging, you are not peaking — you are drifting. Restart the floors this week.

Next action into Month 11 Confirm polish vs grow for the last eight weeks. Book the Month 12 photo date now.

Month 11 — Peak process, not panic (LIFT + LINK / polish)

STRIPLINE phase bias: Finish the chosen bias. No new religion.

What to do this month - Run the plan you already trust. - Fix only leaks: weekend averages, sleep, skipped lifts, unverified food entries. - Optional: slightly higher step floor if polishing; not marathon cosplay. - Write Year 2 sketch: another STRIP block, growth block, or maintain — plus whether you want coaching support via **[PLACEHOLDER: paid offer / coach funnel — pending agreement]**.

What to track - Photos toward Month 12 set - Waist - Strength maintenance or final PRs - Subjective "can I live like this?" score — sustainability matters

What "good" looks like - Stable execution under life as it actually is. - Physique shows muscle + midsection honesty relative to your start. - Year 2 sketch exists so Month 13 is not Month 0 energy.

Common failure modes - All-or-nothing finale (perfect or abandoned). - Comparing your Month 11 to someone else's Year 5. - Dropping LINK and food logging early "because habits are locked" — then watching them unlock. - Borrowing advanced protocols you do not understand.

Sustainability probe (answer honestly) - Could I run the next 12 weeks of this food pattern without hating my life? - Is my training template still compatible with work and family? - What single friction (groceries, gym time, weekends) needs a better default? - Do I want more accountability next year via **[PLACEHOLDER: paid offer / coach funnel — pending agreement]**?

Next action into Month 12 Schedule Month 12 photo day, measurements, and written review. Keep training through it.

Month 12 — Receipts and Year 2 fork (LIFT + LINK)

STRIPLINE phase bias: LIFT + LINK (show the work). Optional short polish already decided in Months 10–11.

What to do this month - Full photo set vs Month 1 (and Month 6). - Waist, trend weight, strength summary. - Adherence autopsy: what broke, what held, what you will systematise next year. - Keep sessions and protein going — do not treat Month 12 as a victory lap that deletes the habits. - Decide Year 2: grow, strip, maintain/recomp, and accountability structure.

What to track - Everything on the primary scoreboard one more clean time - A short list of non-negotiables for Year 2 - Whether you want ongoing LINK support (soft CTA placeholder)

What "good" looks like - Side-by-side proof you are not guessing anymore. - Strength and skill you did not have in Week 0. - A Year 2 plan that is boring enough to work. - Identity shift: you know how to run STRIPLINE, not just "try a diet."

Common failure modes - Declaring failure because you are not stage-lean / magazine-cover ready. - Immediate rebound chaos "as a reward." - Throwing away the logbook and photos. - Jumping into unsupervised enhancement as a finale instead of literacy + coaching standards.

Year-end review agenda (60–90 min once) 1. Photo board: Month 1 / 6 / 12 side by side. 2. Numbers: waist, strength, adherence themes. 3. What worked (keep): 4. What failed (kill or redesign): 5. Year 2 block 1 (8–12 weeks): STRIP / LIFT / maintain — 6. Accountability plan: self + mate / soft CTA placeholder. 7. Immediate next week scheduled like Week 1 again — no "January reboot" mythology if you finish in another month.

Next action after Month 12 Open the Year Logbook appendix pages for Year 2 Week 1. Keep LINE locked. Soft door if you want help: **[PLACEHOLDER: paid offer / coach funnel — pending agreement]**.

BLOCK SUMMARY TABLES

Months 1–3 — Foundation under STRIP + LINE

Focus	Default
Phase bias	STRIP + LINE
Food	Deficit or recomp (Food Bro + 5B); high protein
Training	Locked PPL / PPLU / 3-day; learn hard sets; log everything
Steps / recovery	Step floor + sleep floor installed

Focus	Default
LINK	Weekly check-ins begin
Exit criteria	Photos/waist moving or exception documented; adherence mostly real; programme attendance solid

Months 4–6 — Continue STRIP or transition

Focus	Default
Phase bias	STRIP continues; transition only if earned
Food	Keep honest; maintenance bridge before surplus
Training	Same skeleton; tiny weak-point adds only
Reviews	4-week reviews; mid-year photo audit in Month 6
Exit criteria	Written fork: stay STRIP or enter LIFT via checklist

Months 7–9 — LIFT emphasis when earned

Focus	Default
Phase bias	LIFT if checklist passed; else STRIP integrity
Food	Small surplus or continued deficit — not vibes
Training	Overload focus; sparse accessories; deloads respected
Risk to watch	Soft surplus chaos; novelty addiction; LINK fade
Exit criteria	Clear visual vs Month 1/6; final-quarter bias drafted

Months 10–12 — Show the work + LINK

Focus	Default
Phase bias	LIFT + LINK; optional short polish
Food	Patient grow or modest polish deficit

Focus	Default
Training	No coasting; no last-minute programme rewrite
Deliverables	Month 12 photos vs Month 1; Year 2 sketch; adherence autopsy
Exit criteria	Receipts + sustainable next block — not a rebound reward spiral

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FOUR-WEEK REVIEW SCRIPT

Use this every 4 weeks (put it in the calendar in Week 0). Ten to twenty minutes. No theatre.

Before you start

- [ ] Latest photos (or confirm last set is ≤2 weeks old)
- [ ] Waist number (today)
- [ ] Weekly weight averages for the last 4 weeks
- [ ] Logbook open on the same 3–5 main lifts
- [ ] Adherence scores for the last 4 weeks
- [ ] One sentence on sleep/stress

Script (answer in writing)

1. **Adherence first:** Did I mostly run the written plan? If no → stop. Plan a MED recovery week, restore logging, do **not** change calories/programme yet.
2. **Photos:** Better / same / worse through the midsection and overall shape?
3. **Waist:** Down / flat / up vs four weeks ago?
4. **Strength:** Main lifts up, holding, or down?
5. **Trend weight:** Direction of weekly averages?
6. **Phase check:** Am I still in the correct STRIPLINE bias for my photos?
7. **One lever:** If stalled with good adherence, pick **one** change from the plateau tree below.
8. **LINK send:** Sessions, protein, steps, waist, one sentence, the one lever (if any).

Review output template (copy/paste)

- Dates covered:
- Adherence (train/protein/steps/sleep):

- Photos: better / same / worse —
- Waist: __ → __
- Strength notes:
- Decision: stay course / one lever =
- Next review date:

PLATEAU ONE-LEVER TREE

Definition of a real plateau: adherence is genuinely high for ~2–4 weeks **and** photos/waist/strength are stuck or moving the wrong way.

If adherence is low, it is not a plateau. Fix compliance.

Tree (change one lever, then re-review in 2–4 weeks)

1. **Steps / NEAT**
   Raise daily step floor by ~1–2k (STRIP) or restore a collapsed floor (any phase). Silent NEAT drops sabotage deficits.

2. **Calories (small)**
   STRIP stalled fat loss → trim ~100–200 kcal/day **or** tighten weekend logging accuracy first if leaks are obvious.
   Strength collapsing / misery → raise ~100–200 kcal.
   LIFT waist sprinting → trim surplus; do not "train more" as the first lie.

3. **Sleep / stress load**
   Defend sleep floor; cut junk volume; use MED sessions for 1 week if life is on fire.

4. **Training honesty**
   Are work sets actually near failure with decent form? Is progression logged? Add **one** hard set to a lagging lift **or** clean up RIR — not both plus a new split.

5. **Only then consider structure**
   Swap an exercise for a pain-free alternate; deload; or change days to match the calendar. Programme-hop as first response is how you stay stuck with better branding.

Hard rule: one lever. Write it down. Give it time. Then review.

Worked plateau cases

Case A — fake plateau: "Nothing's happening." Digging shows 3/7 protein days and two skipped sessions. **Action:** MED week to reset habits; no calorie change; no new split.

Case B — STRIP stall with good adherence: waist flat 3 weeks, photos unchanged, lifts holding, steps drifted from 9k → 5k. **Action:** restore step floor first. Re-review in 3 weeks.

Case C — STRIP stall, steps good: logging verified, steps solid, waist flat, mild strength rise. **Action:** trim ~150 kcal/day. Hold programme.

Case D — LIFT waist creep: surplus on paper looks small, sleeves improving, waist +2 cm in a month, weekend logging sparse. **Action:** fix weekend logging accuracy for 2 weeks before cutting food; if still climbing, trim surplus.

Case E — strength crash on cut: photos improving but every lift down and sleep poor. **Action:** raise calories, sleep floor, optional 1-week volume MED — not "add more intensity techniques."

What not to do when stalled

- Stack five changes on Monday.
- Start a 14-day detox.
- Copy an advanced bodybuilder's volume.
- Throw away twelve weeks of data because week thirteen was annoying.

TIER-1 SUPPLEMENTS (SHORT, AFTER BASICS EXIST)

Supplements are seasoning. They do not replace STRIPLINE.

Tier-1	Role	Notes
Creatine monohydrate	Strength/performance support	Daily; boring and useful
Caffeine	Training focus	Do not nuke sleep floor
Protein powder	Convenience toward gram target	Food first when practical

Skip the fat-burner museum until calories, protein, steps, and progressive overload are real. Fancy stacks usually buy expensive urine and a story.

WHAT TO IGNORE ON PURPOSE (SAVES MONTHS)

- Spot reduction fantasies
- Dirty bulk as personality
- “I need a perfect programme before I start”
- Advanced tools as Month 1 homework (literacy later; coaching standard if used)
- Comparison to unknown-drug timelines
- Forty niche food rules before calories and protein
- Daily scale verdicts without weekly averages
- Programme hop as first response to boredom

STRIP → LIFT CRITERIA CHECKLIST

Do not enter LIFT emphasis because you are bored, it is Month 7 on someone else’s calendar, or you want bigger sleeves while the midsection is still soft.

Tick **all** of the must-haves before surplus bias:

Must-haves

- [ ] Side-by-side photos show a clearly improved midsection vs your start (not “I feel smaller in hoodies”).
- [ ] Waist is down meaningfully **or** stable after a solid fat-loss / recomp block with honest adherence.
- [ ] Strength on main lifts mostly held or improved through the STRIP/recomp work.
- [ ] Adherence has been real for ≥4 weeks (training + protein + logging).
- [ ] Sleep is not in freefall; you can recover a bit more food and still train.
- [ ] You will keep the **same** programme skeleton (Stage 5C) — LIFT is food + overload emphasis, not a new split identity.
- [ ] You have a waist watch plan (weekly) and a rule to return to STRIP if softness accelerates.

Nice-to-haves (not required)

- [ ] Clothes fit differently through waist and shoulders.
- [ ] LINK person agrees the photos earn the phase change.

- [ ] You can surplus without historical binge patterns wrecking the average (if that is a risk, maintain/recomp longer).

If you cannot tick the must-haves: stay in STRIP or recomp. That is not failure. That is the method.

LEAN-HARDGAINER EXCEPTION CHECKLIST

This is a **documented exception**, not the default, and not cosplay for soft midsections.

You may use the exception only if you can tick these

- [ ] Same-condition photos show little fat to strip (midsection not clearly soft).
- [ ] Waist measure supports the photo story.
- [ ] History of undereating relative to training, or chronic cut mentality keeping you small.
- [ ] Written one-sentence rationale: e.g. “Already lean; underfed history; priority is progressive surplus under a locked plan.”
- [ ] LINE still locks calories/protein/programme/floors — surplus is intentional, not chaos.
- [ ] Review date in 4–6 weeks written on the calendar.
- [ ] Rule: if waist climbs faster than strength and limb fullness, return to STRIP/recomp without drama.

What the exception is not

- Permission to dirty bulk because you “feel small.”
- Permission to skip tracking.
- Permission to avoid progressive overload and blame genetics.
- A personality.

Month sketch if exception is valid: Month 1 short “stop undereating” + hard LINE → Months 2–12 patient LIFT with waist watched → insert short STRIP polish only if softness creeps in.

CHAOS / TRAVEL / SICK SOPS

Life will try to delete your plan. Pre-decide the minimum so Thursday-you cannot invent ethics in a hotel bar.

Bad-week MED plan (still “on programme”)

Lever	Minimum effective dose
Training	Stage 5C MED sessions: key compounds only, shorter time
Protein	Hit the gram target even if food is boring / repetitive
Calories	Keep the weekly average intent; do not “save” then binge
Steps	Floor, not fantasy — walks count
Sleep	Protect the minimum on as many nights as possible
Forbidden	Inventing a new split at 11 p.m.; starting a detox; zeroing the plan until “next Monday”

Travel SOP

- [ ] Before you leave: know hotel/gym access or bodyweight/DB alternatives from Stage 5C
- [ ] Protein defaults packed or located (bars, sachets, shops near the site)
- [ ] Step floor stays; sightseeing walks are training assistants
- [ ] Log in the app the same day — memory fails on trips
- [ ] Social meals: estimate, pick protein-first plates, return to plan next meal
- [ ] If training days must drop: hit 2 quality sessions rather than 0, then resume home template without rewrite

Sick SOP

- [ ] If febrile / acute illness: train less or not at all; sleep; protein as appetite allows; drop the hero story
- [ ] Resume with MED sessions for several days — do not PR the first day back
- [ ] Do not “make up” all missed sessions in 72 hours
- [ ] Extend the phase by the sick days; do not panic-cut to compensate
- [ ] If illness lasts >1–2 weeks, redo a mini Week 0 (waist/photos optional refresh) and continue

Overtime / kids / shift-work SOP

- [ ] Calendar the sessions first; accessories are optional, compounds are not

- [ ] Default meals beat inspiration
- [ ] LINK check-in can be three lines on your phone
- [ ] Use PPLU or 3-day if PPL is fantasy this roster cycle — that is LINE intelligence, not quitting

Fatherhood + brutal hours (the real constraint story)

STRIPLINE was written for people who do **not** have unlimited gym time. Stage 4's why-me is blunt on purpose: transformation under **fatherhood** and **~70-hour construction weeks** — not a content-creator calendar. If your week looks like site/ overtime/ school runs/ bedtime negotiations, you are not behind the method. You are the method's intended user.

What survives that kind of week:

- **Locked sessions that fit the calendar** — early, after shift, or lunch. Duration can shrink; the written day does not vanish.
- **Protein defaults** that don't need a perfect kitchen every night — same breakfast, packed lunch, boring dinner that still hits grams.
- **LINK that still asks** when Thursday-you wants to negotiate — a mate or the soft coaching door when it opens: **[PLACEHOLDER: paid offer / coach funnel — pending agreement]**.
- **MED before zero** — a shortened compounds-only session keeps the identity alive after a twelve-hour day; a cancelled month does not.

What dies on that calendar: programme-hopping, chef-level meal prep as a personality, and "I'll start when life calms down." Life rarely calms down. LINE is how you train inside the noise.

Use the sample week below as a template — swap site for office crunch, swap kids' sport for shift work — keep the structure.

Sample: construction / long-day week (STRIP)

Day	Training	Food note	Steps
Mon	PPLU Push after work or early	Packed lunch protein locked	Floor
Tue	Pull	Same breakfast default	Floor
Wed	Rest / walk	Protein target only non-negotiable if overtime wrecks cooking	Floor+

Day	Training	Food note	Steps
Thu	Legs	Carbs around session if energy low	Floor
Fri	Upper or MED if smashed	Social meal budgeted	Floor
Sat	Optional walk; catch missed session only if recovered	Average the week	Floor
Sun	Prep defaults; LINK send	Grocery + cook once	Easy

If six-day PPL keeps dying on this calendar, **LINE says switch to PPLU** — that is intelligence, not weakness.

Sample: travel conference (4 days away)

- Day before: MED home session; pack protein sachets; download offline food entries if your app allows.
- Away days: 2× full-body hotel sessions OR 1× hard + steps heavy.
- Tracking: estimate restaurant meals the same night; do not "start again Monday."
- Home day 1 back: normal template loads if you feel well; else MED.

Alcohol rule (all phases)

Alcohol counts in the weekly average. Budget it. Do not build identity around purity theatre *or* nightly obliteration. In a deep STRIP phase, frequent heavy drinking fights waist goals — that is physics, not morality. Log it and decide with the scoreboard.

LINK: WHAT TO SEND EACH WEEK (TEMPLATE)

Copy/paste to your accountability person (or future coaching funnel when live):

```
Week of:
Sessions hit: __ / __
Protein days: __ / 7
Step-floor days: __ / 7
Sleep-floor nights: __ / 7
Waist:
Hunger/energy (one line):
```

```
One win:
One risk next week:
Lever change (if any): none / steps / kcal / sleep / training =
```

If you do not have a person yet, send it to yourself in a dated note — and keep the soft door in mind: **[PLACEHOLDER: paid offer / coach funnel — pending agreement]**.

BRIDGE TO STAGE 5B AND STAGE 5C

You now have the year on rails. Two specialist chapters install the meters and the sessions:

Stage 5B — Calories, Macros & Tracking

What calories do in STRIP vs LIFT, how to set protein/carbs/fats, how to track like an adult with a job, busy-day defaults, alcohol, eating out, and when to simplify to calories + protein.
Start numbers here: https://yehbro.com/food-bro/ → paste into your app → run weekly averages → bring results back to this chapter's review script.

Stage 5C — PPL & PPLU

The default STRIPLINE programmes: Push/Pull/Legs and Push/Pull/Legs/Upper, plus the 3-day fallback, effort/RIR rules, progression, deloads, and logging.
LINE means: pick one template tomorrow, write it, lift it, log it.

After 5B and 5C

Stage 6 turns the system into this week's first actions, FAQ landmines, and the soft next step if you want more accountability: **[PLACEHOLDER: paid offer / coach funnel — pending agreement]**.

The Year Logbook appendix (later) is where you print checklists and fill pages for all twelve months — photos, waist, sessions, reviews — so Month 12 compares to Month 1 with receipts, not nostalgia.

How the three chapters work in one week

1. **This morning (5A):** confirm which month you are in and which phase bias applies.
2. **Food (5B):** hit the targets; log; use Food Bro if numbers are not set — **https://yehbro.com/food-bro/**
3. **Training (5C):** run today's PPL/PPLU session; log loads.

4. **Tonight (5A):** adherence tick-boxes; LINK lines if it is check-in day.
5. **Every fourth week (5A):** full review script + one-lever rule.

Print / save list

- [ ] This chapter's Week 0/1 checklists
- [ ] Food Bro PDF
- [ ] Stage 5C programme page for your template
- [ ] Four-week review template
- [ ] LINK weekly paste template
- [ ] Year Logbook pages when available

Action now: finish Week 0 if you have not. Put the first review date in the calendar. Open 5B for numbers and 5C for the template. Then run Month 1 like an adult with a plan — not like someone collecting another PDF.

Calories, Macros & Tracking (Nutrition System)

Food is not a personality. It's the metering system for fat loss and muscle growth.

If you lift hard and eat like the goal is optional, your body shrugs. If you obsess over meal timing while your weekly calories are chaos, your body also shrugs — just with more spreadsheets.

This stage is the nutrition system for *The 12-Month Body*: what calories do in STRIP and LIFT, how to set protein/carbs/fats without cult behaviour, how to track like an adult with a real job, and how to eat when the day is twelve hours long and dinner is whatever is left in the fridge.

Keep Stage 2's sequence in your head. STRIPLINE decides the phase. This chapter decides the numbers and the logistics.

WHAT CALORIES ARE — AND HOW THEY MAP TO STRIP VS LIFT

A calorie is a unit of energy. Your body takes energy in (food and drink) and spends energy out (basal metabolism, digestion, training, steps, fidgeting, stress, sleep debt, the lot). Over weeks, the relationship between average intake and average expenditure decides whether body mass trends down, holds, or climbs.

That is not a vibe. It is not "eating clean." Clean food can still overfeed you. Dirty food can still sit inside a deficit. Food quality matters for health, hunger, training performance, and whether you can stick the plan — but the fat-on-the-midsection lever is still **average energy balance**.

Maintenance

Maintenance is the average daily intake that keeps your trend weight roughly stable over a few weeks when training and steps are similar.

It is not one sacred number forever. It moves with:

- body size (bigger bodies usually burn more)
- muscle mass and training load

- daily steps / NEAT (non-exercise activity — pottering, pacing, standing, fidgeting)
- sleep and stress
- how aggressive the previous phase was

Treat maintenance as a **working estimate**, then let the scale trend and photos referee it.

A useful mental model: maintenance is a **range**, not a laser line. Two weeks at ±100 kcal around the true average often look like "holding." That is why tiny daily obsessing is wasted effort and weekly averages are the grown-up tool.

Why the scale lies short-term (and why you still use it)

Use the scale. Do not worship it.

Short-term weight shifts come from:

- **Glycogen + water** — carbs and hard training pull water into muscle; low-carb days dump some of it
- **Sodium and restaurant meals** — hold extra water without adding fat overnight
- **Gut content** — high-fibre days and big meals sit on the scale
- **Inflammation / soreness** — heavy lower-body sessions can bump morning weight
- **Hormonal cycle** (where relevant) — water retention patterns across the month
- **Stress and sleep** — cortisol/sleep debt can change water handling and hunger

Fat loss still shows up as a **downward trend** across weeks when the deficit is real. Fat gain still shows up as an **upward trend** when the surplus is real. Your job is to stop treating a single weigh-in like a court verdict.

Practical weigh-in protocol:

1. Same conditions most mornings (after bathroom, before food/drink, similar clothing).
2. Record the number without emotional commentary.
3. Average the week.
4. Compare week-to-week averages alongside photos and waist.

Deficit (STRIP default)

A **deficit** means average intake sits below what you need to hold weight. Fat loss requires this over time. STRIP is fat-loss-first for anyone carrying meaningful fat or skinny-fat softness — so most readers start here.

Practical starting point for many busy adults:

Phase intent	Starting calorie adjustment
STRIP fat loss	~**300–500 kcal/day** below estimated maintenance
Larger bodies / faster early drop (if hunger and training hold)	sometimes nearer **-500 to -700**, then moderate
Too aggressive (strength collapsing, misery, adherence dying)	raise calories; heroics are not a strategy

Expect noisy weeks. Water, glycogen, salt, gut content, training soreness, and hormones move the scale more than fat does day to day. Judge the **weekly average**, photos, waist, and strength — not Tuesday morning panic.

STRIP still wants **high protein** and progressive lifting. The goal is not "smaller soft person." The goal is less fat while you keep (and ideally improve) the muscle signal.

How aggressive should the deficit be? Aggressive enough that photos change over a month. Gentle enough that you can still train, sleep, work, and not hate your life. If your only personality trait on a cut becomes irritability and skipped sessions, you did not find discipline — you found a deficit that is too deep for your current recovery budget.

STRIP calorie reality checks:

- Early weeks often drop faster (water/glycogen). Do not assume that rate continues.
- If waist and photos improve while scale weight stalls briefly, you may be recomposing or holding water — stay the course before slashing again.
- If strength is free-falling and workouts are junk for two weeks, raise food or cut volume before you "add more cardio punishment."

Surplus (LIFT emphasis — when earned)

A **surplus** means average intake sits above maintenance so gaining tissue is easier. In STRIPLINE, this is not month-one cosplay for someone who still has a midsection story to finish. LIFT calories are earned when photos and adherence say the middle is ready enough — or when a true hardgainer exception was documented honestly.

Practical starting surplus for many:

Phase intent	Starting calorie adjustment
LIFT growth	~**200–400 kcal/day** above maintenance
Impatient dirty bulk	usually buys extra fat once a modest surplus already covers growth

Patience beats chaos. Soft ≠ failure if strength is climbing and you still have months on the clock. Aborting a growth phase at week eight because the mirror got slightly softer is how people stay forever small-soft and confused.

In a surplus, many people unconsciously move more (NEAT rises — pacing, fidgeting, general pottering). That means a chunk of "extra" calories does not always become fat one-for-one. Still: do not use NEAT as an excuse to eat like a hardgainer meme and wonder why nothing happens. Track steps so the silent changes are visible.

LIFT calorie reality checks:

- Aim for slow scale drift upward over weeks, not a revenge bulk.
- Keep protein high so the surplus has somewhere useful to go.
- If waist is racing ahead of strength for several weeks, trim 100–200 kcal.
- Appetite can be a skill — scheduled feeds and liquid calories help when chewing becomes the bottleneck.

Near-maintenance / recomp

Some stretches sit near maintenance: skill-building weeks, transitions between STRIP and LIFT, or skinny-fat phases where protein, lifting, and steps do the quiet work while scale weight barely moves. Photos and waist still matter more than the decimal on the scale.

Recomp is not magic and it is not an excuse to avoid deciding. It is a useful holding pattern when:

- you are new enough that muscle and fat can move usefully near maintenance
- you are bridging phases without chaos
- life stress says "do not open a deep deficit or surplus right now"

If you have a clear midsection problem and keep "recomping" for nine months with soft photos, you are usually just avoiding STRIP.

Quick map

Energy setting	STRIPLINE job	What “winning” looks like
Deficit	STRIP	Waist/photos improve; strength holds or rises slowly; adherence real
Maintenance ± nudge	Hold / recomp / transition	Composition improves without big scale drama
Surplus	LIFT (earned)	Strength and size climb; fat gain stays controlled

If you only remember one sentence: **calories set the phase; protein and training protect the look.**

Why weekly averages beat daily drama

Fat loss and fat gain are slow relative to water shifts. You can “gain” a kilo overnight from a salty takeaway and glycogen refill without gaining a kilo of fat. You can “lose” fast in week one of a cut mostly from glycogen and gut content.

So:

- Weigh most mornings (or several times per week) under similar conditions if the scale doesn’t wreck your head.
- Average the week.
- Pair that average with waist and photos every 2–4 weeks.
- Ask: is the midsection story moving the way STRIP or LIFT intends?

If the scale is a mental landmine for you, lean harder on waist + photos + how work trousers fit, and use weight less often. The goal is decision-quality data, not a daily emotional flogging.

NEAT — the silent calorie thief (and gift)

When you eat in a surplus, many people unconsciously move more: pacing, fidgeting, taking the stairs, pottering. When you diet hard, some people become quiet energy-savers without noticing — fewer steps, more sitting, less spontaneous movement.

That is why step targets matter in STRIP. They keep expenditure from silently collapsing while you cut food. In LIFT, endless cardio that erases a carefully built surplus is equally silly. Match

movement to the phase instead of collecting random punishment sessions.

PROTEIN, CARBS, AND FATS — WHAT THEY DO, AND PRACTICAL RANGES

Macros are the three big energy nutrients: protein, carbohydrate, and fat. Alcohol is the awkward fourth that still counts.

You do not need a PhD. You need a hierarchy you will not invert.

The hierarchy (memorise this)

1. **Average calories vs your needs** — deficit to lose fat (STRIP default), near-maintenance to recomp/hold, surplus when LIFT is earned.
2. **Protein** — high enough to support muscle in whatever phase you're in.
3. **Carbs and fats** — fill the rest in a way you can digest, train on, and repeat.
4. **Micronutrients, fibre, hydration** — health and adherence glue.
5. **Meal timing / food "rules"** — useful seasoning, rarely the main meal.

Most beginners invert this list. They buy a fat burner before they know if they're eating 1,800 or 3,800 by accident.

Protein

Protein supplies amino acids for repair and growth. In a deficit it helps you hold muscle and stay fuller. In a surplus it still matters — extra carbs do not replace it.

Practical daily band for resistance trainees:

> **~1.6–2.2 g of protein per kg of body weight per day**
> (about **0.7–1 g per lb** as a simple high heuristic)

Notes that keep this sane:

- If body weight is very high, use **goal weight** or an adjusted body weight so the target is achievable.
- In STRIP, lean toward the **higher end** of the band when hunger and retention need help.
- In LIFT, still hit a solid total; surplus carbs are fuel, not a protein substitute.

- Distribute across **3–5 feedings** if you can. Perfect timing is optional; **daily total is not**.

Protein powder is convenience food, not magic. Matched grams from yoghurt, meat, eggs, or powder do the same job for hitting the number.

Fats

Dietary fat supports hormone production, fat-soluble vitamins, cell membranes, and — bluntly — whether food tastes like something you'll eat for twelve months.

Loose practical band: ~0.6–1 g of fat per kg of body weight as a starting floor/ceiling guide for many people. Do not crush fats to zero to "make room for carbs." Do not flood fats so high that protein and training carbs get squeezed out of a modest calorie budget.

Choose mostly unsaturated sources you tolerate (olive oil, avocado, nuts, fatty fish) and keep room for foods you actually enjoy. Exact split can flex with preference.

Carbohydrates

Carbs fill glycogen, support hard training, and are often the easiest lever for energy once protein and fats are set. Fruit, potatoes, rice, oats, bread, pasta — none of these are morally superior or evil. They are tools.

Practical rule after protein and fats are set:

> Calories remaining ÷ 4 ≈ carbohydrate grams for the day.

Bias more carbs around hard training sessions if performance feels better that way. On rest days you can keep carbs similar for simplicity, or nudge them down slightly if it helps hunger control in STRIP — consistency beats clever micro-timing.

Putting macros into one picture

Once calories and protein are locked, fats and carbs are mostly preference + performance:

Situation	Bias that often helps
Hard lower-body / high-volume training days	More carbs around the session

Situation	Bias that often helps
Very low appetite in LIFT	Liquid carbs/milk, fruit, rice; keep protein non-negotiable
STRIP hunger loud at night	Save a satisfying protein + carb dinner; don't "save" all food for 9 p.m. chaos
Digestion issues with high fat	Lower fat toward ~0.6 g/kg; raise carbs
Digests fats well, hates huge rice portions	Raise fats toward ~1 g/kg; carbs fill less

There is no trophy for the most complicated split. The trophy is still hitting the weekly average twelve months from now.

Micronutrients without becoming a supplement catalogue

Hit most of this from food:

- colourful plants across the week
- some dairy or fortified alternative if you tolerate it
- fish a couple of times a week when possible (or discuss omega-3 options later in the tools section of the book)
- iodised salt / normal varied meals rather than fear of every mineral

Supplements can fill gaps. They do not excuse a diet of three foods and hope. Creatine and basics belong in the tools conversation later; here, food structure comes first.

Fibre, veggies, hydration

These are not optional "health fluff." Fibre and high-volume vegetables make STRIP hunger manageable. Water makes everything less miserable. If your diet is only protein shakes and dry chicken with no plants, expect constipation, cravings, and a mood that belongs in a parking-fine queue.

A practical hydration default for many adults is drinking enough that urine is pale most of the day — more in heat, on site, or in hard training — without turning yourself into a water-chugging mascot. Pair sodium and fluids like a normal eater, not a chemistry experiment, unless a coach or clinician has you on a specific protocol **[PLACEHOLDER: coach-specific detail]**.

Alcohol

Alcohol is energy. Rough guide many people use: ~**7 kcal per gram**, before mixers. It also lowers inhibition, wrecks sleep for some people, and turns "I'll estimate" into "I forgot three drinks." Budget it. Log it. Don't build your identity around purity theatre *or* nightly obliteration.

If you drink, prefer a planned number inside the weekly calorie average over a surprise blackout of logging. Beer and sugary mixers add up fast; spirits with zero/low-cal mixers are easier to budget — still not free.

HOW TO SET YOUR NUMBERS — STEP BY STEP

No mysticism. Estimate → choose phase → run → review.

Step 1 — Get a maintenance estimate

Pick one starter method (both are fine):

Method A — calculator + humility
Enter your stats into a reputable TDEE/calorie estimator (or the metering tool in the next section). Treat the output as a **guess**, not a prophecy.

Method B — reverse engineer from real life
Track intake honestly for **10–14 days** while eating "normally." Average daily calories. Watch weekly average weight. If weight is roughly flat, that intake is near maintenance. If weight is rising or falling, adjust the estimate accordingly.

Many people do A to start, then correct with B within two to four weeks.

Step 2 — Choose the phase (STRIPLINE decides)

Your situation	Default calorie setting
Meaningful fat to lose / skinny-fat soft middle	**STRIP deficit**
Midsection ready enough; adherence high; ready to grow	**LIFT surplus** (earned)
Transition, skill block, or honest recomp stretch	**Near maintenance**

Your situation	Default calorie setting
True hardgainer with low fat and poor appetite	Document the exception; often a patient surplus — not “dirty bulk because impatient”

Write the daily calorie target in your logbook. Round to something you can hit (±50–100 kcal is normal noise).

Step 3 — Set protein first

1. Choose body weight or adjusted/goal weight in kg.
2. Multiply by **1.6–2.2**.
3. Write the gram target.
4. Build meals that make that number boringly inevitable.

Example band for an 85 kg trainee: roughly **136–187 g protein/day**. Pick a number in that band you can hit on workdays.

Step 4 — Set fats, then fill carbs

1. Set fats around **0.6–1 g/kg** (loose).
2. Convert protein and fat grams to calories (protein × 4, fat × 9).
3. Subtract from daily calorie target.
4. Remaining calories ÷ 4 = carbohydrate grams.

If the carb number looks tiny and you train hard, nudge fats down within the band rather than nuking protein.

Step 5 — Run 2–4 weeks before rewriting your life

Change one big lever at a time. Hit the targets. Lift. Sleep enough to function. Walk.

Then review:

Signal	Likely move
Losing faster than ~0.5–1% body weight/week with strength crashing	Eat more

Signal	Likely move
Scale stuck 2–3+ weeks, photos soft, adherence honest	Trim ~100–200 kcal or raise steps
Scale stuck but photos/waist better	Often stay the course
Soft photos + weight ripping up in LIFT	Trim surplus
Strength up, slight softness, still early in earned LIFT	Patience

[PLACEHOLDER: coach-specific detail — exact weekly loss/gain rate targets, check-in cadence, and adjustment rules if following a particular coaching desk]

Step 6 — Don't ego-flip phases

STRIP fails when people "reward" three good weeks with an unplanned surplus weekend festival, then panic-diet harder. LIFT fails when people abort at the first soft mirror photo. Give the phase enough runway that the data means something.

A one-page setup you can actually finish tonight

Open your notes app or workbook and write:

1. Phase: STRIP / hold / LIFT
2. Estimated maintenance: _____ kcal
3. Daily calorie target: _____ kcal
4. Protein target: _____ g
5. Fat target (optional if simplifying): _____ g
6. Carb target (optional if simplifying): _____ g
7. Review date (14–28 days out): _____
8. Photo reminder set: yes / no

If those eight lines are blank, you do not have a nutrition plan yet. You have a vibe.

YEH BRO FOOD BRO — METER YOUR NUMBERS

Guessing forever is how people stay soft, stuck, or accidentally underfed while "eating clean."

Use **Yeh Bro Food Bro** as your metering companion:

https://yehbro.com/food-bro/

Enter your stats and download a **free tailored PDF** with cut, maintain, or lean-bulk style targets. Paste those numbers into your workbook. Then run them.

What it is:

- a practical way to get starting calories/macros without staring at a blank page
- a free PDF you can reopen on your phone between sets or on site

What it is not:

- a replacement for STRIPLINE sequencing (fat-loss-first still comes first when you need it)
- a substitute for weekly averages, photos, and honest logging
- permission to ignore protein because the PDF looked tidy

If the PDF and your real-world trend disagree after two to four weeks, reality wins. Adjust. That is the system working — not the calculator failing.

HOW TO TRACK — STEP BY STEP

Tracking is literacy, not a personality transplant. You are learning what portions actually are. Most people are shocked in week one. That shock is useful.

If tracking food is psychologically rough because of a disordered eating history, get professional support and use a gentler method (portion frameworks, plate method, coach-guided structure). This book is not a substitute for that care.

1) Get a kitchen scale

Digital, grams, cheap is fine. Put it on the bench. Leave it there. A scale you have to dig out of a drawer will not get used on a twelve-hour day.

2) Weigh food the useful way

- Weigh **raw** meats consistently *or* cooked consistently — pick a method and stick to it so the database matches.

- Weigh calorie-dense foods that are easy to underestimate: oils, peanut butter, cheese, nuts, dressings, butter.
- Vegetables can be looser once you know your pattern; oils cannot.
- “A drizzle” is often two tablespoons. Two tablespoons is not a drizzle. The scale ends the debate.

Raw vs cooked tip: 100 g raw chicken is not 100 g cooked chicken. If your app entry says “chicken breast, raw,” weigh it raw. If it says cooked, weigh cooked. Mixing those up is a classic silent error that makes people think maths is broken when their method is.

3) Read labels without getting conned

- Check **serving size** before the pretty front of pack.
- Note whether numbers are per 100 g or per serving.
- Liquids and “health” bars still count.
- When cooking mixed dishes, weigh ingredients in, then portion the finished meal by weight if you need accuracy.

Example: a “healthy” granola can be denser than cake once you measure the bowl you actually pour. Front-of-pack marketing is not a macro entry. The nutrition panel is.

4) Pick one logging app and stop shopping for apps

Any decent food logger works if you use it. Search the database carefully (brand + exact product). Save frequent meals as favourites or recipes so busy days take thirty seconds, not thirty minutes.

Build a personal library in week one:

- your default breakfast
- two work lunches
- two dinners
- your usual shake
- your usual coffee milk amount

After that, most days are tap-tap-done. Tracking should become boring. Boring is the point.

5) Log as you go — especially the “harmless” bits

Coffee milk. Sauce. Weekend nibbles. The bite of whatever your kids left. Unlogged food is how people swear they eat 1,900 while maintaining at 2,600.

If you hate logging at dinner time, log earlier feeds during the day and only finish the last meal at night. The open loop of "I'll add it later" is where entire evenings disappear.

6) Use weekly calorie averages — not daily panic

Daily intake will swing. Training days, rest days, social meals, travel. That is normal.

Do this instead:

1. Log daily.
2. At week's end, average the seven days.
3. Compare average intake to your target.
4. Compare weekly average weight (or 7-day trend) plus photos/waist/strength.

One high day does not ruin a cut. One low day does not make you "disciplined." Trends do.

A clean way to think about it: if your target is 2,300 kcal, a week that lands at ~16,100 total (~2,300/day average) is on target even if Wednesday was 2,800 and Thursday was 1,900. Chase the week, not a perfect straight line.

7) Rest days

You still need protein. Calories can match training days for simplicity, or sit slightly lower if it helps STRIP hunger — **[PLACEHOLDER: coach-specific detail]** on exact rest-day carb protocol if you use one. What matters is that rest days are logged, not treated as free space outside the dataset.

Rest days are also where "I earned a blowout because I trained hard yesterday" turns into quiet maintenance. Keep the structure. Keep protein. Keep walking if STRIP is the job.

8) Eating out — estimate like an adult

You will not weigh restaurant risotto on a date night. Good.

- Prioritise a protein main.
- Assume oil and sauces are more generous than home cooking.
- Log a best-estimate entry the same day (search similar meals; slightly overestimate rather than pretend it was steamed air).

- Return to precision at home. One estimated meal inside a tracked week still teaches you more than a month of “I’ll be good later.”

Fast-food rule of thumb: use the chain’s published numbers when available. Local café rule of thumb: pick a similar generic entry and add a buffer for oil. Pride about precise restaurant macros is usually fake precision. Directionally honest beats delusionally exact.

9) Alcohol budgeting

Decide before the first drink:

- How many drinks?
- What are they (beer, wine, spirits + mixer)?
- What food will you cut or keep to stay near the weekly average?

Log the drinks. If sleep and training quality fall apart every time you drink, that is data — not a moral lecture.

A simple budget method: keep protein hit, reduce carbs/fats earlier in the day by roughly the drink calories, and stop when the planned number is done. “I’ll see how I feel” is how weekly averages get ambushed.

10) When to simplify to calories + protein only

Full macro theatre helps some people. It makes others quit by Thursday.

Simplify to calories + protein when:

- tracking all three macros is killing adherence
- you’re competent enough that fats/carbs flex without chaos
- life load spiked (new baby, overtime, travel) and you need the minimum viable dashboard

Hit calories. Hit protein. Let carbs and fats fill the rest from foods you tolerate. That pair alone outperforms “I eat pretty clean” memory every time.

Simplifying is not failing. Quitting tracking entirely because you tried to micromanage every gram of fat on a fourteen-hour shift — that is the failure mode this rule prevents.

Tracking quality checklist

Habit	Pass / fail
Scale on the bench	
Protein logged every day	
Oils/nut butters weighed	
Weekly average reviewed	
Photos every 2–4 weeks	
Weekend logged like weekdays	
Eating-out estimates logged same day	
One app, not three abandoned downloads	

MEAL STRUCTURE, DEFAULT FOODS, AND BUSY-DAY PATTERNS

You do not need seven different gourmet dinners. You need repeatable feeds that hit protein without requiring a chef and a silent kitchen.

3–5 feeds per day

Most people do well with **three to five** eating occasions. Examples:

Three-feed day (simple)
1. Breakfast — protein + carbs
2. Lunch — protein + carbs + veg
3. Dinner — protein + carbs + veg
(+ optional protein snack if the daily total is short)

Four-feed day (common workday)
1. Breakfast
2. Mid-morning or post-training feed
3. Lunch
4. Dinner

Five-feed day (high protein / long days)
Add a yoghurt, shake, or meat-and-fruit snack between larger meals so you're not trying to force 180 g of protein into two sittings.

There is no moral prize for intermittent fasting or for six tiny meals. Pick the structure that fits your shifts, digestion, and hunger.

Default high-protein foods (build your roster)

Rotate what you actually like:

Category	Easy defaults
Meat / poultry	Chicken thigh or breast, lean beef mince, turkey, steak when budget allows
Fish	Tinned tuna/salmon, frozen fish fillets
Dairy / alternatives	Greek yoghurt, cottage cheese, high-protein milk drinks, cheese in measured amounts
Eggs	Whole eggs, egg whites if you need volume
Convenience	Rotisserie chicken, pre-cooked chicken, quality deli turkey, protein powder/whey or alternative
Plant-forward adds	Tofu, tempeh, lentils/beans alongside animal protein if you like them

Carb and plant defaults

- Rice, potatoes, sweet potatoes, oats, bread, wraps, pasta
- Fruit you will actually eat
- Frozen mixed veg, bagged salad, broccoli, carrots — boring on purpose

Grocery patterns that survive real life

Shop like a systems person:

1. **Protein first** on the list (enough for 3–4 days minimum).
2. **Carb staples** in bulk (rice, oats, potatoes).
3. **Frozen veg** so “no fresh produce” is not an excuse.
4. **Emergency protein** (tins, yoghurt tubs, powder) for the day everything goes wrong.
5. Same breakfast five days a week is a **feature**, not a failure of creativity.

Optional add-ons that save adherence:

- pre-washed salad kits (watch the dressing calories)
- microwave rice pouches for true disaster days
- a dedicated “site snack box” that always lives in the work bag

If you only shop when the fridge is empty and you’re already hungry, you will buy chaos. Shop on a schedule. Hunger is a terrible procurement officer.

Busy-day / construction / long-shift defaults

When the day starts early and finishes filthy:

- **Cook once, pack twice:** night-before rice + chicken + veg in two containers.
- **Cold options:** Greek yoghurt tubs, fruit, wraps with turkey/chicken, boiled eggs, ready-to-drink protein if it helps.
- **Site-friendly:** foods that don’t need a microwave drama; ice brick in the esky/cooler bag.
- **Post-shift anchor:** a default dinner you can assemble half-asleep (rotisserie + microwave potato + frozen veg + yoghurt).
- **Missed lunch protocol:** do not “start tomorrow.” Hit protein with a shake + whatever solid food you can get; log it; move on.
- **Overtime protocol:** if the day runs long, keep a shelf-stable backup (tuna + crackers, protein bars you actually tolerate, powder + shaker) so the only option is not the servo pie plus regret.

Parents get an extra constraint: kid food in the house. That does not ban biscuits from the planet. It means your defaults are pre-decided so their snacks are not automatically your dinner. Measured shares beat “I’ll just have a bit” amnesia.

[PLACEHOLDER: paid offer / coach funnel — pending agreement]

You do not need a perfect kitchen. You need a protein plan that still works when the day is ugly.

Sample day shapes (illustrative — not prescriptions)

STRIP-leaning workday (~protein-first)
- Breakfast: oats + Greek yoghurt + berries
- Lunch: chicken, rice, mixed veg
- Snack: whey shake + apple

- Dinner: lean mince, potatoes, salad
- Optional: cottage cheese if protein short

Long-shift day
- Cooler: two chicken wraps, yoghurt, fruit, shake bottle
- Dinner: rotisserie chicken, microwave rice, frozen veg
- Late: yoghurt or shake if the total is short

LIFT-leaning higher-carb day
- Same protein anchors
- Bigger rice/potato portions around training
- Extra milk/fruit if appetite is the limiter

Adjust portions to *your* calorie target. The pattern matters more than copying someone else's plate photo.

HUNGER MANAGEMENT IN STRIP, SOCIAL MEALS, AND COMMON MISTAKES

STRIP hunger is real. Pretending you can white-knuckle misery for forty weeks is how people rebound into chaos.

Hunger management that actually helps

- **High protein** at every feed.
- **High-volume veg** and fruit for chew and fullness.
- **Potatoes and other satisfying carbs** beat living on sad salad energy.
- **Diet soft drinks / coffee / tea** (within your caffeine-sleep trade-offs) as tools, not personality.
- **Steps** — walk more; it helps expenditure and often mood.
- **Sleep** — short sleep makes hunger louder and adherence dumber.
- **Keep tasty foods in the plan** in measured amounts so you are not building a forbidden-food explosion for Saturday.
- **Protein desserts** (yoghurt + cocoa, high-protein pudding hacks) when sweet cravings show up.

Hunger has flavours. Learn which one you're dealing with:

Feeling	Often means	Better move
Empty + shaky + obsessed	Deficit too deep, carbs too low, or long gap between feeds	Bring a feed forward; raise calories if persistent
Bored mouth / “want something”	Habit, stress, salt/crunch craving	High-volume crunchy veg, gum, tea, planned snack
Night raiding	Under-ate earlier, poor dinner protein, sleep debt	Bigger daytime protein + solid dinner; protect bedtime
Post-alcohol hunger	Disinhibition + poor sleep	Plan drinks; protein-first next morning; no spiral

If hunger is unbearable and training is falling apart, your deficit is too aggressive or your food selection is too low-volume. Fix the inputs. Suffering is not proof of progress.

Social meals without blowing the week

- Eat protein-forward; enjoy the occasion; estimate and log.
- Front-load the week with tighter adherence if you know a big dinner is coming — or just accept one higher day inside a solid weekly average.
- Do not “earn” social meals with punishment cardio cosplay that ruins recovery.
- Do not turn one dinner into a four-day off-plan spiral. The spiral is the problem, not the steak.

Family BBQs, work lunches, and kids’ leftovers are part of adult life. The skill is staying in the weekly average without becoming the person who brings a tub of weighed chicken to every event — unless that is genuinely your preference and your social life can handle it. Most people do better with flexible estimation plus a strong home baseline.

Common mistakes

Mistake	What it costs you	Fix
Tracking weekdays, “forgetting” weekends	Fake deficit; stalled fat loss	Log Friday–Sunday like they count — because they do
Cutting protein to make carbs/fats fit aesthetics	Soft, hungry, weaker	Lock protein first

Mistake	What it costs you	Fix
Changing calorie target every three days	Noise, no signal	Run 2–4 weeks
Oil/peanut butter “eyeballing”	Hundreds of hidden kcal	Weigh the dense stuff
Dirty bulk as month-one identity	Extra fat, then a miserable cut	Earn LIFT; use a modest surplus
Zero fun foods → binge cycle	Adherence collapse	Budget foods you like
Scale-only judgement	Bad phase flips	Photos + waist + strength
App-hopping and plan-hopping	Zero skill built	One logger, one phase
Cardio punishment to erase logging gaps	Recovery debt	Budget honestly instead
Copying someone else’s macros	Wrong size, wrong job, wrong phase	Set from *your* weight and STRIPLINE phase

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WORKED EXAMPLE — FICTIONAL COMPOSITE (NOT AN AUTHOR CLAIM)

Meet **Alex** — a composite trainee for teaching maths, not a real person and not a testimonial.

- Age ~30s
- Body weight **92 kg**
- Desk + physical job mix, lifts 4 days/week
- Soft midsection; wants athletic lean, not skinny
- STRIPLINE call: **STRIP first**

1) Maintenance estimate

Food Bro / calculator guess lands near **2,700 kcal** maintenance. Alex treats it as a start.

2) STRIP calories

Start at **2,700 − 400 = 2,300 kcal/day**.

3) Protein

92 kg × **2.0 g/kg** ≈ **184 g protein** (chosen toward the higher end for a cut).
Calories from protein: 184 × 4 = **736 kcal**.

4) Fats

92 × **0.8 g/kg** ≈ **74 g fat**.
Calories from fat: 74 × 9 = **666 kcal**.

5) Carbs fill the rest

Remaining calories: 2,300 − 736 − 666 = **898 kcal**.
Carbs: 898 ÷ 4 ≈ **225 g carbs**.

Alex's starting targets:
~2,300 kcal · ~184 g protein · ~74 g fat · ~225 g carbs

6) Two-week review (illustrative)

- Weekly average weight down ~0.4–0.6 kg/week
- Strength holding on main lifts
- Sleep OK; hunger manageable with high-volume dinners

Decision: **stay the course**. No hero cut to 1,800 because a mate said "real cutting starts under two grand."

7) Six weeks later (illustrative)

Photos tighter through the waist; weight progress slowed for 2.5 weeks while adherence stayed honest. Alex trims to ~**2,150–2,200 kcal**, keeps protein ~180+ g, and raises daily steps. Progress resumes without wrecking gym performance.

8) Example meal sketch at those targets (one possible day)

Not a meal plan you must copy — just proof the numbers can land in ordinary food:

Feed	Example	Rough role
Breakfast	200 g Greek yoghurt, 60 g oats, berries	Protein + carbs
Lunch	180 g cooked chicken, 200 g cooked rice, big mixed veg, 1 tsp oil	Protein + carbs
Snack	Whey shake in water + apple	Protein fill
Dinner	200 g lean beef mince, 300 g potato, salad, measured dressing	Protein + carbs + volume
Optional	Cottage cheese if protein short	Top-up

Alex adjusts portion sizes until the logger says the day is near 2,300 / 184 P. Same template, different scoop sizes — that is meal planning without a personality cult.

9) Later transition thought-experiment

When photos say the middle is ready and adherence has been high for months, Alex would nudge toward maintenance, then a small **+200–300** surplus for LIFT — not a revenge bulk. That decision is earned by the mirror and the logbook, not by boredom.

On a later LIFT pass, the same bodyweight maths might look like maintenance rediscovered near ~2,500–2,600 after the cut, then **~2,800** calories with protein still ~170–180 g and carbs carrying most of the surplus. Waist watched monthly. Surplus trimmed if softness outruns strength.

Second composite snapshot — smaller frame, same process

Sam (also fictional): 70 kg, mostly sedentary job, new to lifting, skinny-fat.

- Maintenance estimate ~**2,100 kcal**
- STRIP start: **1,700–1,800 kcal**
- Protein: 70 × 2.0 ≈ **140 g**
- Fats: ~**50–60 g**
- Carbs: fill remaining calories

Sam's trap would be copying Alex's 2,300 kcal cut and calling it "not enough food." Different body, different job, different maintenance. Same process. Different outputs.

Your numbers will differ. The **process** should not: estimate → phase → protein → fill → review on a schedule.

[PLACEHOLDER: coach-specific detail — if using a coach's spreadsheet or check-in template, paste targets there and follow their adjustment rules]

YOUR ACTION CHECKLIST FOR THIS WEEK

1. Enter your stats at **https://yehbro.com/food-bro/** and save the free PDF.
2. Write calorie + protein targets in your workbook (carbs/fats optional if you're simplifying).
3. Put the kitchen scale on the bench.
4. Build **three default breakfasts** and **three default lunches/dinners** that hit protein.
5. Grocery shop the anchors.
6. Log **seven days**, including the messy ones.
7. Schedule photos in 14–28 days.
8. Do not change the plan because one weigh-in annoyed you.

Do that, and nutrition stops being a mystery religion. It becomes a metering skill.

BRIDGE INTO STAGE 5C — TRAINING PROGRAMMES

Calories and macros decide whether fat leaves or size arrives. They do not replace the training stimulus.

Next up is Stage 5C: the lifting system — how to structure the week so progressive overload is boringly inevitable. You'll lock a programme template that fits real calendars (including practical push/pull/legs style splits), train hard enough that sets count, and stop collecting polite workouts that look like a plan on paper and feel like cardio with dumbbells.

Food meters the phase. Training builds the body the phase is meant to reveal.

Turn the page when your protein target is written down — not when you feel "ready." Ready is usually just another delay.

RECOMMENDED FOOD TRACKING APPS (STARTING DEFAULTS)

You can change these later. Pick one and stop shopping for apps.

Priority	App	Why it's here
Primary recommendation	**Cronometer**	Accurate database, clear micronutrient view if you want it, solid for weighing-and-logging beginners who hate junk entries
Strong alternative	**MyFitnessPal**	Huge barcode database (handy in AU shops), fast logging once you verify entries
Paid coaching-style option	**MacroFactor**	Excellent if you want algorithm-assisted calorie adjustments and will pay for it

Rule: one app for ≥8 weeks. Verify barcodes (especially MFP). Log oils. Use weekly averages.

Alternatives are fine if you already love another tracker — consistency beats brand. If you later standardise on a house favourite, treat this list as editable defaults (`[PLACEHOLDER: preferred food app]` only if you rip these out).

How to use with Food Bro: set targets at https://yehbro.com/food-bro/ → enter the same calories/protein as goals in your app → log daily → review weekly averages in Stage 5A reviews.

Exact Week-1 logging workflow (app + scale)

1. Download **Cronometer** (or your chosen alternative).
2. Create foods you eat weekly; prefer brand/verified entries.
3. Weigh proteins and calorie-dense fats on a kitchen scale for 14 days.
4. Log cooking oils — the silent surplus.
5. Every Sunday: export or screenshot weekly average calories + protein into the Year Logbook.
6. If logging anxiety spikes: switch mode to **calories + protein only** for two weeks (hide other macros).

FOUR EXAMPLE MACRO DAYS (COMPOSITE — NOT PRESCRIPTIONS)

Numbers are teaching examples for a fictional ~85 kg adult on ~2,200 kcal STRIP / ~2,600 kcal LIFT with ~170 g protein. **Your** numbers come from Food Bro + trend reviews — do not copy these calories blindly.

Example A — STRIP training day (~2,200 kcal, ~170 g protein)

Meal	Foods	~P	~Kcal
Breakfast	200 g Greek yoghurt, 40 g oats, berries, 1 scoop whey	55	420
Lunch	180 g chicken breast, 200 g cooked rice, mixed veg, 1 tsp oil	55	550
Snack	Apple + 20 g whey in water	20	180
Dinner	180 g lean mince, potatoes 250 g, salad, stock sauce	45	600
Evening	Cottage cheese 150 g	20	160
Total		**~195**	**~1,910–2,200** (oil/sauce variance)

Example B — STRIP hungry day (volume focus)

Bias: high-volume veg, lean proteins, potatoes, broth soups; keep oils measured. Same protein target; calories at bottom of range.

Example C — LIFT surplus day (~2,600 kcal)

Add: extra rice/oil on training meals, peanut butter on yoghurt, larger potato portion — still hit protein first.

Example D — long-shift / construction day

Strategy	Default
Meal 1	Yoghurt + whey + banana (prep in car)
Meal 2	Twin tuna packs + microwave rice
Meal 3	Rotisserie chicken + bag salad
Flex	Extra wrap if under protein

Eating-out estimation (60-second method)

1. Pick the protein portion (palm/deck of cards → estimate grams).
2. Starch: fist of rice/chips.
3. Oils/sauces: assume +1–2 tbsp if glossy.
4. Log a close custom meal; don't skip the day.
5. Next meal back on plan — no punishment.

Weekly calorie decision rules (copy into logbook)

Signal (2–4 weeks, adherence ≥80%)	Action
Waist down, strength OK	Hold
Waist stuck, photos soft	-100 to -200 kcal **or** +2–3k steps
Strength freefall + fatigue	+100 to +200 kcal; deload if needed
Weekends erase weekdays	Budget Thu–Sun; keep protein
Scale ↑ but waist ↓	Likely glycogen/water — hold

LABEL-READING WALKTHROUGH (AU SUPERMARKET)

1. Check **serving size** vs what you actually pour.
2. Protein per 100 g — compare lean meats/yoghurts.
3. Energy (kJ): divide by 4.184 for kcal approx if needed.
4. "No added sugar" ≠ low calorie.
5. Sauces: log a tablespoon weighed once, reuse that custom food.
6. Barcode scan → verify protein and calories aren't fantasy entries.

TROUBLESHOOTING MATRIX (USE IN REVIEWS)

Problem	Likely cause	Monday fix
Scale ↑, waist ↓	Glycogen/water/salt	Hold calories; trust waist/photos
Soft + kcal "on target"	Underreporting oils/weekends	Weigh oils 7 days; budget weekend

Problem	Likely cause	Monday fix
Strength crash in STRIP	Deficit too hard / sleep	+100–200 kcal; deload
Protein always short	No default breakfast	Lock yoghurt+whey breakfast
App fatigue	Too many macros	Calories+protein only 14 days
Hungry at night	Skipped protein early	Front-load protein

GROCERY PATTERNS THAT SURVIVE BUSY WEEKS

Cart A (high protein): chicken thighs/breast, eggs, Greek yoghurt, tuna, lean mince, whey.
Cart B (carbs): rice, oats, potatoes, fruit, bread.
Cart C (volume): frozen veg, salad kits, salsa.
Cart D (controlled fats): olive oil spray + measured oil, not free-pour.

Prep Sunday: cook 1–2 kg protein + rice trays → weekday LINE.

PROMISE & PLAYBOOK

STRIPLINE Programmes: PPL & PPLU

This is the training chapter you run, not the one you skim for vibes.

Stage 5 already told you the rules: progressive overload, hard-enough sets, log the work, protect recovery. This chapter installs the **default STRIPLINE programmes** — the templates you put on the calendar tomorrow morning.

Default recommendation (non-negotiable clarity):

Your reality	Default programme	Weekly shape
You can train **6 days** and recover (sleep mostly OK, stress manageable)	**PPL** — Push / Pull / Legs	PPL → rest or light day → PPL → rest
You can train **4 days** hard, or 6 days feels like fantasy	**PPLU** — Push / Pull / Legs / Upper	Four training days; three rest or step days
Life will not allow 4+ days this season	**3-day full body** (fallback)	Mon / Wed / Fri or any three non-adjacent days

Not "3–4 days vaguely." Pick one. Lock it for 8–12 weeks. Stop inventing a new split every Sunday night.

PPL and PPLU are the primary STRIPLINE programmes because they hit each major muscle roughly **twice per week**, keep sessions themed and short enough to finish, and scale from beginner to intermediate without rewriting the skeleton. The 3-day full-body plan is the honest backup when schedule or recovery says no.

If you still want someone else watching the logbook and calling the shots, that's fine later — [PLACEHOLDER: paid offer / coach funnel — pending agreement]. For now: write the days, lift the weights, eat for the phase.

What "default" means here

These templates are **evidence-aware defaults**: each major muscle hit about twice weekly when you run PPL or the Push+Upper pairing in PPLU; compounds first; accessories that actually progress; effort near failure without living in form collapse; progressive overload you can measure. They are not a secret private coach sheet photocopied into a book. Where an exact coached prescription would matter and we don't have clearance to invent one, you'll see a sparse placeholder — not a fake protocol dressed up as gospel.

Year one does not require novelty. It requires attendance, hard sets, and a logbook that proves next week was a little better than last week.

HOW TO CHOOSE: PPL VS PPLU VS 3-DAY

Choose PPL when

- You can guard **six training days** most weeks (construction, shift work, kids — if you've got the slots, use them).
- Sessions can be **45–70 minutes**.
- Sleep is mostly decent and you're not already living in a deep deficit crash.
- You like theme days: push day feels like push day.

Typical PPL week:

Day	Session
Mon	Push
Tue	Pull
Wed	Legs
Thu	Rest or long walk
Fri	Push
Sat	Pull
Sun	Legs

That's two full PPL cycles. Each muscle gets hit twice. Rest Thursday (or move the rest wherever life needs it). Don't skip Legs twice and call it "prioritising upper."

Choose PPLU when

- **Four hard days** is what you'll actually hit.
- Six days sounds heroic and you already know you'll ghost Fridays.
- You're in a hard STRIP deficit and six hard sessions leave you flat.
- You're newer and want slightly more recovery between hard lower-body days while still covering upper twice.

Typical PPLU week:

Day	Session
Mon	Push
Tue	Pull
Wed	Rest / steps
Thu	Legs
Fri	Upper
Sat	Rest / steps
Sun	Rest or optional easy walk

Push + Upper covers chest/shoulders/triceps twice. Pull covers back/bis. Legs once hard — and Upper still includes some rear-delt / upper-back work so the week doesn't feel half-empty. If you want legs twice on a four-day plan later, you can swap Upper for a second lower day — but **PPLU as written is the default four-day STRIPLINE template**.

Choose 3-day full body when

- You cannot protect four days.
- You're restarting after a long layoff and need practice without burying yourself.
- Travel, overtime, or childcare makes PPL/PPLU a lie this month.

Three hard full-body days beat six skipped half-sessions. Run it without shame. Upgrade when the calendar allows.

Recovery check (be honest)

If joints ache, sleep is wrecked, and every session is junk for two weeks straight — you don't need a fancier split. You need fewer hard sets, more food or sleep, or a MED week (below). Programme choice sits under recovery, not above it.

Real-life schedule examples (steal one)

Early shift / construction-style days: train after work three nights + weekend mornings for PPLU; or early AM short sessions for PPL if you've got the discipline and sleep isn't toast. If 4 a.m. wake-ups already exist, don't add hero PPL on five hours of sleep — pick PPLU.

Office / hybrid: Push Mon lunch, Pull Tue after work, Legs Thu morning, Upper Sat. Rest Wed/Fri/Sun. That's a clean PPLU.

Kids / evenings only: three weeknights + one weekend day. If a weeknight dies, the weekend becomes the make-up — not a free pass to skip the pattern.

Shift work: map the split to your **waking days**, not the calendar's Mon–Sun ego. Two Push / two Pull / two Legs across your work cycle for PPL; or four quality sessions across the roster for PPLU. Consistency of stimulus beats matching Instagram's week.

Travel month: run 3-day full body with hotel DBs / bands, or MED Push/Pull/Legs in 30–40 minutes. Resume the locked template when you land — don't "try a new split I saw."

Switching between PPL and PPLU mid-block

Allowed when life actually changes — not when you're bored.

- **Downgrade PPL → PPLU** if you miss two+ sessions per week for two weeks, or recovery collapses.
- **Upgrade PPLU → PPL** only after 4+ weeks of hitting all four days, sleep is fine, and you want more frequency — not because a mate trains six days.
- Keep as many **exercise selections** as you can when you switch so the logbook still means something.

SESSION STRUCTURE (EVERY TRAINING DAY)

Same skeleton for PPL, PPLU, and full body.

1. Warm-up (8–12 minutes)

- 3–5 minutes easy cardio or brisk walk into the gym.
- Dynamic bits for the day's joints (arm circles, hip openers, bodyweight squats — don't invent a yoga class).
- **Ramp sets** on the first compound: empty bar / light machine → add load → one last light–moderate set. Ramp sets are not work sets. Don't count them as volume.

2. Work sets

- Hit the listed **sets × reps**.
- Most working sets: about **1–2 reps in reserve (RIR)** — near failure, form still honest.
- Last hard set of an isolation can flirt with 0–1 RIR if the joint feels fine.
- Stop a set when form collapses into ego theatre. That rep didn't count anyway.

RPE quick map (use one language in the logbook):

Feel	RIR	RPE (approx.)
Could do 3+ more clean reps	3+	≤7
Could do ~2 more	2	~8
Could do ~1 more	1	~9
No clean reps left	0	10

Target most compounds at **RPE 8–9** once you've learned the movement. Week 1 beginners: leave a little more in the tank while you find the groove — still not polite gym tourism.

3. Rest times

Lift type	Rest
Heavy compounds (squat, hinge, press, row)	**2–3 minutes** (up to 3–4 if truly heavy)
Machines / secondary compounds	**90–150 seconds**
Isolations (curls, laterals, pushdowns)	**60–90 seconds**

Rest is part of the programme. Scrolling for four minutes between lateral raises is not "intensity."

4. Logging (non-optional)

Every session, write:

- Exercise
- Load
- Sets × reps actually done
- Rough RIR / RPE on the hard sets
- One-line note if something hurt or sleep was rubbish

Phone notes app, notebook, spreadsheet — pick one. If it's not logged, you didn't progress; you exercised.

5. Finish

You're done when the list is done. No bonus burnout circuit unless the template says so. Save energy for the next session.

Finding week-1 loads (so you can train tomorrow)

You do not need a one-rep max calculator. You need a starting number that lets you learn the movement and still work hard by the end of the week.

1. **Guess light.** First working set should feel like you could do the top of the rep range easily.
2. **Adjust set to set.** If set 1 was 12 reps with four left in the tank on an 8–12 lift, bump the load for set 2. If set 1 died at 5 reps with ugly form, strip weight.
3. **Lock a load for next time.** By the end of session one, you should know "this is my working weight for bench right now." Write it down.
4. **Week 1 bias:** leave ~2–3 RIR while grooves form. Weeks 2–3: push most sets to ~1–2 RIR.
5. **Machines vs free weights:** machines often let you push closer to failure sooner because the path is fixed — still don't bounce into joint pain.

If you are returning after months off, start more conservatively than your old PRs. Pride is not a warm-up set.

What to bring / how to use the gym floor

- Water, headphones optional, **logbook mandatory**.
- Claim a rack or bench for the main lift; do accessories that don't steal someone else's compound station for forty minutes of laterals.

- If a machine is taken, do the **next free exercise in the same pattern**, then return — don't stand still for ten minutes protecting a seat with a towel and a glare.
- Train the planned day even if the gym is busy. Busy is not a programme change.

EFFORT AND FORM CUES (COACH VOICE, NOT TEXTBOOK)

Chest presses: shoulder blades set, wrists stacked, lower with control, drive without bouncing the bar off your ribs like a trampoline.

Overhead work: ribs down, don't turn every press into a standing crunch. If your lower back is doing the lift, the load is too heavy or the setup is lazy.

Rows / pull-downs: pull elbows, not just hands. Pause a beat at the squeeze. Don't cheat every rep into a hip-hinge Olympic event.

Squats / leg press: depth you own, knees tracking roughly over toes, no ego depth that turns into a lower-back story. Full range you control beats half-reps with a plate you can't earn.

Hinges (RDL / back extension): soft knees, push hips back, feel hamstrings/glutes — not a rounded spine speed-run.

Lateral raises: slight elbow bend, lead with elbows, stop before shrugging the weight to your ears.

Curls / extensions: own the negative. Swinging the torso for the last three "reps" is cardio with a dumbbell.

Effort rule: if you finish every set knowing you had four clean reps left, you didn't train — you visited. If every set ends in a screaming form dump, you didn't train — you performed. Live in the middle: hard, clean, progressive.

Breathing (simple): brace before the hard part of the rep — don't hold a purple face for a twelve-rep set. Exhale through the sticking point on presses and squats; stay braced enough that your spine doesn't become a garden hose.

Tempo default: controlled down (roughly 2 seconds), crisp up. No need for fancy 4010 codes. If you bounce every rep, slow the eccentric until you own it.

Pain vs effort: muscle burn and the urge to quit near the end of a hard set is normal. Sharp joint stabbing, unusual nerve zings, or pain that alters your gait walking out of the gym is not "the programme working." Deload that pattern, swap the variation, get it checked if it persists.

Film one set per week of your hardest compound. Watch it once. Fix one thing. That's coaching without a coach.

PROGRESSIVE OVERLOAD: DOUBLE PROGRESSION

This is the engine. The split is just the calendar.

Rule (default):

1. Pick a **rep range** (usually **8–12** for most hypertrophy work; **6–10** on some heavier compounds if you prefer).
2. Use a load you can hit the **bottom** of the range for all prescribed sets at ~1–2 RIR.
3. When you hit the **top** of the range for **all** work sets with solid form, **add load** next session (smallest plate jump that makes sense — often 2.5 kg total on dumbbells/machines, 2.5–5 kg on barbells).
4. New load will often drop you back toward the bottom of the range. Climb again.

Example — dumbbell bench, 3×8–12

Session	Load	Result	Next move
Week 1 Mon	22.5 kg	12, 11, 10	Keep load; push reps
Week 1 Fri	22.5 kg	12, 12, 11	Keep load
Week 2 Mon	22.5 kg	12, 12, 12	**Add load**
Week 2 Fri	25 kg	10, 9, 8	Build reps again

That's progress. Not a new exercise every week because Instagram was bored.

When you stall for 2–3 sessions on a lift

1. Check sleep, protein, and whether you're actually near failure.
2. Keep the load; earn the reps.
3. If still stuck: small form fix, longer rest, or swap to a close variation (e.g. DB press → machine press) and progress that.
4. Do **not** add five random sets of junk.

Accessories

Same double-progression logic. Smaller jumps. Ego laterals with trapezius shrugs don't count as shoulder growth.

Example — leg press, 3×6–10

Session	Load	Result	Next move
Week 1 Legs A	120 kg	10, 9, 8	Keep; push reps
Week 1 Legs B (PPL)	120 kg	10, 10, 9	Keep
Week 2 Legs A	120 kg	10, 10, 10	**Add 5–10 kg**
Week 2 Legs B	130 kg	8, 7, 6	Build back up

If the machine stack jumps are huge, hit the top of the range, then add a slow eccentric or a 1-second pause before you chase the next plate.

What counts as overload (and what doesn't)

Counts: more load at same reps; more reps at same load inside the range; same load/reps with cleaner deeper range you previously shortened; controlled pauses that make the set harder *on purpose* when plates don't exist.

Doesn't count: longer sessions with gossip between sets; random drop sets every week that aren't logged; swapping the whole lift because last session felt hard; "I sweated more."

DEFAULT PPL TEMPLATES (COMPLETE)

Use gym versions first. Home swaps are later in this chapter. Rest between sets as above. Target ~1–2 RIR on work sets unless noted.

Weekly volume philosophy: this is a **solid beginner–early intermediate default**, not a pro prep sheet. If you're crushed after week two, cut one accessory set per day before quitting the split. If everything feels easy and you're recovering well by week six, add **one** set to a lagging movement — not seven.

[PLACEHOLDER: coach-specific detail] — if you later run a coached template, keep the same split logic; swap exercise brands/machines to what your coach programmes. Don't invent

secret protocols from the internet and call them “the system.”

Push day (chest, shoulders, triceps)

Order	Exercise	Sets × reps	Notes
1	Barbell or dumbbell bench press	3 × 6–10	Main horizontal press. Ramp first.
2	Seated dumbbell shoulder press **or** machine shoulder press	3 × 8–12	Controlled; no back arch circus.
3	Incline dumbbell press **or** incline machine press	3 × 8–12	Upper chest bias; stop short of flaring into pain.
4	Cable or dumbbell lateral raise	3 × 10–15	Strict. Rest-pause last set only if form holds.
5	Triceps pushdown (cable) **or** overhead triceps extension	3 × 10–15	Full range; elbows quiet.
6	Optional: pec deck **or** cable fly	2 × 12–15	Only if recovered; skip on MED weeks.

Time: ~50–65 minutes.
Finishers: none required.

Pull day (back, rear delts, biceps)

Order	Exercise	Sets × reps	Notes
1	Chest-supported row **or** seated cable row	3 × 6–10	Squeeze mid-back; don’t bounce.
2	Lat pull-down **or** assisted pull-up	3 × 6–10	Full stretch up top; pull elbows down.
3	One-arm dumbbell row **or** machine row	3 × 8–12 /side	Brace; no rotating the whole room.

Order	Exercise	Sets × reps	Notes
4	Straight-arm cable pulldown **or** dumbbell pullover	2–3 × 10–15	Lats lengthened; light enough to feel.
5	Rear-delt fly (cable/machine/DB)	3 × 12–15	Soft elbows; don't turn into a row.
6	EZ-bar or dumbbell curl	3 × 8–12	Own the negative.
7	Optional: face pull	2 × 12–15	Light, crisp; great if shoulders feel beat-up.

Time: ~50–70 minutes.

Legs day (quads, glutes, hamstrings, calves)

Order	Exercise	Sets × reps	Notes
1	Back squat **or** goblet squat **or** leg press	3 × 6–10	Choose the pattern you can load safely.
2	Romanian deadlift (barbell or DB) **or** seated/lying leg curl	3 × 8–12	Hinge with pride; keep lumbar honest.
3	Walking lunge **or** Bulgarian split squat **or** leg press (if squat was free-weight)	3 × 8–12 /side	Controlled; knee tracks.
4	Leg extension	2–3 × 10–15	Squeeze at the top; don't slam.
5	Standing or seated calf raise	3 × 10–15	Pause at the bottom stretch.
6	Optional: back extension or cable crunch	2 × 10–15	Core/posterior; not a twenty-minute ab class.

Time: ~55–75 minutes. Eat something with carbs around this day if you train hard in a deficit — legs punish empty tanks.

PPL micro-notes

- Swap bilateral for machines if you're learning or your lower back is noisy — tension still counts.
- Keep **exercise order** unless a machine is taken; then swap within the same slot, don't delete the pattern.
- If Pull takes forever because the cable station is a social club, start with the row that is free and circle back.
- Missed Wednesday Legs? Do Legs Thursday and shift the rest day — don't "skip Legs and do arms instead."
- Two Pushes in a row because you skipped Pull is not clever. Make up the missed *theme*.
- Optional fly / face-pull / core lines: use them when recovered; drop them first when life gets loud.

Example PPL week 1 (concrete)

Day	What you do
Mon Push	Warm-up → bench find loads → finish table → log → steps if behind
Tue Pull	Warm-up → rows/pull-downs → arms → log
Wed Legs	Carbs somewhere near the session if dieting → squat/hinge/lunge → calves → log
Thu	Rest or long walk; protein still hits
Fri Push	Same lifts as Mon; try to beat Mon's reps or match with cleaner form
Sat Pull	Same idea vs Tuesday
Sun Legs	Same idea vs Wednesday; if crushed, MED Legs and go home proud

That's a beginner-runnable week. No seminar required.

DEFAULT PPLU TEMPLATES (COMPLETE)

Same effort, rest, and logging rules. Four days. Do not sneak a fifth "bro pump" day that wrecks recovery unless you've earned capacity.

Push (PPLU)

Order	Exercise	Sets × reps	Notes
1	Bench press (BB/DB/machine)	3 × 6–10	Horizontal press A.
2	Overhead press (DB or machine)	3 × 8–12	Vertical press.
3	Incline press (DB/machine)	2–3 × 8–12	Slightly less volume than 6-day PPL Push — recovery matters.
4	Lateral raise	3 × 10–15	
5	Triceps pushdown or skull crusher	3 × 10–15	

Pull (PPLU)

Order	Exercise	Sets × reps	Notes
1	Seated row or chest-supported row	3 × 6–10	
2	Lat pull-down or pull-up regression	3 × 6–10	
3	Single-arm row	3 × 8–12 /side	
4	Rear-delt fly	3 × 12–15	
5	Curl variation	3 × 8–12	
6	Optional: face pull or straight-arm pulldown	2 × 12–15	

Legs (PPLU)

Order	Exercise	Sets × reps	Notes
1	Squat pattern (squat / goblet / leg press)	3–4 × 6–10	Slightly more room here because legs appear once as a dedicated day.

Order	Exercise	Sets × reps	Notes
2	RDL or leg curl	3 × 8–12	
3	Lunge / split squat / hack or second press	3 × 8–12	
4	Leg extension	2–3 × 10–15	
5	Calf raise	3–4 × 10–15	
6	Optional: core anti-extension or back extension	2 × 10–15	

Upper (PPLU) — second upper hit

This day is not “chest annihilate leftover.” It’s the **frequency** day: another push + pull dose with slightly different tools so joints stay happy.

Order	Exercise	Sets × reps	Notes
1	Incline DB press **or** machine chest press	3 × 8–12	Different angle/tool from Push day when possible.
2	Neutral-grip pull-down **or** chest-supported row	3 × 8–12	Opposite of whatever dominated Pull day if you can.
3	Machine or DB shoulder press (lighter)	2–3 × 8–12	Leave 2 RIR; shoulders already worked this week.
4	Cable lateral raise	2–3 × 12–15	
5	Face pull **or** rear-delt machine	2–3 × 12–15	

Order	Exercise	Sets × reps	Notes
6	Curl + triceps superset optional	2 × 10–15 each	Keep crisp; don't turn Upper into arms-only cosplay.

PPLU weekly picture: chest/shoulders/tris ~2×, back/bis ~2×, legs 1 hard dedicated day with enough sets to matter. If legs lag after 8–12 weeks and recovery is fine, [PLACEHOLDER: coach-specific detail] or simply convert one rest day into a second lighter lower session — only if attendance stays high.

ALTERNATIVE: 3-DAY FULL-BODY TEMPLATE

For people who **cannot** run PPL or PPLU this season. Three non-consecutive days. Same RIR, rest, and double progression.

Day A

Order	Exercise	Sets × reps
1	Squat or leg press	3 × 6–10
2	Bench press (BB/DB/machine)	3 × 6–10
3	Chest-supported or cable row	3 × 6–10
4	RDL or leg curl	2–3 × 8–12
5	Lateral raise	2 × 12–15
6	Curl or triceps (alternate each Day A)	2 × 10–15

Day B

Order	Exercise	Sets × reps
1	Hex-bar deadlift, trap-bar, or leg press hinge bias **or** goblet squat if recovery is thin	3 × 5–8
2	Overhead press (DB/machine)	3 × 6–10
3	Lat pull-down or assisted pull-up	3 × 6–10

Order	Exercise	Sets × reps
4	Walking lunge or split squat	2–3 × 8–12 /side
5	Rear-delt fly	2 × 12–15
6	Triceps or curl (opposite of last Day A choice)	2 × 10–15
7	Calf raise	2–3 × 10–15

Day C

Order	Exercise	Sets × reps
1	Leg press or squat variation	3 × 8–12
2	Incline press	3 × 8–12
3	Single-arm row	3 × 8–12 /side
4	Leg extension or goblet squat light	2 × 10–15
5	Face pull	2–3 × 12–15
6	Arms: curl + pushdown	2 × 10–15 each
7	Optional core	2 × 10–15

Run A/B/C across the week. When life opens up, move to **PPLU**, then **PPL** if capacity appears. Don't cling to three days out of stubbornness if four are free — and don't "upgrade" to six if four already fails.

STRIP VS LIFT: SAME SKELETON, DIFFERENT BIAS

The programme days do **not** magically change when you move from fat-loss-first to growth emphasis. The **food and recovery bias** does.

Lever	STRIP (fat-loss emphasis)	LIFT (growth emphasis, when earned)
Calories	Deficit (see Stage 5 nutrition)	Small surplus or high maintenance

Lever	STRIP (fat-loss emphasis)	LIFT (growth emphasis, when earned)
Protein	High end of the band	Still high — surplus carbs aren't a protein substitute
Session template	**Same PPL / PPLU / 3-day**	**Same**
Effort on key lifts	Keep intensity; protect compounds	Keep progressing; add volume carefully if recovering
Volume	Prefer trimming accessories before gutting main lifts	Room to add a set where progression stalls
Steps / cardio	Often higher to help the deficit	Don't erase the surplus with punishment cardio
Deloads	Still scheduled — deficits fatigue you	Still scheduled — surplus isn't immortality
Bad weeks	MED sessions (below)	MED sessions — life doesn't care about your phase name

Rule: do not rewrite the whole programme because you started eating more. Progress the lifts. Adjust the plate. That's STRIPLINE.

Skinny-fat and higher-body-fat readers: stay in STRIP bias longer than your impatience wants. Hardgainers with a documented lean starting point: you may earn LIFT calories sooner — still run the same training skeleton.

HOME VS GYM SWAPS (KEY LIFTS)

Progressive overload still wins. Bands and dumbbells work if the reps get harder over time (more load, harder band, slower eccentrics, extra set only when earned).

Gym lift	Home / limited-kit swap
Barbell bench	DB floor press, push-up variations (elevate feet / weight vest / pause), resistance-band press

Gym lift	Home / limited-kit swap
Incline press	DB incline on adjustable bench or floor with hips elevated; band incline press
Overhead press	DB seated press; band press; pike push-up progression
Cable lateral raise	DB laterals; band laterals
Triceps pushdown	DB overhead extension; band pushdown on door anchor; close-grip push-up
Cable / chest-supported row	Single-arm DB row; backpack/backpack-loaded row; band row
Lat pull-down	Band pulldown; inverted row under table; towel row
Pull-up	Band-assisted if you have a bar; otherwise inverted rows + pulldown bands
Back squat	Goblet squat; DB squat; backpack squat; split squat emphasis
Leg press	Goblet squat + split squat pairing; heel-elevated DB squat
RDL	DB RDL; single-leg DB RDL; band hinge
Leg curl	Sliding leg curl on towel/socks; band curl
Leg extension	DB Spanish squat / heel-elevated goblet focus for quads; sissy-squat regression only if knees happy
Calf raise	Single-leg calf raise on a step with backpack
Pec deck / fly	DB floor fly (careful shoulders); band fly
Face pull	Band face pull; prone Y/T raises

Home programming tip: when load jumps are awkward, use **double progression on reps first**, then add a slow 3-second eccentric, then add a set only if recovery is clear. Don't chase gym-only exercises while your adjustable dumbbells gather dust.

DELOAD RULES

Plan the deload so you don't invent one after an injury.

Default: every **6–8 weeks** of hard training, or earlier if sleep tanks, joints complain, and performance slides for ~7–10 days despite honest effort.

Deload week options (pick one):

1. **Same exercises, ~50–70% usual load, same or slightly fewer sets, stop at ~3–4 RIR.**
2. **Keep load moderate, cut sets roughly in half.**
3. **MED week** (below) if life is chaos — still counts as training, not failure.

Deload is not "seven days of couch and guilt." Walk. Sleep. Eat protein. Come back hungry to train — not wrecked.

Do not deload every time the scale is noisy. Deload for **fatigue and performance**, not for feelings after one bad session.

BAD-WEEK MED SESSIONS (MINIMUM EFFECTIVE DOSE)

When overtime, sick kids, or a mental cliff shows up: **do not rewrite the programme at 11 p.m.** Run MED versions. You're still on STRIPLINE.

MED Push

Exercise	Sets × reps
Bench press variation	2–3 × 6–10
Shoulder press variation	2 × 8–12
Lateral raise	2 × 12–15
Triceps pushdown/extension	2 × 10–15

MED Pull

Exercise	Sets × reps
Row	3 × 6–10
Lat pull-down / pull-up regression	2–3 × 6–10

Exercise	Sets × reps
Rear-delt fly or face pull	2 × 12–15
Curl	2 × 8–12

MED Legs

Exercise	Sets × reps
Squat or leg press	2–3 × 6–10
RDL or leg curl	2 × 8–12
Lunge or split squat	2 × /side 8–12
Calf raise	2 × 10–15

Rules: ~40 minutes max. Still ~1–2 RIR on the compounds. Log it. Resume full template next week. Missing the week entirely trains the wrong habit.

On **PPLU**, MED Upper = bench or incline + row + laterals + one arm movement (2 sets each).

On **3-day**, MED day = squat/press/row pattern, 2 sets each, go home.

When to use MED vs full deload vs skip

Situation	Move
Busy week, body fine	MED sessions; keep the days
Performance sliding ~7–10 days, sleep poor	Planned deload week
Acute illness / fever	Skip hard training; walk if able; resume MED then full
One rough night's sleep	Train full unless unsafe; maybe leave an extra RIR
Motivation dip only	Show up; often the first compound fixes the mood

Skipping “because I deserve rest” every time life is mildly annoying is how six-day PPL becomes zero-day regret.

STEPS, CARDIO, AND THE LIFTING WEEK

STRIP loves steps. Lifting still owns the calendar.

- **Default:** get steps on rest days and after sessions if needed — walking is not a substitute for Pull day.
- **Cardio:** 1–2 easy Zone-2 style sessions (20–30 minutes) is plenty for most year-one lifters if steps are already solid. Put them on rest days or after upper sessions, not before heavy Legs when it nukes your squat.
- **Hard conditioning every day** plus six-day PPL plus a deep deficit is how people stall, sleep badly, and blame genetics.
- **Hardgainers in LIFT:** watch that cardio doesn’t quietly erase the surplus. Lift hard, walk some, eat.

Steps targets live in Stage 5’s playbook. Here the rule is simpler: **never cancel a programmed Lift day to “do more cardio instead”** unless a coach or clinician has a specific reason. Fat loss is mostly the food deficit plus consistency; the programme builds the muscle you’re trying to keep.

RUNNING AN 8–12 WEEK BLOCK (DON’T FREESTYLE)

1. **Weeks 1–2:** learn loads, grooves, calendar. Effort climbing toward 1–2 RIR.
2. **Weeks 3–6:** double progression in full swing. Same exercises. Log everything.
3. **Week 7 (or 6–8):** deload if fatigue is real — or keep rolling if you feel strong *and* performance is still climbing. Don’t deload from boredom.
4. **Weeks 8–12:** resume hard training. Add at most one set to a lagging lift if recovery is clearly fine. Optional small exercise swap only if a joint hates a movement — same pattern, new tool.
5. **End of block:** photos, waist, strength notes. Decide: stay on the same split another block, or switch PPL ↔ PPLU for life reasons — not vibes.

[PLACEHOLDER: coach-specific detail] if you later get weekly programming tweaks — the block logic still applies: run the plan long enough to measure it.

TROUBLESHOOTING (QUICK FIXES)

Problem	Likely fix
Sessions run past 90 minutes	Cut optionals; watch rest on isolations; stop phone-scrolling
Shoulders angry on bench	Try DB or machine; control depth; add face pulls; check overhead volume
Lower back angry on RDL	Soften knees; shorten range; swap to leg curl for a block
No pump / “don’t feel it”	Slow eccentric; full stretch; actually approach failure — feeling isn’t the only scoreboard
Strength dropping in STRIP	Expected some weeks; protect protein/sleep; keep intensity; trim accessories before compounds
Only chest growing	Stop skipping Pull and Legs; row as hard as you press
Can’t do Pull after Push (sore)	Normal early on; keep showing up; soreness fades with consistency
Hate Legs	Do them anyway; machines are legal; physique is not upper-body only
Partner / mate wants a different split	Run *your* locked template; joint sessions can share a gym, not a random programme

COMMON MISTAKES

Mistake	What to do instead
Collecting splits like Pokémon	Lock PPL, PPLU, or 3-day for 8–12 weeks
Polite sets forever	Learn 1–2 RIR; film a set if you lie to yourself
Form collapse as “intensity”	Earn load with clean reps

Mistake	What to do instead
Skipping legs / Pull	Those days build the physique you're chasing
Adding volume when sleepy and under-fed	Sleep, protein, MED — then volume
Changing exercises weekly	Progress the ones you have
Resting 20 seconds on squats	Use the rest table; performance needs oxygen
No logbook	If it's not written, it didn't progress
Six-day PPL while sleeping five hours	Choose PPLU or 3-day until recovery exists
Cardio replacing Lift days in STRIP	Steps help; don't delete Push/Pull/Legs
Waiting for the "perfect gym"	Use home swaps and start
Programme-hopping after 11 days	Boredom ≠ plateau; run the block

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WEEK-1 CHECKLIST (DO THIS TOMORROW)

- [ ] Pick **PPL**, **PPLU**, or **3-day** based on real calendar + recovery — not ego.
- [ ] Put training days in the phone calendar with alarms.
- [ ] Copy the exact session tables into your notes/workbook.
- [ ] Set starting loads you can hit with ~2–3 RIR on day one (find the groove), then push toward 1–2 RIR by week 2–3.
- [ ] Decide deload rule now: e.g. "Week 7 lighter" or "when performance slides 7+ days."
- [ ] Write MED Push/Pull/Legs (or full-body MED) on a note titled **Bad Week — still train**.
- [ ] Confirm STRIP vs LIFT food bias for this month (Stage 5 nutrition + Food Bro if useful).
- [ ] Photo + waist + empty logbook ready — Stage 5 scoreboard.
- [ ] Pack bag tonight if you train mornings — decision fatigue is not a warm-up.
- [ ] After session one: log loads. After week one: you are on programme.
- [ ] Tell one accountability human your training days (mate, partner, group chat) — LINK starts as a behaviour, not a brand.

That's it. No ceremony.

Decision tree (print this)

1. Can I train **six** days with decent sleep most weeks? → **PPL**
2. If no: can I train **four** hard days? → **PPLU**
3. If no: → **3-day full body**
4. Life exploded mid-week? → **MED** versions, same themes
5. Food phase? → STRIP or LIFT bias from Stage 5 — **same lifts**

BRIDGE TO STAGE 6

You now have the **LINE** installed as concrete sessions: warm-up, work sets, rest, RIR, double progression, deload, MED, home swaps, STRIP/LIFT bias.

Stage 5's wider playbook (food, steps, months, scoreboard) still wraps this chapter. Stage 6 is where you stop shopping for more theory and **start**: first-week actions, FAQ landmines, and what "next" looks like when the plan is already in your hands. Bring your chosen template. Bring the logbook. Bring the boring consistency that actually changes a body in twelve months.

The twelve-month body is not built by collecting PDFs. It's built by Push, Pull, Legs (or PPLU), logged, progressive, repeated while food and recovery do their jobs.

If you want a human in the loop for accountability and adjustments later, keep it simple — [PLACEHOLDER: paid offer / coach funnel — pending agreement]. The programme on the page still works if you run it.

Action now: choose PPL or PPLU (or 3-day if you must), train the next scheduled day, log every set. Stage 6 assumes you already began.

RECOMMENDED TRAINING LOG APPS (STARTING DEFAULTS)

Paper in the Year Logbook works. Apps make progression harder to "forget."

Priority	App	Why it's here
Primary recommendation	**Hevy**	Cross-platform, clean PPL templates, rest timers, easy history

Priority	App	Why it's here
Strong iOS-first alternative	**Strong**	Excellent session UX if you live on iPhone
Simple alternative	**Progressive** / notebook	Fine if you already log religiously on paper

Rule: build your PPL or PPLU template once in the app to match Stage 5C. Log every work set. Don't switch apps mid-block.

Alternatives are fine. House default later can replace this list (`[PLACEHOLDER: preferred training app]` only if you remove defaults).

Exact session logging workflow

1. Open Hevy (or Strong) → start Push / Pull / Legs / Upper template.
2. Warm-up sets unlogged or marked warm-up; work sets logged with load × reps.
3. Note RIR in the set note (target ~1–2).
4. End workout; next session the app shows last loads — beat reps then load (double progression).
5. Once a week, copy top sets for squat/hinge/press/row into the Year Logbook monthly page.

WORKED PROGRESSION EXAMPLE (BENCH PRESS)

Week 1: 60 kg × 8,8,8 (2 RIR)
Week 2: 60 × 9,9,8
Week 3: 60 × 10,10,9
Week 4: 60 × 10,10,10 → **add 2.5 kg**
Week 5: 62.5 × 8,8,7 → build reps again.

Same rule on squat, row, hinge. Miss a week? Repeat last week's loads.

WARM-UP PROTOCOL (EVERY SESSION)

1. 3–5 min easy bike/row/walk
2. Pattern light set × 10–15
3. Moderate set × 6–8
4. First work set at planned load

DELOAD WEEK (EVERY 6–8 WEEKS OR WHEN PERFORMANCE TANKS)

- Keep exercise list
- -1 set on accessories
- Stop ~3 RIR
- No PRs; walk steps normally

MED CHAOS TEMPLATES

Push MED: press 3×6–10 · lateral 2×12 · triceps 2×10
Pull MED: row 3×6–10 · pulldown 2×8–12 · curl 2×10
Legs MED: squat/leg press 3×6–10 · hinge 2×8 · calves 2×12

FORM CUES (KEEP THESE ON YOUR PHONE NOTES)

Squat / leg press: brace, knees track toes, depth you own, no bounce ego.
Hinge / RDL: soft knees, hips back, bar close, flat back, squeeze glutes to stand.
Press: pull shoulders down/back, controlled eccentric, lockout without shrugging into neck.
Row: initiate with elbows, avoid lumbar yank, pause squeeze.
Pulldown: long arms stretch, elbows to pockets, no behind-neck circus.

SCHEDULE EXAMPLES

Standard PPL: Mon Push · Tue Pull · Wed Legs · Thu rest · Fri Push · Sat Pull · Sun Legs
PPLU recovery-friendly: Mon Push · Tue Pull · Wed Legs · Thu Upper · Fri rest · Sat Push · Sun rest (then rotate)
Shift worker: lock any 6 slots in 8 days; never skip logging; MED if <5 hours sleep

COMMON TRAINING MISTAKES

Mistake	Fix
New split every fortnight	8–12 week lock
Logging only “good” days	Log misses too
Failure every set	1–2 RIR most work
Cardio before legs weekly	Steps after or separate
Ignoring warm-ups on heavy days	Protocol every session

START & NEXT STEP

Start This Week, FAQ & Next Step

You've got the problem, the method, the benefits, the why, and the playbook. This stage exists because information without a start date becomes another abandoned PDF — and you already own enough of those.

THIS WEEK — DO THESE THINGS

1. **Take baseline photos** (front/side/back) and measure waist. Write the date.
2. **Decide STRIP vs documented lean-hardgainer exception** using photos — not ego.
3. **Generate food targets** at **https://yehbro.com/food-bro/** and save the free PDF. Lock calories + protein into your notes.
4. **Write your programme** for the next 12 weeks (3–4 days is enough). Define the progression rule.
5. **Set floors:** steps, sleep minimum, bad-week MED plan.
6. **Name your LINK:** a human who will check you — or note **[PLACEHOLDER: paid offer / coach funnel — pending agreement]** until that door opens.
7. **Train session one.** Log it. Eat the protein. Go to bed.

Do not wait for Monday. Do not wait for perfect gear. Do not wait until you've reread Stage 5 three times. Information without a date is entertainment; a dated baseline is a beginning.

Richer first-week plan (hour by hour isn't required — decisions are)

Day 0 (today, even if it's ugly):
Photos. Waist. Date. Folder named with the date so future-you can't "lose" baselines. Decision written: STRIP / recomp / documented exception. Food Bro PDF downloaded. Calories + protein copied into the same note as the programme.

Day 1:
Session one as written — even if short. Log every working set. Hit protein without negotiating a new diet identity. Message your LINK: "Started. Targets are X calories / Y protein. Check-in day is ___."

Day 2:
Steps floor. Sleep floor. Prep one default meal that makes protein easy tomorrow. No programme edits.

Day 3:
Session two or rest as written. If hunger is loud, that's data inside STRIP — not a reason to bulk. Keep the weekly average in mind.

Day 4–5:
Stay on LINE. Social event? Plan it inside the week; don't burn the template. If you miss a session, run MED — don't declare a restart.

Day 6–7:
Second (or third) session as scheduled. Brief adherence note: sessions done, protein days hit, steps average, one sentence on energy. Send it. Book next week's check-in. Do **not** change the programme because motivation felt mid.

That's a first week. Unromantic. Sufficient.

First-week traps to refuse

- Rewriting the split after session one because a reel disagreed.
- Cutting another 500 kcal because the scale didn't move in 72 hours.
- Buying five supplements before you've hit protein four days.
- Skipping photos because you "don't look ready." Baselines are supposed to be honest, not flattering.
- Waiting for your LINK to be perfect coaching — a ruthless mate counts until the formal door opens.

COST OF WAITING

Another year of wrong order costs you the photos you'll take anyway — still soft, still hopping, still telling yourself you need more information.

Waiting feels safe. It's usually just unaccountable. The plan doesn't get easier when you're a year older with the same midsection story.

STRIPLINE doesn't require perfect conditions. It requires sequence and reps.

Cost of waiting, itemised

- **Physique cost:** another twelve months of soft-middle photos and wardrobe negotiation.
- **Identity cost:** "nothing works" calcifies, even when continuity never got a fair trial.
- **Money cost:** more PDFs, more tubs, more gear that never meets a locked plan.
- **Social cost:** another summer of excuses; another winter of "next year."
- **Skill cost:** you stay a beginner at progressive overload because you keep resetting the skill tree.
- **Opportunity cost:** the version of you who ran STRIPLINE this year doesn't get built.

You don't need a perfect week to start. You need a dated baseline and session one. Waiting for calm calendars is how busy adults stay soft forever — calm calendars are rare; locked lines are portable.

FAQ

Do I have to get stage-lean before I build any muscle?
No. You lift during STRIP. Fat-loss-first means fat is the priority bias — not "never stimulate muscle."

I'm skinny. Shouldn't I bulk?
Only if photos show you're already lean. Soft middle + "I'm a hardgainer" is usually skinny-fat cosplay. Document exceptions; don't invent them.

How aggressive should the deficit be?
Moderate enough to train and adhere. Start ~300–500 kcal below maintenance for many people; adjust from trend data.

Can I recomp instead of cut?
Often yes early — especially skinny-fat — if lifting and protein are excellent and the middle still improves. Recomp isn't a forever fog to avoid decisions.

What if I miss a week?
Run MED. Resume. Don't burn the programme and start a new identity.

How much protein?
~1.6–2.2 g/kg as a practical band. Use Food Bro + book hierarchy. Consistency beats precision theatre.

Is cardio required?
Steps help a lot in STRIP. Extra cardio is optional if it doesn't trash lifting or recovery.

When do I move to LIFT emphasis?
When midsection trajectory and adherence criteria you wrote are met — not when boredom hits.

Do I need supplements?
Optional. Creatine, caffeine, protein powder are the sensible tier once basics exist.

What about PEDs / peptides / GLP-1s?
Read the appendix for literacy. No protocols in this book. Fundamentals first. Discussion of personal fit: **[PLACEHOLDER: paid offer / coach funnel — pending agreement]**.

How do I track without obsessing?
Photos + waist + strength + weekly averages. Simplify if the app runs your mood.

What if my job destroys my schedule?
Shorter sessions, fewer days, protein defaults, step floor, LINK still active. Busy is normal here — chaos programmes aren't.

Can women run STRIPLINE?
Yes — same sequence principles; individual calorie/protein set-up still personal. This book doesn't pretend one number fits every body.

How long until I see change?
Waist/photos often shift in weeks if adherence is real; "best physique of your life" is a twelve-month project, not a weekend.

What if I don't have a coach yet?
Use a ruthless mate as LINK. Keep the placeholder for formal coaching when available.

Should I weigh every day?
Daily weighing is fine if you use weekly averages and don't let single mornings run your emotions. If the scale runs your mood, weigh less often and lean harder on photos, waist, and strength.

What is MED again?
Minimum effective dose for a bad week: protein floor, step floor, abbreviated sessions that keep the pattern alive. MED is a bridge, not a new lifestyle. Resume the full LINE when the week allows.

Can I drink alcohol and still STRIP?
Sometimes, inside a weekly average — with honesty about calories and recovery. Chronic

weekend black holes aren't a mystery; they're a plan leak. Adjust the plan or the drinking pattern; don't pretend both are unlimited.

I have kids and no quiet evenings. Still viable?
Yes. Shorter sessions, earlier training if possible, protein defaults that don't need chef energy, LINK that texts not essays. The method assumes real life; it doesn't require a monastery. Stage 4's point stands: this sequence was run under fatherhood and brutal work hours — not unlimited gym time. Your constraints are the arena, not the veto.

I'm on ~60–70 hour work weeks. Do I wait?
No. Calendar fewer training days (PPLU or 3-day), protect compounds, hit protein with packed defaults, keep step floor honest, send LINK even when it's three lines. Waiting for a light roster is how soft middles stay soft. See Stage 5A's construction / long-day sample week.

How do I pick lifts if I'm a beginner?
Simple patterns you can load safely: squat or leg press, hinge (RDL or machine), push, pull, a carry or core finisher. Progression rule written. Ego maxing left at the door. Stage 5's playbook is the deeper map — LINE still starts with what you'll actually show up for.

What if my waist isn't moving after a month?
Check adherence first (food average, steps, weekends). Then one lever: small calorie drop or step bump. Don't change programme, diet religion, and supplement stack in the same weekend.

What if strength is crashing in STRIP?
Protein, sleep, and deficit size first. Panic cuts trash performance. Deload if needed. Keep lifting — don't become a cardio-only tourist.

Do I need a fancy watch?
No. Steps help; a phone pedometer or honest daily walk total is enough to start. Tools amplify; they don't replace LINE.

How many times can I fail and still be "on" STRIPLINE?
As many bad weeks as life throws — if you resume. Failure is quitting the sequence. Misses are weather.

Is twelve months mandatory before any pride?
No. Take interim wins. Just don't confuse a four-week waist change with the full project. The book is named for the year because the year is what builds a physique you keep.

What if I already lift hard but look soft?
That's often STRIP + LINE nutrition honesty, not a new advanced split. Hard training on a soft

surplus still yields a soft photo.

Can I run STRIPLINE with home kit only?
Yes if you can overload over time — adjustable dumbbells, bands plus load progression, or progressive push-up/row variations with honest difficulty increases. If you can't progress, join a gym or add loadable kit. LIFT requires progressive stimulus.

What if I'm already on a cut that feels miserable?
Misery that trashes training and protein isn't STRIP — it's a crash. Raise food toward a sustainable deficit, keep lifting, reassess in two weeks. Adherence is part of the physics.

How do I handle holidays inside STRIPLINE?
Decide before the trip: maintenance week, lighter deficit, or planned surplus days inside a monthly average. Keep LINE's training where possible. Don't invent a new annual identity in December and call it strategy.

Should I tell people I'm doing this?
Tell your LINK for sure. Everyone else is optional. Public announcements without a check-in human are usually theatre.

What if photos demotivate me?
Good — baselines aren't supposed to flatter. File them. Compare only under the same conditions at review dates. Daily mirror audits in bad lighting are not a scoreboard.

Can I change my Food Bro numbers mid-block?
If body weight or phase changes enough that the targets are clearly wrong — yes, at a review. Not because Thursday felt hungry.

Is walking enough "cardio"?
For many people in STRIP, a step floor is the main movement lever beside lifting. Add structured cardio only if it helps adherence or conditioning without wrecking recovery.

What if my LINK flakes?
Replace them. The role matters more than the original person. Silence returns you to negotiating with yourself.

Do I need to read the appendix before I start?
No. Start STRIPLINE. Read advanced-tools literacy when curiosity or Year 2 decisions show up — not as a delay tactic.

How do I know the first week "worked"?
You took baselines, locked numbers, trained, ate protein, and sent a check-in. That's success

for week one. Waist magic is not the grading rubric yet.

FIRST-MONTH BRIDGE (AFTER WEEK ONE)

Weeks 2–4 are where novelty dies and LINE earns its name.

- Keep the same programme.
- Hit protein most days.
- Defend steps and sleep floors.
- Send weekly LINK notes even when they're boring.
- At week 4: photos, waist, strength glance, adherence score. One lever maximum if stalled.
- Refuse: new split, new diet religion, new supplement identity.

If week two feels flat, congratulations — you're in the real programme. Flat is where wrong order usually hops. STRIPLINE stays.

COST OF WAITING — ONE MORE PASS

Imagine two folders on your phone a year from now.

Folder A: twelve months of dated photos under STRIPLINE — imperfect weeks included — with a waist trend and a logbook.
Folder B: screenshots of programmes you meant to start, and a handful of accidental mirror shots you hate.

Both futures cost time. Only one buys evidence. Waiting doesn't preserve optionality; it spends a year on Folder B by default.

Busy job? Kids? Imperfect sleep? Welcome — you're the reader this book was built for. The method was never "wait until life is a retreat." The method is sequence inside the life you already have.

Script: the five-minute start if you're about to overthink

1. Open camera — front, side, back.
2. Tape the waist — write the number.
3. Open https://yehbro.com/food-bro/ — generate, save PDF.
4. Note: days you'll train this week + progression rule in one line.
5. Text LINK: "Starting STRIPLINE. Check-in ___."

6. Do the first hard set of session one today or tomorrow morning — not next Monday.

If you complete that list, Stage 6 has done its job even if the rest of the FAQ stays unread tonight.

FAQ add-ons for edge cases

I travel weekly for work.
Lock a hotel-capable MED session (push/pull/hinge/squat pattern with whatever kit exists) plus protein defaults you can buy at a petrol station without turning it into a joke. Full LINE at home; MED on the road; averages across the week.

I train with a mate who hops programmes.
Your LINE is yours. Train together if it helps LINK; don't outsource your template to their boredom.

I've been injured.
Get clearance and diagnosis. LINE becomes the pattern you can load pain-free. STRIPLINE doesn't require heroics on a damaged joint; it requires honesty and progressive work inside what's allowed.

I'm impatient and angry this is "only" twelve months.
Good. Use the impatience to refuse hopping. Twelve focused months beats five angry years of restarts.

What if I hate tracking food?
Use Food Bro targets as portions and defaults; tighten tracking only if waist won't move. Some people need grams; some need consistent plates. Results decide, ego doesn't.

Can I do two-a-days?
Usually unnecessary for this book's reader. Earn recovery first. More sessions aren't LINE — finishing the ones you wrote is.

What if my partner cooks differently to the plan?
Defaults and communication beat secret diets. Hit protein with add-ons if needed; keep the weekly average adult. LINE isn't a hostage situation — it's shared clarity where possible.

How strict is "lock" on LINE?
Locked means you don't hop philosophies mid-block. Substitutions for pain, travel, or equipment are allowed when they keep the pattern and progression rule alive. Locked is not brittle; brittle plans shatter on contact with Tuesday.

Should I deload on a schedule or when needed?
Pick a rule and write it — e.g. every 6–8 weeks, or when performance and joints complain together. Random deloads that are actually skipped weeks without a plan don't count as recovery strategy.

What goes in the Year 2 sketch?
Another STRIP polish, a growth block, skill goals, and whether advanced-tools literacy conversations belong under supervision. Sketch beats cliff. Details wait until months 10–12 when you have evidence.

Cost-of-waiting close

If you close this book without a dated baseline and a named LINK, you didn't buy information — you rented a familiar feeling. Start ugly. Start short. Start today. The FAQ will still be here when you check in next week with actual data instead of fresh excuses.

PERMANENT STRIPLINE CHECKLIST

- [ ] Fat-loss-first until the midsection is honest (or exception documented)
- [ ] One written programme locked
- [ ] Protein most days
- [ ] Progressive overload logged
- [ ] Steps + sleep floors
- [ ] Human accountability
- [ ] Review every 2–4 weeks — one lever
- [ ] Food Bro PDF filed
- [ ] Bad-week MED written
- [ ] Year sketch started by months 10–12

Checklist commentary (why each box earns its ink)

Fat-loss-first / exception documented — Stops the bulk-into-soft-photo reflex. Writing the exception prevents cosplay.

One written programme — Ends hopping. If it isn't written, it isn't locked.

Protein most days — Protects muscle in STRIP and feeds LIFT. "Most days" is adult language for consistency without perfection theatre.

Progressive overload logged — Memory lies; notebooks don't. No log, no proof of LIFT.

Steps + sleep floors — Quiet levers that save aggressive calorie cuts and trashed recovery.

Human accountability — The plan outside your mood. Mate or coach; silence is how weeks evaporate.

Review, one lever — Diagnostics without identity crisis. Multiple levers at once teach you nothing.

Food Bro PDF filed — Numbers stop being vibes. Revisit when body weight or phase changes enough to matter.

Bad-week MED — Guarantees you have a bridge before life asks for one.

Year sketch by months 10–12 — Prevents cliff-edge panic and random Year 2 chaos.

Tick boxes in ink. Unticked boxes are where years hide.

Print the checklist or copy it into your notes app. Revisit it every review. If three boxes go grey for a month, you don't need a new book — you need LINK to ask why, and LINE to resume. The checklist is not decoration; it's the short form of *The 12-Month Body*.

One more FAQ block for nerves

What if I'm embarrassed to send photos to my LINK?
Send them anyway on schedule, or use waist + strength until trust exists — but don't let embarrassment delete accountability. Soft lighting optional; honesty not optional.

What if I start and stop again?
Restart at Day 0 without a speech. New dated baselines if the gap was long. Same STRIPLINE. Shame is optional; sequence isn't.

Is this compatible with shift work / FIFO / overtime seasons?
Yes with MED and flexible day placement. The plan moves on the calendar; the targets and progression rule don't reinvent themselves every swing.

FINAL CTA

Run the system. Prove twelve months can change more than your mood.

If you run the plan and still want hands-on help linking with an experienced coach, that door is here when it's formally open:

[PLACEHOLDER: paid offer / coach funnel — pending agreement]

No secret chapter with the “real” method. The method is STRIPLINE — executed on ordinary weeks until ordinary weeks build an extraordinary difference.

Lace up. Log the set. Eat the protein. Strip first. Lock the line. Lift. Link.

Welcome to *The 12-Month Body*. The year starts when the first set is logged — not when the last FAQ is memorised.

ADVANCED TOOLS EDUCATION

Advanced Tools Literacy — PEDs, TRT, Peptides & GLP-1s

Bodybuilding, in the real world, involves more than chicken and progressive overload. Supplements, prescription metabolic drugs, testosterone clinics, and — for some people — anabolic drugs and peptides sit in the same cultural conversation as the gym. Pretending otherwise helps no one.

This chapter is **education**. Matter-of-fact. Non-judgmental. Pro **smart use with a plan and appropriate medical/coaching support** when tools are in play. Anti chaos, anti stranger-PDF "cycles," anti "just start jabbing because TikTok."

What you will not find here: dosages, titration charts, cycle protocols, stacks, sourcing guides, or "how to start TRT/GLP-1/PED use from this book." Those belong with clinicians and coaches — not a paperback.

If you want a personal conversation about whether any of this fits *your* situation after you've installed STRIPLINE fundamentals:

[PLACEHOLDER: paid offer / coach funnel — pending agreement]

Year-1 still runs on fat-loss-first, a locked plan, progressive training, protein, sleep, and accountability. Tools amplify the system you bring.

WHY THIS CHAPTER EXISTS

Physique culture flattened natural and enhanced timelines into one scroll. Beginners compare their month three to someone else's pharmacy year five and call themselves failures. Other beginners discover GLP-1 ads, TRT clinic funnels, and peptide vendors in the same afternoon and treat them as interchangeable "hacks."

Literacy means you can separate:

Lane	Rough idea
Food + training + sleep	Always on

Lane	Rough idea
Tier-1 supplements	Optional convenience/performance
Prescription metabolic drugs (e.g. GLP-1 class) under a doctor	Legitimate medical pathway for some people with overweight/obesity
Clinically indicated testosterone therapy via proper assessment	Real medicine for real hypogonadism — clinics exist for a reason
Physique-oriented androgens / grey-market peptides	Higher-stakes culture; smart use ≠ DIY

You don't have to use any advanced tool to change your body in twelve months. You *do* need to understand the map so marketing and gym lore don't run your decisions.

DECISION FILTER BEFORE ANYTHING "ADVANCED"

Ask honestly:

1. Have I locked STRIPLINE for a boring block — progressive training, protein most days, photos/waist logged?
2. Is my goal composition — or impatience?
3. Am I comparing to someone on a different pharmacy or genetics lottery?
4. If this involves medicine, am I willing to go through a **doctor/clinic**, bloodwork, and follow-up — not a group chat?
5. If this involves enhancement culture, am I willing to treat monitoring and coaching as non-optional?

If (1) is trash, fix Stages 5A–5C first. Tools on chaos multiply chaos.

Red flags (walk away): stranger "beginner cycle" PDFs; no bloodwork culture; discount-code medicine as education; guaranteed timelines; pressure to start tonight; anyone telling you to skip monitoring.

TIER-1 SUPPLEMENTS (SHORT, STILL USEFUL)

Once training and protein exist:

- **Creatine monohydrate** — best-supported performance supplement for many healthy lifters; daily use beats timing theatre.
- **Caffeine** — can help session quality; don't trade it for sleep.
- **Protein powder** — convenience for hitting totals, not magic versus food.

They don't replace STRIPLINE. Skip the fifty-ingredient fat burner.

GLP-1S IN 2026 — OVERWEIGHT, DOCTORS, AND REALISTIC EXPECTATIONS

What this class is (plain language)

GLP-1 pathway medicines (and related dual/triple agonists people hear about) affect appetite, satiety, gastric emptying, and metabolic signalling. For many people under medical care, average calorie intake drops without relying only on white-knuckle willpower. That can create a real fat-loss environment.

Legitimate pathway: doctor + overweight/obesity care

If someone is **truly overweight or living with obesity**, in many places a **doctor can assess and may prescribe** a GLP-1 (or related agent) as part of medical weight management — depending on criteria, comorbidities, local guidelines, supply, and cost/coverage. That is a **clinical pathway**, not a gym hack.

What "legitimate" looks like in practice (themes, not instructions):

- Assessment of BMI/adiposity, history, contraindications, other meds
- Prescription and follow-up through a qualified prescriber
- Monitoring of tolerance, side effects, and progress
- Lifestyle still exists — medication is not a personality transplant

What it is **not**: buying a mystery pen because a reel promised stage-ready abs by summer.

What's realistic vs marketing

Realistic: appetite drops; adherence to a deficit gets easier for some; scale weight can move faster than with lifestyle alone; some people finally get a runway after years of failed white-knuckle cuts.

Marketing fog: “no effort,” “no muscle loss if you wish hard,” “anyone should be on one,” “this replaces training,” “stop when you like and keep the look with zero habits.”

Composition — not just the scale

Analyses of GLP-1-assisted weight loss often show some **absolute lean-mass drop** as total weight falls. That isn’t an automatic catastrophe label — it’s why **protein + progressive lifting** stay non-negotiable if you care about looking athletic rather than only lighter.

Practical literacy while appetite is suppressed (behaviour layer — not a prescribing guide):

1. **Schedule protein** — don’t wait to “feel like eating.”
2. **Keep a written lifting plan** (PPL/PPLU from Stage 5C). MED weeks beat zero weeks.
3. **Don’t chase heroic weekly drops** if strength is falling off a cliff — talk to your prescriber/coach frame; adjust the boring half.
4. **Steps help;** punishment cardio on empty is how you get flat and injured.
5. **Photos + waist + lifts** — the scale will lie cheerfully.
6. **Plan the off-ramp behaviours** — diet pattern, sleep, training calendar — before you need them. Medication without lifestyle still fails the long game.

Where GLP-1s sit inside STRIPLINE

STRIP is fat-loss-first. A medically supervised GLP-1 can be a **tool that makes STRIP adherence easier** for the right patient — it does not skip LINE (locked plan) or LINK (accountability). If you’re not in a medical category for these drugs, don’t invent a DIY pathway because bodybuilding Instagram normalised pens.

Investigational or newer agents you hear about in 2026 may have different approval/access status by country and month. Treat headline hype as headline hype. Your clinician owns what’s actually available and appropriate.

LOW TESTOSTERONE AND TRT CLINICS — EDUCATION, NOT A STARTER KIT

Why this comes up so often

Low testosterone (clinically evaluated hypogonadism — not “I had a nap and felt unmotivated”) is a **real medical issue** for some men. Symptoms people describe in the wild — low energy, low libido, mood changes, training recovery feeling broken — overlap with sleep

debt, depression, obesity, alcohol, and overtraining. That's exactly why **bloodwork and a proper assessment** matter instead of self-diagnosis from a podcast.

Why TRT clinics exist

Testosterone replacement therapy (TRT) clinics and endocrine pathways exist because some people have **documented low testosterone** (and a clinical picture that fits) and benefit from supervised replacement. Clinics also exist because demand is high and marketing is loud — which means you must still separate:

Serious clinic / medical pathway	Marketing mill
History + exam + appropriate labs	"Everyone's low, buy this"
Interpretation in context (time of day, illness, obesity, sleep)	One finger-prick → lifelong product
Monitoring plan	No follow-up
Fertility / prostate / haematocrit / cardiovascular conversation where relevant	"It's just optimisation, bro"

This book is not telling you that you need TRT. It is telling you that **clinically low T is a legitimate medical domain**, clinics exist for that domain, and gym lore is a terrible laboratory.

What "low T" literacy includes (no protocols)

- Symptoms are **non-specific** — fix sleep, alcohol, body fat, and training stress before you crown yourself hypogonadal.
- Confirmation is **lab + clinical**, not vibes.
- Obesity and metabolic health interact with the androgen axis — sometimes fat loss improves the picture; sometimes medicine is still discussed. Neither sentence is a DIY prescription.
- Exogenous testosterone **suppresses** the natural axis while in use — fertility planning matters if kids are on the horizon.
- Monitoring themes in supervised care often include how you feel, blood counts/haematocrit trends, hormones as directed by the clinician, blood pressure, and follow-ups — exact panels are the clinician's call.
- "TRT" in gym speech sometimes means replacement for low levels and sometimes means physique-dosed androgens with a clinic sticker. Literacy means asking which one you're

actually talking about.

TRT vs physique androgen use

Replacement for diagnosed deficiency and “I want larger delts” are not the same project ethically, medically, or in monitoring intensity. Blurring them is how people get hurt or scammed. If your goal is physique enhancement beyond replacement, you’re in the next section’s risk conversation — not a soft TRT rebrand.

ANABOLIC PEDS — PHYSIQUE CULTURE WITHOUT THE PAMPHLET VOICE

Anabolic-androgenic steroids and related androgens are part of modern physique culture. Done stupid, they wreck people. Done with intention, planning, monitoring, and experienced supervision, some adults still choose them — with real upsides for muscle-building potential and real costs.

What they do (conceptually)

They ramp androgen signalling. Muscle-building potential rises. So do demands on heart, blood, lipids, liver (especially many orals), skin, mood, fertility, and the hypothalamic–pituitary–gonadal axis.

Done properly vs internet chaos (no recipes)

Done properly (themes)	Chaos
Clear goal	“Everyone’s on”
Coach + monitoring culture	Screenshot cycle
Baseline + follow-up labs / BP	“I feel fine”
Fertility conversation if relevant	Surprise infertility
Training + protein still non-negotiable	Drug replaces work
One change at a time under supervision	Five compounds week one
Exit / continuity thinking	Panic Google at 2 a.m.

Long-term illicit AAS patterns are associated in observational research with adverse cardiovascular pictures and axis issues after stopping — not cartoons, not permission slips. Smart use, if someone chooses it with professionals, **monitors and manages** risk instead of pretending risk is fake.

Foundation still matters: months of logging training and hitting protein are competence, not moral purity. Enhancement on top of chaos multiplies chaos.

This book will not invent your plan, doses, or PCT theatre.

PEPTIDES — SUITCASE WORD, UNEVEN EVIDENCE

In gym speech, “peptides” mixes injury folklore, fat-loss toys, GH-axis experiments, and random letters on a vial. Some peptides exist in narrow medical lanes. A lot of consumer talk sits on thin human evidence with a checkout link.

Literacy questions before excitement:

1. Which molecule — not which brand stack?
2. Which claim — healing, sleep, fat loss, recovery?
3. What evidence class — clinical use vs preclinical noise vs anecdote?
4. What’s the downside and unknowns?
5. Who’s selling it, and what’s their incentive?

Injury: diagnose and rehab first. Don’t vial your way around physiotherapy. Grey-market mystery vials add contamination and legality risk on top of biology unknowns.

Same rule as the rest of this chapter: coach + medical reality when use is real — not vendor chat as endocrinology.

HOW ADVANCED TOOLS INTERACT WITH STRIPLINE

STRIPLINE piece	Interaction with tools
STRIP	Fat-loss-first still primary for soft middles; GLP-1s may support adherence under a doctor; drugs don’t excuse zero protein

STRIPLINE piece	Interaction with tools
LINE	Locked food + PPL/PPLU plan still required; tools don't replace the written programme
LIFT	Muscle emphasis still needs progressive overload; enhancement doesn't delete form or tendons
LINK	Accountability rises in importance when pharmacology is involved — coach/clinician, not vibes

If a tool makes you drop the barbell, skip protein, or quit logging, it's not "working" for a physique goal — even if the scale moves.

COMMON MYTHS (QUICK)

Myth	Literacy
"Everyone serious is on; naturals can't change"	Twelve months of STRIPLINE still moves most beginners a lot
"GLP-1 = no lifestyle needed"	Composition needs protein + lifting
"TRT clinic ad = I need TRT"	Labs + clinical picture; fix sleep/fat/alcohol first often
"Peptides are safe because they're peptides"	Suitcase word; evidence varies; grey markets add risk
"PCT makes AAS risk-free"	Monitoring and risk domains don't vanish because a forum said so
"This appendix is a starter protocol"	It isn't. On purpose.

WHAT TO DO WITH THIS INFORMATION

1. Install Stages 5A–5C for real.

2. If overweight/obesity and curious about GLP-1s — talk to a **doctor**, not a vendor. Keep training/protein.
3. If you suspect low testosterone — get properly assessed; understand why clinics exist; don't self-diagnose from ads.
4. If you're drawn to physique androgens/peptides — treat coach + monitoring as the price of admission; refuse chaos PDFs.
5. For personalised discussion inside a coaching context when available: **[PLACEHOLDER: paid offer / coach funnel — pending agreement]**

You can build an extraordinary physique in twelve months with fundamentals alone. Advanced tools are part of the culture — learn them as an adult, or ignore them as an adult. Don't half-learn them as a customer.

BRIDGE

Return to the Year Logbook appendix next — print the pages, run the year, keep the scoreboard honest. Literacy without execution is just a smarter way to stall.

DEEPER: GLP-1 PATIENT LITERACY (STILL NOT A PRESCRIPTION)

Who typically ends up in the medical conversation

People with overweight/obesity — often with weight-related health pressures — who have struggled with sustained fat loss through lifestyle alone. Exact eligibility is clinical and jurisdiction-specific. Instagram thinness anxiety is not a prescribing criterion.

What the first clinical conversations usually cover (themes)

- History of weight, diets, binge patterns, medications, pancreatitis/thyroid/family history themes as relevant
- What success means beyond the scale (function, labs, composition goals)
- Side-effect expectations (GI issues are commonly discussed)
- Follow-up cadence
- Cost/access realities

You are not "behind" if your doctor says not yet, not indicated, or try X lifestyle block first. You're in medicine, not a sales funnel.

Physique-specific trap on GLP-1s

The trap is celebrating the scale while arms flatten and the gym becomes optional. STRIPLINE's answer is boring and correct: protein scheduled, PPL/PPLU logged, steps, sleep, photos. If appetite suppression makes food aversive, choose easier protein defaults (yoghurt, shakes, lean meats) — still hit the grams.

Coming off or pausing

Weight regain risk rises when the behaviour layer never existed. Build LINE while the tool is helping — don't rent the result.

DEEPER: TESTOSTERONE ASSESSMENT WITHOUT GYM FOLKLORE

Non-specific symptoms deserve boring differentials first

Low mood, low drive, poor recovery, and low libido show up in sleep debt, depression, relationship stress, alcohol, obesity, and overreaching. A serious workup treats those as first-class suspects. "I saw a TRT ad" is not a differential diagnosis.

What "clinic" should mean

A pathway that can order and interpret labs in context, discuss risks/benefits, plan monitoring, and handle follow-up. A pathway that only sells product against a single number is a store with a white coat filter.

Fertility and life stage

If you want children, say so early in any hormone conversation. Exogenous androgens affect the axis. This is literacy, not scaremongering — and not a protocol.

Body-fat and the axis

Higher body fat can interact with hormonal milieu. Sometimes fat loss (STRIP) improves how you feel and how labs look. Sometimes clinical hypogonadism still exists after fat loss. Both can be true for different people. Neither sentence authorises DIY testosterone.

DEEPER: ENHANCEMENT CULTURE PSYCHOLOGY

People reach for androgens because timelines on the feed look impossible, because they've plateaued after honest training, or because curiosity tipped into impatience. Some will still choose enhancement with eyes open. Literacy demands you admit the category exists without recruiting beginners into Month-1 chaos.

Competence bar before enhancement conversations get serious:

- 8–12+ weeks logged progressive training
- Protein adherence most days
- Photos/waist reviews without lying
- Willingness to monitor like an adult

If you won't do those, you don't want smart use — you want a shortcut story.

EVIDENCE HABIT FOR ANY CLAIM THAT EXCITES YOU

When a reel, clinic ad, or mate promises a compound will fix your life:

1. What exactly is the molecule/claim?
2. Is this clinical medicine, physique culture, or vendor science?
3. What's the incentive?
4. What's the downside list — cardiovascular, endocrine, fertility, mental health, legal/access?
5. Who monitors you if you proceed?

Write those five lines in your Year Logbook before you spend money or change your biochemistry.

FAQ — ADVANCED TOOLS (SHORT)

Do I need any of this to transform in 12 months?
No. STRIPLINE fundamentals are enough for most beginners/restarters.

Can a doctor prescribe a GLP-1 if I'm overweight?
Often that's a real medical pathway depending on criteria where you live — ask a doctor, not a vendor.

Is feeling tired proof I need TRT?
No. Get assessed properly; fix sleep/alcohol/fat/training stress in parallel.

Will this book tell me how to run a cycle?
No. On purpose.

Where do I ask personal questions?
`[PLACEHOLDER: paid offer / coach funnel — pending agreement]` when that door is open — plus appropriate clinicians.

CLOSING STANDARD

Pro smart use. Anti chaos. Bodybuilding involves this landscape — learn it like an adult. Then go lift, eat protein, run STRIPLINE, and fill the Year Logbook. Tools are optional. Honesty isn't.

LEGACY CRAFT NOTES — ANDROGENS (LITERACY EXTRACT)

Reframed under STRIPLINE literacy — no protocols. Prefer the main sections above if anything conflicts.

Let's drop the pamphlet voice. Anabolic PEDs and testosterone are part of modern physique culture. Done stupid, they wreck people. Done properly — **intention, plan, monitoring, coach** — they can be a serious lever.

Coach standard: if you're going to use androgens, use them with someone who knows how to implement and keep you accountable. Don't invent a protocol from this book. Don't run stranger PDFs.

WHAT YOU NEED TO KNOW

What they do

Anabolic-androgenic steroids (AAS) and related androgens ramp androgen signalling. Muscle-building potential jumps. So do demands on the heart, blood, lipids, liver (especially many orals), skin, mood, fertility, and the HPT/HPG axis.

Testosterone is the backbone most smart users start from — whether under clinical TRT care or structured physique use with a coach. It's also had a **remarkably positive impact** for people who finally got levels and training sorted after years of spinning their wheels (lived upside is real; your exact labs and plan are individual — we're not inventing doses here).

Done properly vs internet chaos

Done properly	Internet chaos
Clear goal (recomp, growth, TRT health, etc.)	“Everyone’s on, so I’ll wing it”
Coach + written plan	Screenshot cycle from a stranger
Baseline + follow-up bloodwork	“I feel fine” as the only lab
Blood pressure tracked	Ignoring BP until something scary
Fertility plan if kids matter	Surprise infertility
Progressive training + protein still non-negotiable	Expecting the drug to replace work
One change at a time	Five compounds week one
Exit / continuity plan discussed	Panic PCT Google at 2 a.m.

Risk domains (honest, not theatrical)

Long-term illicit AAS use is associated with adverse cardiovascular phenotypes — impaired ventricular function, greater coronary plaque burden — observational evidence, class **B**, not a cartoon. *(Claim ; bib .)* Exogenous androgens suppress the male axis and can leave hypogonadism, fertility, and mood/dependence issues after stopping. *(Claim ; bib , .)* Orals often hit liver enzymes and lipids harder. Personality can get louder — great if you’re already stable; ugly if you’re not.

Smart use doesn’t pretend those risks are fake. It **monitors and manages** them instead of hoping.

Monitoring themes (what competent setups watch)

Not a DIY prescription — a checklist of what “serious” looks like:

- **Blood pressure** at home, logged
- **Bloods:** haematocrit/hemoglobin / CBC trends, lipids, liver enzymes (context), testosterone/estradiol-related markers as your clinician/coach directs, metabolic panel
- **Individual response:** aromatisation and how you feel on a given setup vary person to person — **bloodwork adjusts the plan**, not vibes and soy memes. Injection frequency and compound choice change the picture; your coach reads labs, you don’t invent ratios from a forum.
- **Fertility** conversation before you need it

- **Mood / sleep / libido / acne / water** notes in the training log
- **Strength jumps vs tendon readiness** — ego injuries spike when the muscle outruns the connective tissue
- **Health curiosity that matches the ambition:** BP, bloods, and (when appropriate) deeper cardiovascular check-ins — people who "do it properly" treat monitoring like part of training, not optional homework

If BP is chaos, that's a stop-and-fix signal — not a badge of honour. Haematocrit creeping up isn't a flex either — it's a conversation with whoever's supervising you.

Training and food while enhanced

- Progressive overload still decides whether the extra androgen signalling turns into muscle or just gym stories
- Protein stays high; calories match the goal
- Don't suddenly max every lift because you feel bulletproof
- Deloads still exist — drugs don't delete fatigue forever; early PR fireworks can hide accumulating fatigue until you stall hard
- When volume needs a nudge mid-block, stay **conservative** (+1 hard set where stimulus was clearly missing) rather than doubling the plan
- Sleep still grows you
- Mini-cuts / easier weeks exist in longer growth blocks to bleed fatigue and buy runway — that's programme design, not panic

Common fuck-ups

1. Blasting before you can log training and hit protein for a boring block
2. Orals-as-"beginner-friendly" marketing
3. Stacking more compounds because week three felt flat
4. Ignoring haematocrit / BP
5. Comparing natural Year-1 mates to your enhanced Month-3
6. No coach, no bloods, maximum Reddit confidence

Foundation still matters

Months 1–3 of this book still teach you to train and eat. That's not moralising — it's competence. Enhancement on top of chaos multiplies chaos. Enhancement on top of a system multiplies the system.

WHY IT MATTERS

Because the feed flattened enhanced and natural timelines into one scroll. If you can't tell smart use from clown use, you'll either fear tools that could help or copy the clown.

WHAT EXPERIENCED USERS / COACHES OBSERVE

- Bloodwork and BP are non-optional
- Food and sleep still explain a disgusting amount of the result
- Short chaotic runs burn people out when ambition outruns recovery
- Testosterone done with a plan often beats kitchen-sink stacking for people who actually want to look better and feel better long-term
- Ego loading on a strong cycle is how pecs tear

YOUR ACTION PLAN

1. **If you're natural Year 1:** build the system first (Parts Two–Three). Curiosity is fine; chaos isn't.
2. **If you're considering androgens:** get a coach who monitors — don't DIY this chapter into a cycle.
3. **Baseline:** BP, bloods, fertility goals, honest health history with a clinician where appropriate.
4. **Write the non-drug half of the plan:** training split, protein, sleep, deload rule.
5. **Log symptoms + lifts + BP** like an adult.
6. **One variable at a time** when adjusting with your coach.

YOUR TARGETS

- [ ] I can explain properly vs chaos in one minute
- [ ] I know the main risk domains without panic theatre
- [ ] Monitoring themes listed
- [ ] Training/protein still non-negotiable on any plan
- [ ] No stranger-PDF protocol

COMMON MISTAKES

Fuck-up	Better
Screenshot cycle	Coached plan + bloods

Fuck-up	Better
“PCT makes it risk-free”	PCT talk ≠ erased CV risk; still not a recipe from this book
Feelings-only monitoring	Labs + BP
Orals first because “simple”	Simplicity ≠ safety

YOUR CHECKLIST

- [ ] Stance clear: pro smart use, anti chaos
- [ ] Coach standard understood
- [ ] Monitoring list saved
- [ ] Ready for peptides — same standard

WHAT’S NEXT

Peptides — suitcase word, uneven evidence, plenty of affiliate nonsense. Same rule: practical literacy, coach when it’s real use, no discount-code science.

LEGACY CRAFT NOTES — GLP-1 / METABOLIC (LITERACY EXTRACT)

Reframed under STRIPLINE literacy — no protocols. Prefer the main sections above if anything conflicts.

These drugs changed the game. Appetite drops. Adherence gets easier. Scales move. Used with a brain — training, protein, monitoring, ideally a coach — they can be transformational. Used as a “stop eating and disappear” button, you get smaller and softer and wonder why you hate the mirror.

Lived reality check: tools in this family (including retatrutide in the emerging lane, and testosterone elsewhere in Part Four) have been **remarkably positive** for people who finally got fat loss and hormones moving after years of white-knuckle failure. Upside is real. So is the skinny-soft trap if you drop the barbell.

WHAT YOU NEED TO KNOW

What they do

GLP-1 pathway drugs (and dual/triple agonists around them) hit appetite, satiety, gastric emptying, metabolic signalling. You eat less without relying only on monk willpower. That creates a real deficit. Treat it like a powerful adherence tool, not a personality transplant.

Done properly vs scale cosplay

Properly	Chaos
Goal = better composition, not just a number	Fastest possible drop
Protein planned on purpose (hunger is gone — that's the trap)	"I'm not hungry so I skipped protein"
Progressive lifting non-negotiable	Cardio-only vanishing act
Coach / clinician titration + follow-up	Grey-market DIY + forum doses
Strength + photos tracked	Scale as the only god
Exit / maintenance behaviour planned	Drug removed, habits never existed, rebound surprise

Muscle and lean mass — practical truth

Analyses of GLP-1/GIP agonist–assisted weight loss often show some **absolute lean-mass drop** (commonly ~¼ of total kg lost in pooled body-comp work) even when relative lean % looks steadier. That's not an automatic disease label — it's why you train. *(Claim ; bib .)*

Practical tips while appetite is suppressed:

1. **Protein first every day** — schedule it; don't wait to "feel like eating." When intake collapses, lean hard into a high protein target (many coaches push toward that ~g/lb ballpark while cutting) so the deficit isn't all lean tissue.
2. **Lift hard on a written plan** — MED weeks beat zero weeks. Keep *some* progressive loading even on rough weeks.
3. **Don't chase heroic weekly drops** if strength is falling off a cliff.
4. **Steps** help; punishment cardio on empty is how you get flat and injured.
5. **Watch session quality** — if every workout is trash, food or recovery needs a nudge with your coach.
6. **Photos + waist + lifts** — the scale will lie cheerfully.

7. **Structure > drug alone** — sleep, food defaults, training calendar. Medication without lifestyle still fails the long game; if the only thing holding your look is appetite suppression 365 days a year with zero habits underneath, you're renting the result.

Retatrutide deep dive (literacy + smart-use framing)

Next-wave multi-agonist interest is high because fat loss can be aggressive. Smart take:

- Respect that access/approval status moves by country and year
- Don't copy another drug's expectations onto a newer agent
- Build the behaviour layer (protein, lifting, sleep) around what the drug actually does to appetite
- Coach + medical oversight — not a group chat

Stopping without habits is how weight returns. That's not a moral failing; it's a systems failure. Fix the system — diet pattern, sleep hygiene, lifting — the same way you'd fix any other tool's off-ramp. It's never *only* the medication.

Side-effect reality (not a scare pamphlet)

GI issues are common conversation topics. Fatigue happens. Food aversions happen. Work with whoever is supervising you — don't "push through" chest pain, severe persistent vomiting, or anything that feels medically wrong.

WHY IT MATTERS

Pathway C readers will see miracles and feel behind. Pathway A/B readers will misuse appetite suppression when they needed surplus or recomp. Smart use matches the tool to the goal and keeps the physique project intact.

WHAT EXPERIENCED COACHES / USERS OBSERVE

- Structure still decides the long game — meds without habits are rented results
- Best looks pair the drug with serious lifting and deliberate protein
- People sabotage by under-eating protein because hunger vanished
- Sales pitches aren't clinical guidelines — evaluate incentives

YOUR ACTION PLAN

1. **Foundation first if you're brand new to training** — learn to lift and hit protein even if a clinician already has you on a metabolic drug.
2. **If you're on a prescribed agent now:** tell your coach/clinician the physique goal; lock protein + lifting; track strength.
3. **Write a "not hungry" protocol:** default protein meals that go down easy.
4. **Review every 2–4 weeks:** photos, waist, lifts, side effects — not only kilograms.
5. **Retatrutide curiosity:** clinical literature + licensed pathway + coach — no DIY lore.
6. **Plan the off-ramp behaviours** before you need them.

YOUR TARGETS

- [ ] Properly vs chaos clear
- [ ] Protein-on-purpose plan written
- [ ] Lifting non-negotiable while appetite is low
- [ ] Lean-mass caveat understood without panic
- [ ] Retatrutide treated as investigational / supervised, not a meme protocol

COMMON MISTAKES

Fuck-up	Fix
Quitting the gym because fatigue feels weird	MED training + talk to supervisor
Tiny protein	Schedule protein
Grey-market pens	Licensed care
Scale-only dopamine	Photos + strength
No plan when the drug stops	Habits before off-ramp

YOUR CHECKLIST

- [ ] Tool matched to goal
- [ ] Behaviour layer installed
- [ ] Monitoring with coach/clinician
- [ ] Ready for the decision chapter — when advanced tools actually make sense

WHAT'S NEXT

Deciding whether advanced tools are relevant — not a fear chapter. A filter: fundamentals competence, coach standard, red flags for chaos, and how to choose intentionally.

LEGACY CRAFT NOTES — PEPTIDES (LITERACY EXTRACT)

Reframed under STRIPLINE literacy — no protocols. Prefer the main sections above if anything conflicts.

"Peptides" in gym speech is a suitcase. Healing folklore, fat-loss toys, GH-axis experiments, random letters on a vial. Some of this is real pharmacology in narrow medical lanes. A lot of it is **C–E evidence** with a checkout link.

Stance here matches the rest of Part Four: **pro when done correctly** — clear goal, evidence honesty, sourcing that isn't clownish, **with a coach** when you're actually using. Anti: affiliate stacks and "research chem because TikTok."

WHAT YOU NEED TO KNOW

What a peptide is

Short amino-acid chains that can signal biology. That definition does not make every vial smart.

Buckets (literacy map, not a shopping list)

Bucket	What people chase	Honest vibe	Smart-use note
Injury / recovery folklore	Faster healing	Preclinical noise; **very low-certainty human** data for widely marketed healing peptides (e.g. BPC-157 talk). *(Claim ; bib , .)*	Diagnose the injury; rehab first; don't vial your way around physio
GH-axis secretagogues	Sleep, recovery, composition	Mixed/limited; age/context matter	Coach + labs if you go there; not a Year-1 distraction

Bucket	What people chase	Honest vibe	Smart-use note
Metabolic / fat-loss peptides	Appetite / composition	Overlaps real drugs and marketing	Often better handled as the GLP-1 conversation (next chapter)
Kitchen-sink blends	Everything	Hard pass	Complexity ≠ sophistication

Discount-code science is commerce. Mark the incentive **E** before you mark the biology.

Done properly vs chaos

Properly	Chaos
Named compound, named goal	“Peptide stack” with no mechanism story
Coach who actually monitors	Telegram vendor as your endocrinologist
Know the evidence class	Preclinical PDF as proof
Quality / legality awareness	Mystery vial, mystery dose culture
Still train and eat	Peptides as personality

Unknowns that still matter

Long-term healthy-lifter safety for many gym peptides is thin. Mislabelling and contamination are real in grey markets. Interactions with meds exist. “I feel recovered” might be sleep and placebo.

SARMs-adjacent marketing

“Beginner-friendly androgen” language is sales. Incomplete long-term data and grey legal status depending on where you live. Same standard: coach, plan, monitoring — or don’t.

WHY IT MATTERS

This is where curious people get farmed. Precision protects you: which molecule, which claim, which evidence class, which downside, who’s selling it.

WHAT EXPERIENCED PEOPLE DO

- Separate “interesting paper” from “I’m starting Thursday.”
- Fix training, protein, sleep before peptide rabbit holes.
- Treat grey-market sourcing as a risk factor by itself.
- Use a coach when use is real — not a vendor chat.

YOUR ACTION PLAN

1. **Name the problem** you’re trying to solve (injury? sleep? fat loss?).
2. **Force the evidence-class sentence** before excitement.
3. **Injuries:** clinician + rehab pathway first.
4. **If pursuing peptides for physique:** do it with a coach and bloodwork culture — not this chapter as a protocol.
5. **Ignore affiliate certainty.**

YOUR TARGETS

- [ ] Suitcase-word problem understood
- [ ] Healing-folklore human evidence marked thin
- [ ] Properly vs chaos table clear
- [ ] No discount-code protocol

COMMON MISTAKES

Fuck-up	Fix
Peptide = safe because “not a steroid”	Different ≠ free
DIY injury stacks	Get diagnosed
Five unknowns at once	Zero is fine until fundamentals are boring

YOUR CHECKLIST

- [ ] Literacy without vendor cosplay
- [ ] Coach standard for real use
- [ ] Ready for GLP-1s / retatrutide — tools that actually move the scale hard

WHAT'S NEXT

GLP-1s, metabolic drugs, and retatrutide — practical use with training and protein, what goes wrong when people only chase the scale, and why these tools can be life-changing when the behaviour layer stays sharp.

LEGACY CRAFT NOTES — DECISION FILTER (LITERACY EXTRACT)

Reframed under STRIPLINE literacy — no protocols. Prefer the main sections above if anything conflicts.

Curiosity is sane. Recklessness is optional. This is the filter chapter: when supplements-beyond-basics, testosterone/AAS, peptides, or GLP-1s actually belong in *your* plan — and how "done properly" stays the standard.

Pro smart use. Anti chaos. One short honesty line: these tools have real risks and real upsides; monitoring and a coach are how adults play.

WHAT YOU NEED TO KNOW

Defaults that still make sense

Layer	Sensible default
Training / food / sleep / habits	Always on
Tier-1 supplements	Optional once basics exist
Testosterone / AAS / peptides / GLP-1s	On the table when the goal fits — **with a plan and a coach**, not as Month-1 cosplay

You can change a lot in twelve months with fundamentals alone. If you can't log training and hit protein for a boring block, adding pharmacology mostly multiplies mess. That's competence, not purity cosplay.

Questions before you escalate

1. Have I run progressive overload ~8–12 weeks with decent attendance?
2. Is protein hit most days?
3. Is my goal actually composition — or just impatience?

4. Am I comparing to someone on a different pharmacy?
5. Do I have (or will I get) a coach who monitors?
6. Am I willing to do bloodwork / BP / follow-ups?
7. Fertility, heart history, mental health — have I been honest with a clinician where it matters?

If (1)–(2) are trash and you're already shopping vials, fix the system first.

What "with a coach" means here

Structure, implementation, accountability, adjustments from data — not a vibe account and not a vendor. We won't name names or funnel you. The standard is the point.

Red flags (walk away)

- Stranger "beginner cycle" PDFs
- No bloodwork culture
- Discount-code medicine as your only education
- Five compounds in week one
- Guaranteed timelines
- Pressure to start tonight
- Anyone telling you to skip monitoring

Evidence habit

> Evidence class A–F · incentive · downside · do I have a coach for this?

Part Four claims for AAS CV/endocrine, healing-peptide thinness, GLP-1 weight/lean-mass, and retatrutide investigational status stay wired as literacy anchors — they inform smart use; they don't replace your coach.

WHY IT MATTERS

Without a filter, Part Four becomes impulse fuel. With one, tools stay tools — including the ones that can change a life when testosterone or a GLP-1/retatrutide pathway finally clicks under proper supervision.

WHAT EXPERIENCED PEOPLE DO

- Separate identity from compounds
- Get labs and goals clear before escalating
- Keep a working programme when tools change
- Treat “not yet” as strategy when fundamentals aren’t installed

YOUR ACTION PLAN

1. **Write your current tool policy** in one paragraph (what’s in, what’s out, coach status).
2. **Run the self-questions** above in your logbook.
3. **If escalating:** book coach + appropriate clinical oversight before product.
4. **If already on tools:** audit protein, lifting, BP/bloods, photos — upgrade the boring half.
5. **Revisit at phase reviews** (Ch 20 / 21), not at 1 a.m. after a reel.

YOUR TARGETS

- [ ] Policy written
- [ ] Coach standard accepted for real use
- [ ] Red-flag list recognised
- [ ] Fundamentals competence checked honestly
- [ ] Part Four exit: you can use literacy without becoming a chaos customer

COMMON MISTAKES

Fuck-up	Fix
Tools to skip basics	Basics first, then tools
Vendor as coach	Real coaching + monitoring
Shame about curiosity	Curiosity fine; PDFs from strangers aren’t
All-or-nothing purity vs kitchen-sink	Intentional middle: smart use

YOUR CHECKLIST

- [ ] Decision filter usable under hype
- [ ] No funnel CTAs, no named coaches from this book

- [ ] Ready for Part Five — identity and the long game

WHAT'S NEXT

Tools don't make you a bodybuilder by themselves. **Identity, discipline without obsession, body image, training around life, and Year Two** do. Part Five closes that loop.

FINAL REMINDER

No dosages. No stacks. No sourcing. Doctor/clinic pathways for GLP-1 and TRT questions. Coach+monitoring for enhancement culture. Fundamentals first. Soft door: **[PLACEHOLDER: paid offer / coach funnel — pending agreement]**.

YEAR LOGBOOK

Year Logbook & Tracker

Print these pages. Write on them. Bring them back for twelve months.

This is the **follow-along paper system** for *The 12-Month Body*. Use it with Stage 5A's month plan, Stage 5B's nutrition workflow, and Stage 5C's PPL/PPLU templates. Digital apps (Cronometer / Hevy defaults) are fine — still paste weekly averages here so the year stays visible on paper.

How to use: fill **Food Bro targets** once → run **weekly templates** (photocopy or duplicate in Notes) → complete **twelve monthly overviews** → do **quarterly reviews** → keep PPL session sheets in the gym bag.

Soft coaching door if you want a human later: **[PLACEHOLDER: paid offer / coach funnel — pending agreement]**

FOOD BRO TARGETS (PASTE-IN)

Set numbers at **https://yehbro.com/food-bro/** then write them here. Update when Stage 5A says to change a lever.

Field	Value	Date set
Goal (STRIP cut / recomp / LIFT)		
Calories		
Protein (g)		
Fat (g) optional		
Carbs optional / fill		
Bodyweight used for protein		
Food app primary	**Cronometer** (alt: MFP / MacroFactor)	
Training app primary	**Hevy** (alt: Strong / paper)	

Notes:

STRIPLINE PHASE CHECKLIST (REVISIT MONTHLY)

STRIP

- [ ] Calories in deficit (or recomp that still improves midsection)
- [ ] Protein hit most days
- [ ] PPL/PPLU sessions still progressive
- [ ] Steps floor active
- [ ] Photos show midsection moving **or** lean exception documented

LINE

- [ ] One programme locked (no hopping)
- [ ] Food targets written
- [ ] Sleep + step floors written
- [ ] Review date on calendar

LIFT (only when criteria met)

- [ ] STRIP→LIFT checklist passed (Stage 5A)
- [ ] Calories at maintenance/surplus as planned
- [ ] Same split; volume added conservatively
- [ ] Not using “bulk” to avoid hunger honesty

LINK

- [ ] Human check-in happened this week/month
- [ ] I told the truth about adherence
- [ ] Placeholder coaching door noted if needed: `[PLACEHOLDER: paid offer / coach funnel — pending agreement]`

WEIGHT / WAIST / PHOTO MASTER LOG

Date	Weight	Waist	Photo ID	Sleep	Stress 1–5	Note

(Add rows as needed; aim ≥2 photo check-ins per month.)

WEEKLY LOG TEMPLATE (PHOTOCOPY / DUPLICATE FOR EACH WEEK)

Week starting: _____ · **Phase:** STRIP / LIFT · **Programme:** PPL / PPLU / FB

Adherence score (0–2 each)

Protein days	Sessions done	Steps floor	Sleep floor	Honest logging	/10

LINK check-in

Date: _____ · Sent to: _____ · What I reported:

Their ask / my commit:

Calories & protein (daily)

Day	Calories	Protein (g)	Notes
Mon			
Tue			
Wed			
Thu			

Day	Calories	Protein (g)	Notes
Fri			
Sat			
Sun			
Weekly avg			

Food app used: Cronometer / MyFitnessPal / MacroFactor / other: _____

Training tick box

Day	Session (P/P/L/U/FB)	Logged in Hevy/Strong?	Top set note
1		[ ]	
2		[ ]	
3		[ ]	
4		[ ]	
5		[ ]	
6		[ ]	

TWELVE MONTHLY OVERVIEW PAGES

Use one page per month. Keep them in order.

MONTHLY OVERVIEW — MONTH 1 — STRIP + LINE INSTALL

Dates: _____ to _____ · **STRIPLINE bias this month:** STRIP / LINE / LIFT / LINK

Metric	Week 1	Week 2	Week 3	Week 4	Month note
Adherence /10					
Avg calories					

Metric	Week 1	Week 2	Week 3	Week 4	Month note
Avg protein (g)					
Waist (cm)					
Trend weight					
Main lift note					

Photos taken? [ ] front [ ] side [ ] back · Folder: _____

What "good" looked like this month:

Failure modes I hit:

One lever for next month:

LINK check-in notes:

Next month's first action:

MONTHLY OVERVIEW — MONTH 2 — STRIP GROOVE

Dates: _____ to _____ · **STRIPLINE bias this month:** STRIP / LINE / LIFT / LINK

Metric	Week 1	Week 2	Week 3	Week 4	Month note
Adherence /10					
Avg calories					
Avg protein (g)					
Waist (cm)					
Trend weight					
Main lift note					

Photos taken? [ ] front [ ] side [ ] back · Folder: _____

What "good" looked like this month:

Failure modes I hit:

One lever for next month:

LINK check-in notes:

Next month's first action:

MONTHLY OVERVIEW — MONTH 3 — STRIP REVIEW & PHASE-1 DECISION

Dates: _____ to _____ · **STRIPLINE bias this month:** STRIP / LINE / LIFT / LINK

Metric	Week 1	Week 2	Week 3	Week 4	Month note
Adherence /10					
Avg calories					
Avg protein (g)					
Waist (cm)					
Trend weight					
Main lift note					

Photos taken? [ ] front [ ] side [ ] back · Folder: _____

What "good" looked like this month:

Failure modes I hit:

One lever for next month:

LINK check-in notes:

Next month's first action:

MONTHLY OVERVIEW — MONTH 4 — STRIP CONTINUE / EARLY TRANSITION WATCH

Dates: _____ to _____ · **STRIPLINE bias this month:** STRIP / LINE / LIFT / LINK

Metric	Week 1	Week 2	Week 3	Week 4	Month note
Adherence /10					
Avg calories					
Avg protein (g)					
Waist (cm)					
Trend weight					
Main lift note					

Photos taken? [ ] front [ ] side [ ] back · Folder: _____

What “good” looked like this month:

Failure modes I hit:

One lever for next month:

LINK check-in notes:

Next month’s first action:

MONTHLY OVERVIEW — MONTH 5 — ADHERENCE & MIDSECTION HONESTY

Dates: _____ to _____ · **STRIPLINE bias this month:** STRIP / LINE / LIFT / LINK

Metric	Week 1	Week 2	Week 3	Week 4	Month note
Adherence /10					
Avg calories					
Avg protein (g)					
Waist (cm)					
Trend weight					
Main lift note					

Photos taken? [ ] front [ ] side [ ] back · Folder: _____

What "good" looked like this month:

Failure modes I hit:

One lever for next month:

LINK check-in notes:

Next month's first action:

MONTHLY OVERVIEW — MONTH 6 — MID-YEAR REVIEW (STRIP VS LIFT CRITERIA)

Dates: _____ to _____ · **STRIPLINE bias this month:** STRIP / LINE / LIFT / LINK

Metric	Week 1	Week 2	Week 3	Week 4	Month note
Adherence /10					
Avg calories					
Avg protein (g)					
Waist (cm)					
Trend weight					
Main lift note					

Photos taken? [ ] front [ ] side [ ] back · Folder: _____

What "good" looked like this month:

Failure modes I hit:

One lever for next month:

LINK check-in notes:

Next month's first action:

MONTHLY OVERVIEW — MONTH 7 — LIFT EMPHASIS IF EARNED / STRIP IF NOT

Dates: _____ to _____ · **STRIPLINE bias this month:** STRIP / LINE / LIFT / LINK

Metric	Week 1	Week 2	Week 3	Week 4	Month note
Adherence /10					
Avg calories					
Avg protein (g)					
Waist (cm)					
Trend weight					
Main lift note					

Photos taken? [ ] front [ ] side [ ] back · Folder: _____

What "good" looked like this month:

Failure modes I hit:

One lever for next month:

LINK check-in notes:

Next month's first action:

MONTHLY OVERVIEW — MONTH 8 — PROGRESSIVE OVERLOAD HONESTY

Dates: _____ to _____ · **STRIPLINE bias this month:** STRIP / LINE / LIFT / LINK

Metric	Week 1	Week 2	Week 3	Week 4	Month note
Adherence /10					
Avg calories					
Avg protein (g)					
Waist (cm)					

Metric	Week 1	Week 2	Week 3	Week 4	Month note
Trend weight					
Main lift note					

Photos taken? [ ] front [ ] side [ ] back · Folder: _____

What “good” looked like this month:

Failure modes I hit:

One lever for next month:

LINK check-in notes:

Next month’s first action:

MONTHLY OVERVIEW — MONTH 9 — REFINE WEAK POINTS WITHOUT NOVELTY

Dates: _____ to _____ · **STRIPLINE bias this month:** STRIP / LINE / LIFT / LINK

Metric	Week 1	Week 2	Week 3	Week 4	Month note
Adherence /10					
Avg calories					
Avg protein (g)					
Waist (cm)					
Trend weight					
Main lift note					

Photos taken? [ ] front [ ] side [ ] back · Folder: _____

What “good” looked like this month:

Failure modes I hit:

One lever for next month:

LINK check-in notes:

Next month's first action:

MONTHLY OVERVIEW — MONTH 10 — PEAK PREPARATION / PHOTO STANDARD

Dates: _____ to _____ · **STRIPLINE bias this month:** STRIP / LINE / LIFT / LINK

Metric	Week 1	Week 2	Week 3	Week 4	Month note
Adherence /10					
Avg calories					
Avg protein (g)					
Waist (cm)					
Trend weight					
Main lift note					

Photos taken? [ ] front [ ] side [ ] back · Folder: _____

What "good" looked like this month:

Failure modes I hit:

One lever for next month:

LINK check-in notes:

Next month's first action:

MONTHLY OVERVIEW — MONTH 11 — YEAR METRICS LOCK-IN

Dates: _____ to _____ · **STRIPLINE bias this month:** STRIP / LINE / LIFT / LINK

Metric	Week 1	Week 2	Week 3	Week 4	Month note
Adherence /10					

Metric	Week 1	Week 2	Week 3	Week 4	Month note
Avg calories					
Avg protein (g)					
Waist (cm)					
Trend weight					
Main lift note					

Photos taken? [ ] front [ ] side [ ] back · Folder: _____

What "good" looked like this month:

Failure modes I hit:

One lever for next month:

LINK check-in notes:

Next month's first action:

MONTHLY OVERVIEW — MONTH 12 — LINK + YEAR 2 FORK

Dates: _____ to _____ · **STRIPLINE bias this month:** STRIP / LINE / LIFT / LINK

Metric	Week 1	Week 2	Week 3	Week 4	Month note
Adherence /10					
Avg calories					
Avg protein (g)					
Waist (cm)					
Trend weight					
Main lift note					

Photos taken? [ ] front [ ] side [ ] back · Folder: _____

What "good" looked like this month:

Failure modes I hit:

One lever for next month:

LINK check-in notes:

Next month's first action:

QUARTERLY REVIEW PAGES

Quarter 1 review (end of Month 3)

Photos vs Week 0: better / same / worse
Waist change: _____
Strength: up / flat / down on _____.
Adherence average: _____
STRIPLINE phase next: STRIP / transition / LIFT exception
One lever for Q2: _____
LINK note:

Quarter 2 review (end of Month 6)

Photos vs Month 3:
Waist: _____
STRIP→LIFT criteria met? Y / N — why:

Programme still locked? Y / N
Lever for Q3: _____

Quarter 3 review (end of Month 9)

Photos vs Month 6:
Best decision this quarter:
Worst failure mode:
Keep split? Y / N
Lever for Q4: _____

Quarter 4 review (end of Month 12)

Best physique markers vs Week 0:

What worked:

What to never repeat:

Year 2 fork: another STRIP polish / long LIFT / maintenance skill / coaching door

`[PLACEHOLDER: paid offer / coach funnel — pending agreement]`

PPL / PPLU SESSION LOG SHEETS (PRINT EXTRAS)

Push

Exercise	Sets	Reps	Load	RIR
Press (bench/machine)	3	6–10		
Overhead press	3	6–10		
Incline press	2–3	8–12		
Lateral raise	3	10–15		
Triceps	2–3	8–12		

Date: _____ · App logged: Hevy / Strong / paper · Sleep: _____

Pull

Exercise	Sets	Reps	Load	RIR
Row	3	6–10		
Pulldown / pull-up	3	6–10		
Rear delt / face pull	3	10–15		
Curl	2–3	8–12		

Date: _____

Legs

Exercise	Sets	Reps	Load	RIR
Squat / leg press	3	6–10		
Hinge / RDL	3	6–10		
Lunge / curl	2–3	8–12		
Calves	3	8–15		
Core	2	—		

Date: _____

Upper (PPLU)

Exercise	Sets	Reps	Load	RIR
Horizontal press	3	6–10		
Horizontal row	3	6–10		
Vertical press or pull	2–3	8–12		
Lateral raise	2–3	10–15		
Curl	2	8–12		
Triceps	2	8–12		

Date: _____

CALORIES + PROTEIN WEEKLY TRACKER (EXTRA BLANKS)

Week _____

	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun	Avg
Kcal								
Protein								

Week _____

	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun	Avg
Kcal								
Protein								

Week _____

	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun	Avg
Kcal								
Protein								

Week _____

	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun	Avg
Kcal								
Protein								

WEEKLY SHEETS PACK (12 BLANKS)

Duplicate these digitally or print double-sided. One sheet ≈ one week.

Weekly sheet 1

Week starting: _____ · Phase: STRIP / LIFT · Split: PPL / PPLU / FB · App food: Cronometer/other · App train: Hevy/other

Adherence	Protein 0–2	Sessions 0–2	Steps 0–2	Sleep 0–2	Log 0–2	/10

Day	Kcal	Protein	Train? (P/P/L/U)	LINK note
Mon				

Day	Kcal	Protein	Train? (P/P/L/U)	LINK note
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				
Avg				

Waist: _____ · Weight trend: _____ · Wins: _____ · Lever next week: _____

Weekly sheet 2

Week starting: _____ · Phase: STRIP / LIFT · Split: PPL / PPLU / FB · App food: Cronometer/other · App train: Hevy/other

Adherence	Protein 0–2	Sessions 0–2	Steps 0–2	Sleep 0–2	Log 0–2	/10

Day	Kcal	Protein	Train? (P/P/L/U)	LINK note
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				
Avg				

Waist: _____ · Weight trend: _____ · Wins: _____ · Lever next week: _____

Weekly sheet 3

Week starting: _____ · Phase: STRIP / LIFT · Split: PPL / PPLU / FB · App food: Cronometer/other · App train: Hevy/other

Adherence	Protein 0–2	Sessions 0–2	Steps 0–2	Sleep 0–2	Log 0–2	/10

Day	Kcal	Protein	Train? (P/P/L/U)	LINK note
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				
Avg				

Waist: _____ · Weight trend: _____ · Wins: _____ · Lever next week: _____

Weekly sheet 4

Week starting: _____ · Phase: STRIP / LIFT · Split: PPL / PPLU / FB · App food: Cronometer/other · App train: Hevy/other

Adherence	Protein 0–2	Sessions 0–2	Steps 0–2	Sleep 0–2	Log 0–2	/10

Day	Kcal	Protein	Train? (P/P/L/U)	LINK note
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				
Avg				

Waist: _____ · Weight trend: _____ · Wins: _____ · Lever next week: _____

Weekly sheet 5

Week starting: _____ · Phase: STRIP / LIFT · Split: PPL / PPLU / FB · App food: Cronometer/other · App train: Hevy/other

Adherence	Protein 0–2	Sessions 0–2	Steps 0–2	Sleep 0–2	Log 0–2	/10

Day	Kcal	Protein	Train? (P/P/L/U)	LINK note
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

Day	Kcal	Protein	Train? (P/P/L/U)	LINK note
Avg				

Waist: _____ · Weight trend: _____ · Wins: _____ · Lever next week: _____

Weekly sheet 6

Week starting: _____ · Phase: STRIP / LIFT · Split: PPL / PPLU / FB · App food: Cronometer/other · App train: Hevy/other

Adherence	Protein 0–2	Sessions 0–2	Steps 0–2	Sleep 0–2	Log 0–2	/10

Day	Kcal	Protein	Train? (P/P/L/U)	LINK note
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				
Avg				

Waist: _____ · Weight trend: _____ · Wins: _____ · Lever next week: _____

Weekly sheet 7

Week starting: _____ · Phase: STRIP / LIFT · Split: PPL / PPLU / FB · App food: Cronometer/other · App train: Hevy/other

Adherence	Protein 0–2	Sessions 0–2	Steps 0–2	Sleep 0–2	Log 0–2	/10

Day	Kcal	Protein	Train? (P/P/L/U)	LINK note
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				
Avg				

Waist: _____ · Weight trend: _____ · Wins: _____ · Lever next week: _____

Weekly sheet 8

Week starting: _____ · Phase: STRIP / LIFT · Split: PPL / PPLU / FB · App food: Cronometer/other · App train: Hevy/other

Adherence	Protein 0–2	Sessions 0–2	Steps 0–2	Sleep 0–2	Log 0–2	/10

Day	Kcal	Protein	Train? (P/P/L/U)	LINK note
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				

Day	Kcal	Protein	Train? (P/P/L/U)	LINK note
Sat				
Sun				
Avg				

Waist: _____ · Weight trend: _____ · Wins: _____ · Lever next week: _____

Weekly sheet 9

Week starting: _____ · Phase: STRIP / LIFT · Split: PPL / PPLU / FB · App food: Cronometer/other · App train: Hevy/other

Adherence	Protein 0–2	Sessions 0–2	Steps 0–2	Sleep 0–2	Log 0–2	/10

Day	Kcal	Protein	Train? (P/P/L/U)	LINK note
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				
Avg				

Waist: _____ · Weight trend: _____ · Wins: _____ · Lever next week: _____

Weekly sheet 10

Week starting: _____ · Phase: STRIP / LIFT · Split: PPL / PPLU / FB · App food: Cronometer/other · App train: Hevy/other

Adherence	Protein 0–2	Sessions 0–2	Steps 0–2	Sleep 0–2	Log 0–2	/10

Day	Kcal	Protein	Train? (P/P/L/U)	LINK note
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				
Avg				

Waist: _____ · Weight trend: _____ · Wins: _____ · Lever next week: _____

Weekly sheet 11

Week starting: _____ · Phase: STRIP / LIFT · Split: PPL / PPLU / FB · App food: Cronometer/other · App train: Hevy/other

Adherence	Protein 0–2	Sessions 0–2	Steps 0–2	Sleep 0–2	Log 0–2	/10

Day	Kcal	Protein	Train? (P/P/L/U)	LINK note
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				

Day	Kcal	Protein	Train? (P/P/L/U)	LINK note
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				
Avg				

Waist: _____ · Weight trend: _____ · Wins: _____ · Lever next week: _____

Weekly sheet 12

Week starting: _____ · Phase: STRIP / LIFT · Split: PPL / PPLU / FB · App food: Cronometer/other · App train: Hevy/other

Adherence	Protein 0–2	Sessions 0–2	Steps 0–2	Sleep 0–2	Log 0–2	/10

Day	Kcal	Protein	Train? (P/P/L/U)	LINK note
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				
Avg				

Waist: _____ · Weight trend: _____ · Wins: _____ · Lever next week: _____

END-OF-YEAR SIGN-OFF

I ran *The 12-Month Body* STRIPLINE year from _____ to _____.
Honest adherence: _____ / 10 average.
Physique note in one sentence:

Signature / date: _____